

Cohort A

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Business AAS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The Business AAS mission statement has not been changed. The mission statement is still aligned with the college's mission statement. The department continues to work with industry leaders to give students necessary skills to translate into the business community.

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	"Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution? The Business AAS degree gives students the knowledge and skills needed for attractive careers in fields such as accounting, banking and finance, hospitality, human resources, logistics management, marketing, supply, sales, and supply chain management. The Business AAS program and certificates all for partnership and relationship with local businesses and communities.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes

2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The learning outcomes have been assessed in the BUSN 2395 course. Students are assessed using a final exam. There is no change in the outcomes and the way students are being assessed.

Learn outcomes have not changed. These outcomes are assessed in the BUSN 2395 capstone course. Students are still assessed prior to graduation.

PLO 1 and PLO 5 are assessed in the Accounting 1010 course during the Fall and Spring semesters. The current assessment, which began to be used in Fall of 2021, was selected because it is assigned in all ACCT 1010 classes, regardless of modality, and supports all three of the course learning objectives as well as mapping very well to the AAS Business PLOs 1 and 5. The assignment requires students to interpret and evaluate transaction data presented, and then to apply Generally Accepted Accounting Principles in recording those transactions. The assessment has seven elements that parallel the complete accounting cycle that all businesses go through in a single project.

PLO 1, 2, 3, 4, are assessed in the BUS 1305 Introduction to Business Courses during the Fall and Spring. Questions have come up since 2020 on how to better meet these PLOs. In 2021 the Business plan was removed from the course as a way to address the PLOs.

The concern was that students at this point did not fully understand the different parts of a business plan. The understanding of financial statements in the class were not substantial enough to successfully apply to PLOs. Business faculty are currently reviewing other course materials and ideas on how to better prepare students to complete these PLOs.

Faculty are tasked to complete an overhaul of the course by Spring of 2025. In Fall of 2019 all exit exams for the course were removed as they did not directly address or apply to these PLOs.

PLO 1-5 are all assessed in the BUSN 2395 BUSN Applications or Capstone Course. In 2020 program faculty overhauled the course to better align with these PLOs. The course is also better aligned with the course catalogue. The new Capstone course is required for students graduating as early as Fall 2021 (if they entered in Fall 2020 and continued as full-time students for four consecutive semesters through Fall 2021). The new Capstone course include new assessments of program-level student learning outcomes. Objective assessments at the end of the course are currently being used to track student success in meeting these PLOs. Data will continue to be tracked for student success. Program faculty continue to meet and create ideas on how to better meet all five PLOs in this

course. Prior to Spring 2020 the exam was outdated and did not align with program SLOs or courses required for all students in the program and therefore did not accurately measure program learning outcomes. The exam was added in Spring 2020 and addresses new program PLO measures being embedded into the design of a new capstone course.

Evidence:

- Business, AAS Assessment Tool (1)

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

There is no change in the data that was reported in 2023. Students are still being assessed. The course is offered in Spring 2025

Data is still being collected for the 2024 and 2025 AY. The last time data was provided was at the beginning of the APR.

OUTCOME	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	2023 Met	2023 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met) Average%
PLO 1			75.49	24.51%	69.85%	30.15%	Met Met Not
PLO 2			73.15%	26.85%	72.79%	27.21%	Met Met Not
PLO 3			73.15%	26.85%	86.76%	13.24%	Met Met Not
PLO 4			73.15%	26.85%	68.33%	31.67%	Met Met Not
PLO 5			85.94%	14.06%	92.73%	7.27%	Met Met Not
Course Learning Outcome #1 ACCT1010			90.71%	9.29%	92.91%	7.09%	Met Not Met
Course Learning Outcome #2 ACCT1010			90.71%	9.29%	92.91%	7.09%	Met No Met
Course Learning			90.71%	9.29%	92.91%	7.09%	Met Not Met

Outcome #3 ACCT1010							
Course Learning Outcomes	ACCT1010.1 Principles	ACCT 1010.2 Cycle	ACCT 1010.3				
Methods & Procedures							

1. Analysis of trends

Although 75 to 90% of students met PLOs 1-5 in 2022 and 2023, overall the three year outcome results were not met. More data will need to be collected in 2023 to 2025 to determine overall student success rates.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning. Tremendous contributions from a strong team of adjunct faculty that not only taught courses well but even developed numerous, high quality model courses and supported department service and support requirements when we had no other resources to do so. Adjunct faculty have taught 50% or more of all BUS sections for the last three years and helped us provide our students the access and learning modalities they needed to succeed.

Unfortunately, the story of this program and our performance is not entirely pretty. The combination of inadequate full-time faculty strength levels, instability/turnover in the dean's position, and the double-edged blessing and challenge of soaring enrollments have contributed to and exposed some program deficiencies and a challenge to meet objectives with overall PLOs.

- BUS AAS programs see enrollments continue to grow, spurred in part by soaring numbers of high school students enrolling in online, dual enrollment BUS A.A.S. courses
- Business faculty begin utilizing new Team Room spaces to enable more team-based, in-class, problems-/case study-based assignments
- Department rolls out robust tutoring program for Accounting 1010 and 1020 courses

Evidence:

- ACCT1010 CLOs AY20-23
- BUS AAS PLO AY21-23 Ground all other & Online
- BUSN2395 Rubric Report 02-07-2024 081547
- Business AAS Gender PLOs AY21-23
- Business AAS PLOs Pell_First Gen AY21-23
- Business AAS PLOs Race_Ethnicity AY21-23
- Business Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Here is an update on initiatives established by the division.

- Hired new Faculty in accounting and Business in 2023
- Classes in Hospitality Management will start summer 2025 for the embedded certificate.
- Continues to focus on collaboration and teamwork with full-time advisors and developing advising tools and templates to help students develop good, achievable degree plans regardless of the pace at which they progress (full-time or part-time).
- Improved outreach efforts to improve alignment and teamwork with feeder school systems, TCATs, job centers, and employers in our service area.
- Department offers more significant and impactful career transition support enabled by new faculty hires and driven by increasing completion rates and booming regional economies
- Hosted advising clinics at the beginning of each semester to allow faculty and department members to better meet individual student needs.
- Improved relationships and improved services and enrollment at all of the regional campuses.

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- Department offers more significant and impactful career transition support enabled by new faculty hires and driven by increasing completion rates and booming regional economies
- Hosted advising clinics at the beginning of each semester to allow faculty and department members to better meet individual student needs.
- Improved relationships and improved services and enrollment at all of the regional campuses.

The BUS department and BUS AAS programs have been succeeding at a high rate and showing significant gains in most performance measures in recent years despite woeful full-time faculty strength levels. Building renovations and continuous course rewrites during Spring 2025 should help in meeting the PLOs and overall student success rates. At this point, program faculty are displaced throughout different buildings on campus. This creates a challenge to collaborate with other program faculty. Unfortunately, the story of this program and our performance is not entirely pretty.

The combination of inadequate full-time faculty strength levels, instability/turnover in the different positions key campus positions, and the double-edged blessing and challenge of soaring enrollments have contributed to and exposed some program deficiencies. Tremendous contributions from a strong team of adjunct faculty that not only taught courses well but even developed numerous, high quality model courses and supported department service and support requirements when we had no other resources to do so. Adjunct faculty have taught 50% or more of all BUS sections for the last three years and helped us provide our students the access and learning modalities they needed to succeed.

Despite being woefully under-resourced, Business enrollment growth has far outpaced overall college enrollment growth over the last five years (by more than 700%). The department is now moving in the right direction with slow but steady movements toward the faculty levels needed to achieve the excellence and outcomes that students, faculty members, and supported communities deserve. In part inspired by its resource challenges, the department has recently implemented numerous improvements that are sure to make BUS AAS programs even more successful and impactful and drive enrollments, retention rates, and completion rates ever higher.

Actions currently being implemented that are sure to boost positive momentum include:

- Hiring a Full-Time faculty member to teach BUS courses in Cookeville – started Spring 2021
- Creating a, new Embedded Technical Certificates effective Fall 2024 in Hospitality Management.
- Hiring two additional full-time faculty members
- Continuing to focus on collaboration and teamwork with full-time advisors and developing advising tools and templates to help students develop good, achievable degree plans regardless of the pace at which they progress (full-time or part-time).
- Initiating new outreach efforts to improve alignment and teamwork with feeder school systems, TCATs, job centers, and employers in our service area.
- Department offers more significant and impactful career transition support enabled by new faculty hires and driven by increasing completion rates and booming regional economies
- Hosting advising clinics at the beginning of each semester to allow faculty and department members to better meet individual student needs.
- Better relationships and improved services and enrollment at all of the regional campuses.

Evidence:

- Business Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1
- Business- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

Students completing end-of-course surveys have generally reported strong satisfaction with BUS AAS courses. Overall student satisfaction survey data continues to match student retention and satisfaction with the program and staff. Student engagement office tracks employment satisfaction as well as student satisfaction survey data.

There are no changes to PLO from the initial APR.

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline**	Baseline Data
1	Apply Business and Management Knowledge through employability of skills	Increase employer hiring satisfaction survey rate of BUS AAS graduates	Programs Faculty BUS AAS Department	36% of employers are responding to surveys as of 2019	2025 to 2026	Increase response rate to 50% or higher by 2026
2	Demonstrate a basic understanding of the American Free Enterprise System	Increase Student survey responses on application of BUS AAS courses to program and jobs in the industry	Program faculty	Student survey response rate is at 30 to 40% of those enrolled in classes	2025 to 2026	Increase student survey rates to 60% of those enrolled in courses.
3	Implement a Tutoring Program through Tutor.com for students taking accounting classes. PLO 5 (SL)	Improve Student Success Rate in the Accounting 1010 and 1020 classes and improve exam scores	Program Faculty Tutor.com	Increase in student usage of Tutor.com for accounting.	2025-2026	

4	Implement Team Room Space Activities through in class and online classroom modalities PLO 1 (SL)	Improve student team based, problem/case study based skills in BUS 1305 and BUS1330 revisions/development	Program Faculty www.persusail.com	Rubrics will be created for BUS 1330 and BUS 1305 Team Room activity	2025-2026	
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Students completing end-of-course surveys have generally reported strong satisfaction with BUS AAS courses. However, there was some decline in satisfaction with some BUS AAS courses after the college shifted rapidly to fully online learning in Spring 2020 and taught online again in Fall 2020. Declines were most significant with courses for which we did not have a model course already developed and with sections taught by faculty members who were less experienced in online learning and less familiar with the college's learning management system.

The BUS AAS program is prioritizing efforts to develop model courses for all courses required for a Business AAS degree. As of Summer 2020, 60% of Distributed Education's AY 2020-2021 budget was obligated for Business and Technology Division courses. The pace of these development efforts is constrained by the limited number of Full-Time faculty authorizations but the department and division are prioritizing this work, highly.

The Department is also working to make course design and development efforts more collaborative so more faculty will use the model courses as the foundation of what they teach – *particularly* for courses taught online.

Although 75-90% of students met PLOs annually, the three-year outcome for PLO 5 was not met, indicating a need for stronger, sustained support in applying accounting concepts. Implementing a Tutor.com tutoring program for accounting courses (ACCT 1010/1020) directly targets gaps in interpreting accounting data and applying it to business problems, strengthens foundational skills across delivery modalities (including high-enrollment and dual enrollment sections), and is expected to improve consistency and long-term PLO achievement.

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

There is no new budget initiatives as of Spring 2025

Much of the division budget concerns were met with revocation of building and hiring of new faculty members. I am not aware of any new budget concerns.

Department and College wide turnover will continue to hurt in meeting PLOs and overall student success. Positions in the BUS AAS programs are funded and are going through the hiring processes. Salary rates don't match industry rates at this point, and create a challenge in getting qualified faculty to either locate or relocate to the area. Several positions in the Department have gone vacant for around two years. An analysis of salaries throughout the campus is also underway.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

The mission of the program is aligned with the educational items in the institutional mission. This last sentence "The Business AAS program and certificates all for partnership and relationship with local businesses and communities" seems to have missing parts.

The PLO's seem to align with the division's mission, but they are not stated in the document, so I am not able to provide feedback on them.

From the presentation given in the committee meeting, the rational for the recommended changes seem appropriate and responsive to recognized deficiencies in the program.

There are several encouraging initiatives here. There is one repeated paragraph from Section 2. These initiatives seem appropriate for the division.

Mission- The Business AAS program and certificates all for partnership and relationship with local-**Does this sentence need to be adjusted?**

Under PLO1-5 an EXAM is discussed - **What is the exam and what topics does it cover that address your PLOs? Is this an updated exam versus the exam discussed in the prior sentence?**

Section 2B- **How do these bullet points speak to the manner in which you are using the data in table 2 to improve student learning outcomes?_**

- BUS AAS programs see enrollments continue to grow, spurred in part by soaring numbers of high school students enrolling in online, dual enrollment BUS A.A.S. courses
- Business faculty begin utilizing new Team Room spaces to enable more team-based, in-class, problems-/case study-based assignments.
- Department rolls out robust tutoring program for Accounting 1010 and 1020 courses

Section 3-

- succeeding at a high rate and showing- **What constitutes "succeeding at high rates and showing significant gains"? Tie this statement back to data that supports it.**
- Unfortunately, the story of this program and our performance is not entirely pretty. The combination of inadequate full-time faculty strength levels, instability/turnover in the different positions key campus positions, and the double-edged blessing and challenge of soaring enrollments have contributed to and exposed some program deficiencies.
Tremendous contributions from a strong team of adjunct faculty that not only taught courses well but even developed numerous, high quality model courses and supported department service and support requirements when we had no other resources to do so. Adjunct faculty have taught 50% or more of all BUS sections for the last three years and helped us provide our students the access and- **You have these statements listed in 2B. Do you mean to have the same content in two different places?**
- Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1- **What data came from your course evals?**

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The faculty appear to be engaged in reviewing this academic program. Outcomes data has been provided.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell.	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%	YES

	online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Administrative Professional Technology Technical Certificate

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The Administrative Professional Technology Technical Certificate prepares students to succeed in entry-level administrative support positions in practically any sector of the economy. Students will complete courses that align with popular industry certifications from Microsoft. Graduates also will develop the knowledge and confidence to adapt to workplace requirements of the future. Knowledge and skills gained in the program also provide students a strong foundation for further studies toward an Associate's degree.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
The mission of the Administrative Professional Technology Technical Certificate aligns with the institution's mission by preparing students for successful careers and meaningful civic	

participation in a global society.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

To ensure students are fulfilling the objective of ADMN 1311, they are required to complete a project utilizing various components of Word. Students are assessed on a rubric.

To ensure students are fulfilling the objective of BUSN 1302, they are required to complete a project assessing students on their typing capabilities. Students are assessed on a rubric.

BUSN 1302 Keyboarding with Word Processing
BUSN 1305 Introduction to Business
INFS 1010 Computer Applications

These three courses provide the framework for further study in the business technology. Keyboarding with word processing provides basic knowledge to enhance success in computer applications, necessary for additional study in business. Introduction to Business provides an overall look at the fundamentals of the business world. These three courses provide the foundation for future coursework.

ADMN 1311 Word Processing I
BUSN 1310 Business Communications
BUSN 1370 Spreadsheet Applications

The remaining nine hours toward the certificate provides deeper knowledge in coursework. For instance, ADMN 1311 provides advanced knowledge in word processing. BUSN 1310 Business Communication allows students to develop an understanding of proper verbal and written communication including resume completion and preparing for interviews. These skills assist in preparation for entering the job market. Finally, BUSN 1370 provides an overview of Microsoft Excel.

Evidence:

- ADMN 1311 Sam Capstone Project Rubric Detail 01-30-2024 102542
- ADMN, CERT. Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

1 The Administrative Professional Technology Technical Certificate is a newer certificate. Rubrics were created over the last year. Therefore, PLO data is not currently available. We will be collecting the data using Watermark through ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302. Data will be reviewed yearly to look at outcome trends. The next review cycle will include current and a deeper dive into the PLO outcome data.

Technology is here to stay. It is necessary to learn the current technology used in the office environment. Students will learn these technologies in this program. They will also learn to prepare documents found in the office environment such as emails, interoffice communication, Microsoft Office, instant messaging, virtual team meetings, slack, and more.

Students will learn Microsoft office and dive deeper into Word and Excel during this program. They will also become exposed to the most common components of a business such as marketing, accounting, finance, management, and human resources. Once students earn the certificate, they will be better equipped to use their skills in software applications, perform electronic and routine administrative office procedures, prepare documents found in an office environment, and have the ability make decisions and solve problems.

2.To improve student learning, course assignments/projects should include the most up to date technologies used in the business environment.
Assignments will also focus on application to real world problems.

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

The programs strengths can be measured by the course evaluations which are positive with a mean of 4.54 and 4.63.

The headcount for fall 2021 was 12 and fall 2022 was 20. This number could be increased by educating students on their ability to complete this certificate while pursuing their degree.

The skills obtained in the required coursework meet the needs of today's workforce.

Individuals with this certificate may be selected for a job over those who do not have the certificate. It also could lead to a promotion in the workplace.

A survey of students in this problem needs to be conducted to determine the increase in enrollment. To continue the programs growth, students need to be made aware of the existence of the certificate and its value. Faculty should promote the certificate in each of their classes.

Microsoft Office is used in this program which is widely used in the workplace.

Evidence:

- Administrative Professional Technology- Fact Sheet FA23
- Business Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Demonstrate the use of effective office communication. PLO 3 & PLO 1 (SL)	Provide relevant instruction to support their completion of the coursework.	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025	80% meet the outcome of a passing grade of 70%
					Students completed the Capstone Project Spring 2024	
2	Learning to adapt to changing technologies. PLO 1 (SL)	Provide relevant instruction in the areas of current and changing technologies in the workforce.	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025	
3	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of workplace strategies. PLO 4 (SL)		Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025	80% meet the outcome of a passing grade of 70%
					Students completed the Capstone Project Spring 2024	

4	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of technology updates. (SL)	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025 Students will complete the new assignment Spring 2026
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Summary

1. Because the program is new and PLO data are not yet available, the initiative directly responds to the identified data outcome, the need to collect meaningful baseline assessment data using newly developed rubrics in Watermark. By embedding effective office communication using current technologies into course assignments (ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302), the initiative ensures students actively demonstrate required software and communication skills, producing measurable evidence for future PLO trend analysis and continuous improvement while strengthening applied, job-ready learning.

2. Because PLO data are not yet available due to the program's newness and recently developed rubrics, this initiative responds directly to the data outcome by intentionally building adaptive technology skills into ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302. Focusing on learning to adapt to changing technologies ensures students repeatedly engage with updated tools and platforms, generating measurable assessment evidence in Watermark while strengthening students' ability to transfer skills to evolving workplace technologies.

3. Given that PLO data are not yet available due to the program's newness and recently developed rubrics, this initiative directly supports the data outcome by creating a structured, assessable assignment in ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302. Requiring students to illustrate their knowledge of workplace strategies provides measurable evidence in Watermark, supports baseline data collection, and strengthens students' applied decision-making and problem-solving skills in realistic workplace contexts.

4. Because the program is new and PLO data are not yet available, this initiative directly addresses the data outcome by creating an assessable assignment focused on current technology updates in ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302. The assignment generates baseline evidence in Watermark while strengthening students' awareness of evolving office technologies and their ability to apply updated software tools in real-world workplace settings.

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

N/A

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Feedback:

The student success initiative for student learning outcome 1 is a little vague. I don't know that the term "workplace strategies" is clear enough to connect to the learning outcome about effective office communication. \

Demonstrate the use of effective office communication.	Provide relevant instruction to support their completion of the coursework.	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025	
2	Learning to adapt to changing technologies.	Provide relevant instruction in the areas of current and changing technologies in the workforce.	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025
3	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of workplace strategies.		Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025
4	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of technology updates.		Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025

The initiatives reflect student learning from specific assignments. I think a rubric should be used to measure student learning for each of the assignments/ initiatives listed. What determines a passing grade is it a 70% or better or are you looking for a higher pass rate 80-85%? Are the assignments already created or will they need to be created? what would the timeline be for creating the assignment and rubrics? Which courses will the Initiatives be measured?

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

As a newer certificate, there does not look to be a significant amount of data or evidence submitted yet. I will continue to look for more detail as faculty add evidence.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Demonstrate the use of effective office communication (SL)	Students complete the capstone assignment			
2	Learning to adapt to changing technologies (SL)				
3	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of effective workplace strategies (SL)	Students complete the capstone assignment			
4	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of technology updates (SL)				

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of	YES

	resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		pilot sections was 86%	
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
	EX. Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Entrepreneurship Technical CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The Entrepreneurship Technical Certificate provides students with the key, foundational business knowledge and skills needed to effectively manage their own small business or support the goals and success of an employer's small business. The knowledge and skills developed in this program are also highly applicable to a broad range of business positions with diverse employers in virtually every sector of the economy. Student learning in this program can also provide a strong foundation for continued studies in pursuit of an associate degree or beyond.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
The Entrepreneurship Certificate Program at Vol State explores strategies necessary to start and operate a business. Entrepreneurs create new businesses that can create jobs and stimulate the economy. Entrepreneurs develop new products and offer services that can improve the lives of the community in which they operate and impact. Small business entrepreneurs are often involved in philanthropy and volunteering within their communities. Starting a new venture requires an entrepreneur to create internal jobs and develop community relationships by utilizing assets and resources. Dedicated entrepreneurs have the ability to create wealth for themselves, their employees, and stimulates the economy in which they operate. The Entrepreneurship Certificate program aligns with the Volunteer State Community College mission by building partnerships, economic development, strengthening internal and	

external community engagement in an effort to prepare students for successful careers, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

Evidence:

- ACCT AAS learning outcomes
- BUSN AAS learning outcomes
- Entre Cert Mission Statement

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Students are required to successfully complete 6 courses to meet the Entrepreneurship Certificate requirements. Each course of study prepares students to effectively open and operate a small business. Each of these courses supports the college, department, and program's mission and objectives.

ACCT 1010 - Principles of Accounting This course covers basic principles and procedures of accounting in accordance with GAAP. Determination of net and income, valuation of assets and liabilities, introduction to internal control and accounting information systems are emphasized.

BUSN 1305 - Introduction to Business This course introduces the business environment. Topics may include business ownership and organization, management, marketing, business ethics, accounting, economics, finance, and business careers.

BUSN 1330 - Entrepreneurship This course explores the strategies necessary to start and operate a business. Topics may include development of a business plan and strategies in marketing, management, finance, accounting, customer service and operations.

BUSN 2300 - Business Ethics This course is an introduction to basic ethical theories and value systems. Topics include application of these perspectives including moral issues, problems, and situations which arise within the business environment. Topics include codes of ethics, conflict of interest, social responsibility, the work ethic, and fiduciary responsibilities.

BUSN 2380 - Principles of Marketing This course is a study of basic marketing principles and practices, including the selection of target markets and the development of the marketing mix (product, price, promotion, and place of distribution).

INFS 1010 - Computer Applications Computer Applications is an examination of the development of computing technology and terminology. Topics include identification of the functional components of a computer system; using word processing, spreadsheet, and presentation graphics; the proper handling of computer media; and an exploration of the uses of electronic mail and graphical Internet.

The BUSN 1330 Entrepreneurship class has a semester project requiring students to prepare a business plan for their current or future business. Coupled with the ACCT 1010 Principles of Accounting's Comprehensive Problem, students will be prepared to request capital investments, forecast marketing and financial needs, and successfully lead and operate a business of multiple size and industries.

Evidence:

- ENT, CERT. Assessment Plan - old
- Entre Cert Assessment Plan - new
- Entre Cert recommended schedule

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			79.25%	20.75%	96.08%	3.92%	
PLO 2			88.37%	11.63%	98.04%	1.96%	
PLO 3			88.37%	11.63%	96.08%	3.92%	
PLO 4			88.37%	11.63%	97.06%	2.94%	
PLO 5			79.25%	20.75%	96.08%	3.92%	
Course Learning Outcome							
Course Learning Outcome							
Course Learning Outcome							

1. Analysis of trends

Program learning outcomes were not available for 2020. PLOs were assessed in 2021 and found that approximately 85% were met. The average of the program learning outcomes for 2022 increased by 12% to 97% met. The rubric used to evaluate student learning outcomes does not currently reflect the program or course objectives. The Entrepreneurship certificate only has one academic program assessment used to evaluate student achievement. The criteria reported in the rubric is incomplete and does not provide an accurate evaluation.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

The BUSN 1330 Entrepreneurship class is currently being revised to include an updated version of the business plan course assessment. Student learning outcomes are being evaluated and modified to better reflect the course and program initiatives. Course and project updates will focus on realistic methods and opportunities for the potential small business owner.

The academic program review uncovered the need for additional assessments to ensure the certification learning outcomes have been met. The ACCT 1010 Principles of Accounting class includes a comprehensive problem as their course assessment project, and the ACCT 1010 class is a requirement for the certificate. The overlapping learning objectives support the Entrepreneurship Certificate program initiatives and will be used to assess student learning in future.

Evidence:

- ACCT1010 CLO's Standards and Outcomes Report 2-21-2024
- ACCT1010 Comprehensive Problem Rubric- Outcomes Report 01-31-2024
- BUSN1330 Entrepreneurship CLO_s AY21-23
- Entrepreneurship TC - PLO's by Gender AY21-23 Report 01-31-2024
- Entrepreneurship TC PLO's Pell and First Gen AY21-23 Report 01-31-2024
- Entrepreneurship TC Program Learning Outcomes AY21-23 Report 01-31-2024

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.

The BUSN 1330 Entrepreneurship course evaluations were positive, indicating students' desire to incorporate more technology into the certification program. Students' responses also displayed their appreciation for clear expectations regarding assignments, attendance, exams, and grade scales set in the syllabus. Although there were 48 certificate recipients in 2022 there were only 14 formally enrolled in the program. Historically, students earn the certificate while pursuing their business degree.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

The overall number of students could be increased with additional marketing to students focusing on other business certifications or degrees and students concentrating on other majors. Entrepreneurs open and operate their own business in a variety of trades. Whether you become a welder, hairdresser, electrician, or fitness trainer, the skills and knowledge learned when pursuing the Entrepreneurship certification are vital to the success of any business.

Evidence:

- Business Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1 (1)
- Entrepreneurship -Fact Sheet

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Students will complete a business plan to understand the commitment required to own and operate a business. The rubric and assignment will be revised and updated. PLO 1 (SL)	Demonstrate the understanding of student initiative, self-direction, productivity, and accountability skills necessary to maintain their own business or effectively support the small business of an employer.	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Learning - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Revised Entrepreneurship course offered	
2	Students will complete an accounting problem to demonstrate knowledge of financial reports. The accounting assessment will be added to the certificate. PLO 2 (SL)	Prepare annual financial reports for the business to communicate reliable economic information about the company to various stakeholders	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Learning - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – include the comprehensive accounting problem as a measure	
3	Revise the Entrepreneurship Course PLO 3	Successful completion of the Entrepreneurship course objectives and certificate	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Success - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Revised Entrepreneurship course offered	
4	Informing business and other student majors of the certificate availability	Improve enrollment numbers by informing students of the Entrepreneurship certificate during advising, enrollment, and special activities.	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Success - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Recruiting, advising, and student activities	

Evidence:

- Entre Cert initiatives

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Academic Program Review

1. Mission Statement Alignment
 1. Building partnerships, economic development, strengthening community engagement, etc.
2. Curriculum and Student Learning
 1. 6 required courses, each aligns to college and dept. mission and objectives while preparing students to open and operate a small business.
 2. Evidence: Only one assessment is conducted to measure student achievement and SLOs are being evaluated on rubric that does not reflect current objectives.
 1. Significant increase in PLO values from 2021-2022.
 2. Already revising BUSN 1330 to reflect course assessment, SLOs being evaluated and modified. Determined need for additional assessments.
3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information
 1. Strengths: positive course evals, clear expectations. Opportunities: more technology in program, formal enrollment of students in program before certificate earned.
 2. Additional marketing to get students enrolled.
4. Improvement Initiatives.
 1. Specific PLOs listed, each with objective of completing Ent. Certificate
 2. No budget needs listed.

Overall Comments, Suggestions, or Recommendations

The review mentions the need for additional assessments to be implemented. Have faculty identified which courses this might happen in, or can they provide any further information regarding this idea? How does enrollment in the program contribute to student success? Yes, these skills are vital to success of business, but is this the “student success” that this question asks (typically, retention, graduation rates, etc)?

The initiatives listed all seem to be a repeat of specific PLOs for the courses. Are there specific ideas for how to achieve those goals? For instance, initiative 4 states that “Students will complete a business plan” and the parties responsible for this initiative are business/technology faculty. How will students complete the plan? Was there an issue with students not completing the plan previously, so this

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

Assessment of the entrepreneurship certificate looks to be well underway and the faculty are focused on continuous improvement.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)	Timeline	YEAR 2 PROGRESS
Students will complete a business plan to understand the commitment required to own and operate a business. The rubric and assignment will be revised and updated	Demonstrate the understanding of student initiative, self-direction, productivity, and accountability skills necessary to maintain their own business or effectively support the small business of an employer.	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Learning - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Revised Entrepreneurship course offered	REVISED ENTREPRENEURSHIP COURSE WAS DEVELOPED AND IS BEING OFFERED SPRING OF 2025. PLO ACHIEVEMENTS WILL BE AVAILABLE FOR YEAR 3 PROGRESS
Students will complete an accounting problem to demonstrate knowledge of financial reports. The accounting assessment will be added to the certificate.	Prepare annual financial reports for the business to communicate reliable economic information about the company to various stakeholders	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Learning - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – include the comprehensive accounting problem as a requirement to earn the certificate	RUBRIC RESULTS BY ELEMENT ATTACHED. IMPROVEMENT FROM 2023-24 TO FALL 2024 WAS SEEN FOR 5 OF 7 ELEMENTS MEASURED
Revise the Entrepreneurship Course	Successful completion of the Entrepreneurship course objectives and certificate	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Success - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Revised Entrepreneurship course offered	REVISED ENTREPRENEURSHIP COURSE WAS DEVELOPED AND IS BEING OFFERED SPRING OF 2025. PLO ACHIEVEMENTS WILL BE AVAILABLE FOR YEAR 3 PROGRESS
Informing business and other student majors of the certificate availability	Improve enrollment numbers	Business and Technology Advisors	Student Success - Increase PLO achievement	Increase number of student certificates of completion	FALL GRADUATION NUMBERS INCREASED FROM 2023 AND 2024 BUT SPRING DATA IS UNAVAILABLE AT

					THIS TIME. SEE DATA TABLE BELOW
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	21-22	22-23	23-24	24-25
Entrepreneurship TC (Standalone)	14 Students	9 Students	12 Students	16 Students
Business AAS (Management) that also got the Entrepreneurship TC and the Entrepreneurship TC Standalone students Combined	22 Students	58 Students	62 Students	16 Students (missing Spring Graduates)

Evidence:

- ACCT 1010 Rubric Report 2021-2024

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student	Will there be any further action taken on this	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?

		learning or student success?	initiative? If yes, explain.	
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Diagnostic Medical Sonography CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The Diagnostic Medical Sonography program's mission is to prepare competent entry-level general sonographers in the cognitive (knowledge), psychomotor (skills), and affective (behavior) learning domains. This includes equipping students to: 1. Demonstrate knowledge in appropriate didactic areas. 2. Integrate knowledge into competency-based clinical experience. 3. Apply skills to meet the standards of the profession. 4. Analyze clinical data. 5. Write effectively in more than one format as part of the writing across the professional curriculum initiative. 6. Provide excellent quality care to enrich and support the community through active engagement. 7. Engage and maintain personal professional relationships. This program provides students with the opportunity to develop the technical knowledge and personal skills necessary for a career in the sonographic sciences. The curriculum is designed to combine compassion with integrity in order to shape a student into a skilled professional.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	

The missions of the program aligns with the mission of the institution in several key ways. First, both statements have a focus on the importance of delivering high quality educational experiences. The VSCC DMS program directly contributes to this by preparing competent entry-level sonographers with a focus on cognitive, psychomotor, and effective learning domains, mirroring VSCC's commitment to quality and innovation. Second, VSCC's emphasis on building partnerships and community engagement is reflected in the programs objective to enrich and support the community through excellent quality care and active engagement. The program also contributes to the institution's focus on diversity and cultural awareness by preparing students to provide care in a diverse community setting. This promotes cultural sensitivity and understanding through professional practice. Next, the institution strives to prepare students for successful careers and meaningful civic participation while the DMS Program emphasizes integrating knowledge into competency-based clinical experiences and analyzing data that ensures the students are well prepared for professional roles in the medical community.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

As a program that has a didactic section as well as a scanning element, it is imperative that the students are taught the significance in implementing their didactic course material into the clinical component. The rationale behind what the program views as of the most important aspects of the rubrics used as evidence are highlighted below:

Template and Formatting

Consistency in following a paper template and formatting is essential for maintaining professionalism and ease of reading. Exceptional and Accomplished categories indicate a high ability to adhere to these standards, reflecting the student's attention to detail and organizational skills. Lower scores in this category indicate the need for improvement in these areas, which are crucial for academic and professional success.

Accuracy

Summarizing paper sections accurately is crucial for showing comprehension and effectively communicating complex information briefly. High scores in this area reflect a student's comprehension and effective communication skills. Lower scores indicate misunderstandings of the material.

Grammar

The presence of grammatical and punctuation errors can diminish the clarity of written work. Achieving high scores for minimal errors reflects the student's proficiency in writing and editing, important skills in any professional field.

References

Proper citation of references is a cornerstone of academic integrity. High scores in this area demonstrate a student's commitment to acknowledging the work of others and providing a solid foundation for their arguments or findings.

Length and Timeliness

Adhering to deadlines is part of managing project requirements effectively. Appropriateness of length ensures depth without redundancy, and timeliness reflects the student's ability to plan and execute tasks efficiently.

Program Outcomes Alignment

The alignment of student performance with program outcomes (Met/Not Met) is a critical measure of the effectiveness of the educational program, and the student's readiness for professional practice. High performance across the rubric elements suggests that the student is well-prepared to meet the demands of their professional field.

Evidence:

- SONO, CERT Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%			
PLO 2			100%	0%			
PLO 3			100%	0%			
PLO 4			100%	0%			
PLO 5			100%	0%			
PLO 6			100%	0%			
PLO 7			100%	0%			
Course Learning Outcome TAB.2			100%	0%			
Course Learning Outcome TAB.3			100%	0%			
Course Learning Outcome TAB.4			100%	0%			

Course Learning Outcomes SONO2036C Clinical Education 4 TAB.2 Evaluations TAB.3 Clinical Education TAB.4 Competencies

1. Analysis of trends

Data is missing from the 2020 year due to changes in education influenced by the pandemic. Data is also missing from the year 2022 due to the previous program director leaving their position. The data for 2020 and 2022 outcomes is not explicitly provided, making it impossible to analyze trends over the three years directly from the given dataset. However, the data compiled from 2021 indicated exceptional performance across all outcomes measured for that year. Which suggests the program met its educational goals and objectives.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Given the success, the program should focus on how to enhance the curriculum with additional hands-on learning opportunities, real-world case studies, or incorporate technology to further develop the students' skills. While the 100% "Met" rate is indicative of outstanding performance, consistent evaluations are important to sustaining this success. By focusing on areas such as curriculum development, faculty support, student engagement, and evaluation assessments, the program can not only maintain its high standards but also adapt to meet the standards and practices of the continuously evolving imaging community.

Evidence:

- Diagnostic Medical SONO TC PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-22
- Diagnostic Medical Sonography PLOs AY21-23
- Diagnostic Medical Sonography PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-22
- Diagnostic Medical Sonography TC PLOs Gender AY21-22
- SONO 2036C SLOs AY21-22

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

According to the data provided using surveys and fact sheets, the VSCC DMS Program's area of strengths are as follows:

1. **High Levels of Instructor Preparation and Content Availability:** Across all semesters, students consistently rated the instructor's preparation and content availability highly, with means close to 5. This suggests that instructors are well-prepared and make learning materials accessible, a critical factor in student success.
2. **Adherence to Course Policies:** Students felt that instructors followed the course syllabus policies strictly, especially noted in the Fall 2022 evaluations with a mean score of 4.96. This demonstrates a clear communication of expectations and consistency in course management.
3. **Timely Feedback:** The provision of graded assignments and feedback in a timely manner was also a strong point, particularly in the Spring 2023 semester with a mean score of 4.83. Timely feedback is essential for student learning and adjustment throughout the course.
4. **Instructor Accessibility:** Students rated instructor accessibility highly across semesters, indicating that instructors were available through various communication channels as promised in the syllabus.
5. **Encouragement of Engagement and Discussion:** The data shows that instructors were successful in creating an environment conducive to questions and discussions, facilitating a more interactive and engaging learning experience

Overall, The program shows a strong performance in instructor preparedness, adherence to policies, timely feedback, accessibility, and fostering an engaging learning environment.

Based on the same data, areas of opportunity for the program are the following:

1. **Feedback and Progress Monitoring in Spring 2022:** The Spring 2022 semester saw a dip in the score for feedback and progress monitoring (mean of 4.47), indicating that some students felt less satisfied with the timeliness or quality of feedback during this period. Improving on this aspect could enhance learning outcomes and student satisfaction.
2. **Consistency in Engagement and Discussion:** While still rated highly, the instructor's ability to engage students in discussion had slightly lower scores in some semesters. Enhancing strategies to encourage all students to participate in discussions could improve learning experiences.
3. **Application of Concepts through Assignments:** During certain semesters, students noted a minor decline in how assignments related to and applied the concepts taught in the course. By making sure assignments closely align with and support the course content and skills, the effectiveness of learning can be improved.
4. **Focusing on Feedback:** Focusing on consistent, quality feedback and enhancing student engagement and the practical application of concepts in assignments can further improve the program.

Evidence:

- Diagnostic Medical Sonography- Fact Sheet FA23
- SONO Student Course Evals AY20-23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline**	Baseline Data
1	Change format and class style of the Intro to Sonography Course PLO 2 (SL)	To better prepare the students for their clinical setting, the program hopes to make the Intro to Sonography Course a hybrid course that will have online elements as well as in person demonstrations. The class is currently completely in person.	Program Faculty, specifically the program director and the clinical coordinator.	Completion of Intro material (quizzes and tests) by week 6 of the fall semester. This would allow more time for important demonstrations that are needed to be completed before the beginning of the clinical rotations.	Fall 2025	Feedback from students and clinical sites for the last two years stating that the demonstrations that occur in the Intro to Sonography course would be useful before rotations begin.
2	Providing an Edelman's Conference for board review PLO 7 (SL)	Provide student's with an additional board review resource paid for by the program, to further prepare them to pass the abdomen board that they are expected to take before graduation.	Program Faculty, specifically the program director or the clinical coordinator.	Historically, one person per cohort fails the abdominal board exam on the first attempt. This objective could improve the first time pass rate to 100%.	Fall 2024	For at least the last 7 years, one person per cohort has failed the abdomen board on their first attempt. This data can be found in the ARDMS School Reports.
3	Editing lab protocols PLO 3 (SL)	To more accurately reflect what is expected from a new graduate sonographer in the clinical setting performing an exam.	Lab instructors	The ability for 75% of students to accurately and diagnostically complete lab protocols defined by the images listed as well as finishing in the required time limit.	Spring 2024	Clinical and employer evaluations stating that new graduate sonographers from this program, are performing at a slower than acceptable rate.
4	Implementing a skill out PLO 3 (SL)	To assess the students on all abdominal and obstetrics/	Program director and clinical coordinator	The ability for 75% of students to complete multiple abdominal and obstetric/gynecological	Fall 2024	Evaluations from employers of program

		gynecological exams that have been taught through the duration of the 16 month program.		diagnostic ultrasound exams at the level of a registered sonographer by graduation.		graduates have indicated a desire for the program to implement a skill out before graduation, so that the program can evaluate one last time if the students are ready to work in the medical imaging field.
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4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

The ultrasound machines in the DMS program lab need an update. Two of the six machines currently on rotation in the laboratory are dated, perform slowly, and produce poor image quality. For our students to be successful in the clinical setting while in the program, as well as being successful sonographers after graduation - the program needs new machines to stay up to date with imaging departments in the community.

Along with machines, the program would benefit greatly from at least one more 3D ultrasound probe. This probe can be used for more than its' obvious obstetrical benefits but would assist us in teaching our students a skill that is usually only learned on the job, making them more marketable after graduation.

Item	Cost	Units
GE Logiq e10	\$81,000	1
GE RAB2-5-D 3D/4D Probe	\$4,500	1
Total Monies	\$85,500	

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Section 1

Program mission aligns well with the College mission. The focus is on high-quality education and service to the healthcare community.

Section 2

2B. Lack of data and sufficient explanation

#2 Adding verbiage delineating the specific evaluation tools used (employer, graduate, course surveys) would assist in reviewing accurate assessments.

Section 3

Using employer and graduate survey results would strengthen the evidence of student success overall. These surveys would demonstrate the strength of program outcomes using feedback that encompasses both clinical

and didactic skills/knowledge.

Section 4

4A

Initiative #3 “Editing Lab protocols” - Is there a baseline for 75% goal to be compared to? Adjust the information in the “Performance Indicators” and “Baseline” columns. Performance Indicator column could say something similar to, “Clinical and employer evaluations will be used to assess whether students can accurately, and diagnostically complete lab protocols as defined by the images listed, while meeting a set time limit”. The “Baseline” column can say something similar to, “Clinical and employer surveys report 20%(?) of new graduate sonographers from the program are performing at a slower than acceptable rate”.

Initiative #4 Performance Initiatives: What tool will be used to determine if a student “completes an exam at the level of a registered sonographer? Is there a scoring rubric for this?

4B

Can course fees be used for new equipment? Can the new machines requested be tied back into 4A initiative #3. Does the cost table need to be updated to reflect the cost of the 2 machines? Can the need for 1 more 3D ultrasound probe be tied into a listed initiative?

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Diagnostic Medical Sonography program supports the mission of the institution by producing providing a high-quality innovative program that prepares students for successful careers. The program is competitive with more applicants than seats available. Graduates have a 100% job placement rate and easily pass the national board examinations. It has an engaged and supportive Advisory Committee. The program faculty, Lisa Kirkland, Program Director, and Sami Brooks have nurtured and developed relationships with stakeholders in a variety of our service areas. The information in this document does not completely reflect a thorough review. I noted the following,

- The assessment plan narrative does not identify the PLO being assessed. I do see the details in the attached SONO, Cert Assessment Tool.
- The outcomes in section 2B were excellent according to the data provided for 2021. To add to the comment from the IA Committee, in the narrative, provide more details about what specifically is being assessed and connect it to the educational goals and objectives.
- The feedback shared in Section 3 appears to come from course evaluations. If that is the case, the assessed areas were rated highly by the students since a 5.0 represents "strongly agree". In the future, identify the types of surveys used to make the comments more meaningful to the reader. The faculty is expending effort towards focusing on the lower-rated areas although they were still well above satisfactory to improve student success. I support assessing and also including Graduate and Employer Survey results in this section as recommended by the IA committee.
- The faculty and dean will work together to find funding sources for updated ultrasound machines and probes. The SONO program's budget and the Health Science course fees do not support the purchase of expensive items such as an \$81k ultrasound machine. Potential sources of funding include TAF, grants, and the institution's R & R fund.

In summary, although I do not get a solid sense of the program through the APR, I believe with additional training in the particulars of filling out the document, a review of SMART goals, up-to-date data, and adequate time to complete the report, future reports will be more informative. The information that was provided did reflect excellence in those areas.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Change format and class style of the Intro to Sonography Course PLO 2	Contact made to upper division for guidance on course development.	Changes in Program Director/leadership. Unaware of Catalog timeline.	no changes	Currently no progress. The baseline data remains the same until the course can be changed and new feedback can be obtained.
2	Providing an Edelman's Conference for board review PLO 7	New contract made with URR (ultrasound registry review) for purchase in multiple modalities	No challenges	Summer 2025	For at least the last 7 years, one person per cohort has failed the abdomen board on their first attempt. This data can be found in the ARDMS School Reports. Cohort of 2024 had 100% pass rate with using URR material in mock board questions
3	Editing lab protocols PLO 3	Lab protocols have been updated for all abdomen and OB courses	No challenges for abdomen or OB.	Spring 2024	Clinical sites have had positive reviews on site visit made by the Clinical Coordinator that have stated increased scanning time and proficiency in at least 75% of the cohort.
4	Implementing a skill out PLO 3	An outline has been created for a dual grade in mock job interviews as well as a "scan interview"	Program Director and clinical coordinator	Fall 2025	progress indicator will remain the same and will be reviewed once again with the employer surveys that are due within 6mo-

				12mo post hire date of the graduating cohort.
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Close

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Emergency Medical Technician CERT: Basic, Advanced, Accelerated Advanced

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

BASIC

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution? "At Volunteer State Community College, the Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program is dedicated to upholding the institution's commitment to quality, innovation, and comprehensive education. Rooted in Vol State's ethos of building partnerships and fostering community engagement, the EMS Program strives to provide exemplary training and support to aspiring emergency medical professionals. Our mission is to equip students with the knowledge, skills, and values essential for successful careers in emergency medical services. Through cutting-edge educational programs, the EMS Program aims to cultivate a cadre of dedicated and compassionate healthcare providers who embody the core principles of professionalism, integrity, and excellence. Moreover, we instill a sense of civic responsibility, inspiring our graduates to actively engage in meaningful community participation and contribute to the betterment of society. Volunteer States Community Colleges EMS Program Mission Statement aligns with the colleges because both emphasize providing quality education, fostering community engagement, promoting core values, and encouraging meaningful civic participation among students.	

ADVANCED

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness,

and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

"At Volunteer State Community College, the Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program is dedicated to upholding the institution's commitment to quality, innovation, and comprehensive education. Rooted in Vol State's ethos of building partnerships and fostering community engagement, the EMS Program strives to provide exemplary training and support to aspiring emergency medical professionals.

Our mission is to equip students with the knowledge, skills, and values essential for successful careers in emergency medical services. Through cutting-edge educational programs, the EMS Program aims to cultivate a cadre of dedicated and compassionate healthcare providers who embody the core principles of professionalism, integrity, and excellence. Moreover, we instill a sense of civic responsibility, inspiring our graduates to actively engage in meaningful community participation and contribute to the betterment of society.

Volunteer States Community Colleges EMS Program Mission Statement aligns with the colleges because both emphasize providing quality education, fostering community engagement, promoting core values, and encouraging meaningful civic participation among students.

ACCELERATED

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

"At Volunteer State Community College, the Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program is dedicated to upholding the institution's commitment to quality, innovation, and comprehensive education. Rooted in Vol State's ethos of building partnerships and fostering community engagement, the EMS Program strives to provide exemplary training and support to aspiring emergency medical professionals.

Our mission is to equip students with the knowledge, skills, and values essential for successful careers in emergency medical services. Through cutting-edge educational programs, the EMS Program aims to cultivate a cadre of dedicated and compassionate healthcare providers who embody the core principles of professionalism, integrity, and excellence. Moreover, we instill a sense of civic responsibility, inspiring our graduates to actively engage in meaningful community participation and contribute to the betterment of society.

Volunteer States Community Colleges EMS Program Mission Statement aligns with the colleges because both emphasize providing quality education, fostering community engagement, promoting core values, and encouraging meaningful civic participation among students.

Evidence:

- Vol State EMS Mission Statement

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Program Learning Outcomes and **Course Learning Outcomes** focus on students' ability to perform patient assessments, document medical histories, initiate basic interventions, demonstrate professional behavior, and understand operational roles in emergency care. **Assessment Methods** involve practical examinations and evaluations to measure students' competencies in these areas.

Achievement Targets are set to ensure that students meet or exceed the expected standards in their practical and theoretical knowledge.

Assessment Schedule outlines when these evaluations take place, ensuring a structured approach to student assessment throughout the academic year.

Assessment Rubric details the criteria for grading student performance, from exceeding expectations to not meeting the basic requirements.

The assessment plan's structure and content suggest a comprehensive approach to evaluating student outcomes, emphasizing both practical skills and professional behavior. This supports the program's goal of preparing students for the realities of emergency medical services as a profession by focusing on critical competencies and professional standards. The detailed rubric and assessment methods ensure that students are evaluated fairly and comprehensively, providing a clear pathway for achieving and demonstrating proficiency in key areas of EMS practice.

Evidence:

- AEMT, CERT Assessment Tool
- EMSB, CERT Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

BASIC

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			85.42%	14.58%	83.33%	16.67%	
PLO 2			85.42%	14.58%	83.33%	16.67%	
PLO 3			87.50%	12.50%	86.67%	13.33%	
PLO 4			89.58%	10.42%	83.33%	16.67%	
PLO 5			89.58%	10.42%	86.67%	13.33%	
PLO 6							
PLO 7							
Course Learning Outcome PG.1			85.41%	14.58%	86.66%	13.33%	
Course Learning Outcome PG.2			87.50%	12.50%	76.66%	13.33%	
Course Learning Outcome PG.5			85.41%	14.58%	83.33%	16.67%	

Course Learning Outcomes/Goals: PG.5 Trauma PG.2 Cardiac Management PG.1 Medical Diabetic

1. Analysis of trends

Over the length of the data, there's a slight fluctuation in the percentage of students meeting Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes. Most PLOs show a small decrease in the percentage of students meeting the outcomes from 2020 to 2021, indicating a need to address specific areas for improvement. However, the consistency in meeting outcomes for CLOs related to Medical Diabetic, Cardiac Management, and Trauma suggests a stable understanding in these critical areas.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

To improve student learning, targeted interventions in areas showing declines or lower performance can be beneficial. This could include:

Enhanced hands-on training or simulation exercises, particularly in areas where students are not meeting outcomes.

Additional tutoring sessions or workshops focused on weaker areas as indicated by the data. Implementing peer mentoring programs where students who excel in certain areas can assist those who are struggling, fostering a collaborative learning environment.

ADVANCED

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			85.71%	4.29%	100%	0%	
PLO 2			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
PLO 3			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
PLO 4			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
PLO 5			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
PLO 6			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome PG.3			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	

Course Learning Outcome PG.5			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome PG.10			94.29%	5.71%	100%	0%	

Course Learning Outcome Peer Goals: PG.3 Medical Medication Administration PG.5 Medical Pediatric PG.10 Trauma Assessment

1. Analysis of trends

The data for the Advanced program shows a remarkable improvement in student performance across all Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes from 2020 to 2021, with many reaching 100% achievement in 2021. This indicates a significant enhancement in the program's effectiveness and student learning, particularly in areas of Medical Medication Administration, Medical Pediatric, and Trauma Assessment.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Despite the excellent outcomes, continuous improvement is always a priority. Strategies to maintain and even improve these results could include:

Continuing education and professional development opportunities for instructors to stay updated with the latest EMS practices and teaching methodologies.

Implementing a feedback loop where students can provide insights on teaching methods and curriculum, ensuring that the program remains responsive to student needs and industry standards.

Considering the establishment of a mentorship program where high achieving EMS students can provide guidance, support, and tutoring for their classmates.

ACCELERATED will not report until Cycle 3

Evidence:

- EMSA _ AEMT Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23
- EMSB Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23
- EMT ACC PLOs AY21-23
- EMTA PLOs AY21-23
- EMTB PLO_s AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Analysis of enrollment data

Analysis for Basic EMT

Strengths:

- **High placement rate:** Compared to the number of graduates, the program seems to have a good placement rate for graduates (ranging from 76% to 99%).
- **Full-time enrollment:** In Fall 2022, all students were enrolled full-time, potentially indicating strong commitment and program structure.

- **Diverse student body:** The program represents a somewhat diverse range of students from multiple populations.

Areas of opportunity:

- **Declining enrollment:** Headcount has steadily decreased since Fall 2019, suggesting potential recruitment challenges.
- **Limited retention data:** Persistence data is missing, making it difficult to assess student retention within the program.
- **Declining diversity:** While there is some diversity, the number of students from multiple populations has been decreasing.

Ideas for improvement (based on limited data):

- **Investigate reasons for declining enrollment:** Conduct exit interviews with past students or focus groups with potential students to understand why enrollment is decreasing.
- **Implement targeted recruitment strategies:** Based on findings from the investigation, develop targeted campaigns to attract students from specific demographics or backgrounds.
- **Collect and analyze retention data:** Track student progress throughout the program to identify areas where students struggle and implement support systems.
- **Develop initiatives for multiple populations:** Partner with community organizations or offer targeted scholarships to attract students from underrepresented groups.
- **Review curriculum and support services:** Ensure the program remains relevant and addresses current industry needs. Offer additional support services, such as tutoring or academic coaching, to help students succeed.

For Advanced EMT

Strengths:

- **High placement rate:** The program boasts a consistently high placement rate for graduates, ranging from 93% to 102%. This indicates strong industry demand and successful job preparation.
- **Full-time enrollment:** Over the past two years, all students enrolled in the program were full-time, suggesting strong commitment and focus.
- **Diversity in age groups:** The student body represents a range of age groups, potentially increasing program appeal to various demographics.

Areas of opportunity:

- **Declining enrollment:** Headcount has steadily decreased since Fall 2019, potentially indicating recruitment challenges.
- **Limited retention data:** Persistence data is missing, making it difficult to assess student retention within the program.

Suggestions for improvement (based on limited data):

- **Investigate reasons for declining enrollment:** Conduct outreach or surveys to understand why enrollment is decreasing. Identify specific barriers potential students might face.
- **Implement targeted recruitment strategies:** Based on your findings, develop campaigns to attract students from various demographics or backgrounds. Utilize targeted marketing channels and partnerships.
- **Collect and analyze retention data:** Track student progress throughout the program to identify areas where students struggle and implement support systems (e.g., tutoring, academic coaching).
- **Promote initiatives for multiple populations:** Partner with community organizations or offer targeted scholarships to attract students.
- **Review curriculum and support services:** Ensure the program remains relevant and addresses current industry needs. Offer updated educational resources and consider incorporating technology-based learning strategies.

Both the Basic and Advanced outcomes reveal a concerning trend of decreasing enrollment. This phenomenon aligns with the implementation of service-based programs within our state. As I previously communicated to the college administration and TBR, I anticipated this potential outcome. Unfortunately, due to the legislative timeline, opportunities to directly influence the program's structure have already passed. Moving forward, we must adapt to the current environment while strategically planning for future modifications. As legislative

opportunities arise, we can advocate for changes that align with our institution's goals and support student success.

Evidence:

- EMT Student Course Evals AY20-23
- EMT TC Fact Sheet-2 FA23
- EMTA Fact Sheet -1 FA23
- EMTA Fact Sheet -2 FA23
- EMTB Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1					
Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)	Timeline	Baseline Data
Student Learning:					
Develop and implement a simulation activity focused on Trauma Assessment. PLO 1 (SL)	Enhance student proficiency in applying trauma assessment skills in a realistic scenario.	Program Director, Faculty	Increase Trauma Assessment average score to 70%. Increase student confidence in performing trauma assessments as measured by a self-assessment survey.	AY 2024-2025	Current Trauma Assessment average score: 62.29%.
Integrate peer review and feedback into Medical Assessment practice sessions (SL).	Improve students' peer-to-peer learning and critical thinking skills related to medical assessment.	Program Director, Faculty	Increase Medical Assessment average score to 70%. Increase student participation in peer review activities.	AY 2024-2025	Current Medical Assessment average score: 62.17%.
Student Success:					
Implement a student mentoring program connecting experienced EMT students with new students.	Facilitate peer support, improve academic navigation, and foster a sense of community.	Program Director and Student Mentors	Students express a satisfaction rate with program support services of 75%.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data on student satisfaction needed.
Offer workshops on time management and study skills specifically	Equip students with strategies to manage their workload and effectively	Program Director, Academic Success Center	Improve student performance on national registry exams by 5%.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data exam performance needed.

tailored to EMT students.	prepare for exams.				
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Evidence:

- Initiative Matrix APR 2024

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

No additional expenses are required.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Section 1

The EMS program mission aligns well with the college mission. It focuses on community engagement, partnerships, and high-quality education.

Section 2a

EMT Report:

- The assessment plan is not clearly articulated in this section of the report. We do not see what the PLO or CLOs are, what the identified targets are for each outcome, etc. We are assuming that information is present in the attachments that we do not have access to in this part of the review process. Additional access to information is needed for more elaborate feedback.

Paramedic Report:

- The narrative does not delineate the separate aspects of the assessment plan as clearly as EMT report does. We do not see what the PLO or CLOs are, what the identified targets are for each outcome, etc. Additional access to information is needed for more elaborate feedback.

Section 2b

- Both reports:
 1. No 2020 data provided. An explanation for the missing data is needed.
 2. Need explanation why the 3-year outcome result not indicated/reported.
 3. The CLOs listed under the table do not comprehensively relate to or explain the data in the PLO table. More information is needed for the reviewers to understand this information.
- Paramedic Report
 1. PLO 9, 12 are missing data (0% met/not met).
 2. The *Lab Practice Skills SLOs* comment related to the table comments is presumptuous. Identifying high performance in some areas should not lead to an assumption that there is automatically high performance in areas not assessed.

Sections 3-4

Excellent job outlining and describing the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.

Are there correlations between certain questions in the Course Evaluations or Employer Surveys that relate to and support the PLOs? We suggest triangulating data/results where possible.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The EMTB and AEMT programs support the mission of the institution by providing a high-quality, innovative program. They are led by Erik Jesse, Program Director, and he has a team of dedicated full-time and adjunct instructors. The programs are taught at the Cookeville, Springfield, and Gallatin locations. There is a supportive and engaged Advisory Committee. Graduates obtain gainful employment with EMS providers throughout the communities. They demonstrate effective learning by passing the National Registry examination higher than the national average. In reviewing the APR, I noted the following.

- The assessment plan does not identify the PLOs and SLOs being assessed in the narrative sections. I understand that the 2020 data was absent due to the ramifications of the pandemic and the changeover in the research personnel. To add to the comment from the IA Committee, in the narrative, provide more details about what specifically is being assessed and connect it to the educational goals and objectives. With the EMSA Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23 data, I note a significant decrease in the percentage of students who exceed each lab category. The EMSB Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23 contained data that waxed and waned in some areas in 2022- 2023 with 4 out of 7 outcomes exceeding 2021 - 2022. Were all outcomes assessed from students at one campus? Were their changes to the curriculum, teaching style, instructor, etc. that influenced student learning?
- In assessing the EMTB PLO's AY21-23 Report, there was not much variation between AY21-22 and AY22-23 in the data. Although, EMSB.TC.4, related to professional behavior, had a slight decrease and may be worth reviewing. The AY22-23 PLOs for the EMT ACC program are excellent at 100% in each category.
- One of the "Ideas for Improvement" in Section 3 is related to declining enrollment. Feedback from students could help identify barriers to enrollment and completion. EMTB student course evaluation submission has trended downward from 44% in 2021 to 19% in the Spring of 23. Faculty should make more concerted efforts to encourage students to complete course evaluations. Current students and stakeholders such as employers and graduates can provide valuable information about the program that may affect planned initiatives. An additional opportunity for growth is assessing the results of Graduate and Employer surveys.

In summary, I recommend a detailed analysis of the laboratory competency assessments, particularly for the AEMT course. Review the EMTB course as well as it did have several areas of improvement. Identifying differences between the way the courses are taught could be key. The review should include the faculty who teach the course as well as the director. Since the program is offered at three sites, is there a difference in competency level between Cookeville, Springfield, and Gallatin students or is the data from one location? The program has a sufficient budget to order equipment and supplies that can enhance student learning. I believe that additional training in completing the assessment section of the report and having adequate time to complete the APR, will be of benefit in future reports.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)	Timeline	Baseline Data	Response
Develop and implement a simulation activity focused on Trauma Assessment. PLO 1	Enhance student proficiency in applying trauma assessment skills in a realistic scenario.	Program Director, Faculty	(1) Increase Trauma Assessment average score to 70%. (2) Increase student confidence in performing trauma assessments as measured by a self-assessment survey.	AY 2024-2025	Current Trauma Assessment average score: 62.29%.	Data from the National Registry is no longer available. The Registry ceased tracking trauma assessment data in May of the previous year, concurrent with the implementation of the new examination. Consequently, comprehensive historical data is inaccessible, including detailed student performance metrics. Regarding the self-assessment survey, it is administered internally as part of the affective domain questionnaire. However, due to the absence of comparative historical data, analysis will be limited to internal trends.
Integrate peer review and feedback into Medical Assessment	Improve students' peer-to-peer learning and critical	Program Director, Faculty	(1) Increase Medical Assessment average score to 70%. (2)	AY 2024-2025	Current Medical Assessment average score: 62.17%.	Data from the National Registry is no longer available. Student

practice sessions. PLO 4	thinking skills related to medical assessment.		Increase student participation in peer review activities.			participation in peer review activities will be tracked using the lab software, which records peer interactions.
Implement a student mentoring program connecting experienced EMT students with new students.	Facilitate peer support, improve academic navigation, and foster a sense of community.	Program Director, Student Mentors	(1) Increase student satisfaction with program support services. (2) Reduce first-year student withdrawal rate.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data on student satisfaction and withdrawal rate is not available due to the program's recent initiation.	The peer-to-peer mentoring program was initiated in August 2024, with 16 students participating. Due to limitations in the available data, specifically the factbook not reporting data past 2021, a comprehensive comparison of first-year student withdrawal rates is not currently feasible. Student feedback has been solicited through a feedback form distributed to the initial participant group. Further data collection and analysis will continue to assess the program's impact.

Offer workshops on time management and study skills specifically tailored to EMT students.	Equip students with strategies to manage their workload and effectively prepare for exams.	Program Director, Academic Success Center	(1) Increase student self-reported time management skills. (2) Improve student performance on standardized exams.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline exam performance is currently at 70% on the National Registry exams. Performance needed.	Workshops have been offered in-house to all EMT students in an in-person format; however, there has been no participation to date. These workshops will continue to be offered throughout the reporting period. The impact of these workshops will be assessed by comparing the first-time pass rate on the National Registry exams to the overall class average. The appropriateness of adding time management training to orientation has been assessed and is deemed not suitable.
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6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress

	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

Evidence:

- Initiative for EMT AEMT

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Paramedic CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
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Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The sequencing of courses, gathered from the assessment detail, appears to be strategically designed to build upon foundational skills before advancing to more complex scenarios and technical competencies. This progression ensures that students develop a solid base of knowledge and skills, enhancing their confidence and competence in performing more intricate and challenging tasks as they progress through the program. The mapping of specific technical competencies (e.g., history taking, CPR for different age groups, EKG interpretation, medication administration) to assessment outcomes indicates a curriculum that is both comprehensive and aligned with real-world EMS demands.

Overall, the assessment plan demonstrates a thoughtful and systematic approach to evaluating student learning and competency in EMS practices. By closely aligning the assessment methods, schedules, and rubrics with the program's learning outcomes, it ensures that students are well-prepared for their future roles in emergency medical services, equipped with the necessary skills and knowledge to excel in their professional lives.

Evidence:

- PARA, CERT Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1	N/A		100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 3			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 4			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 6			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 7			98.75%	1.25%	100%	0%	
PLO 8			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 9			0%	0%	0%	0%	
PLO 10			100%	0%	97.5%	2.5%	
PLO 11			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 12			0%	0%	0%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome LP.2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome LP.4			100%	0%	97.5%	2.5%	
Course Learning Outcome LP.5			100%	0%	100%	0%	

Course Learning Outcomes Lab Practice SLO's LP.2 History Taking LP.3 Medical and Cardiac Assessment Scenario LP.5 Radio Transmission Scenario

1. Analysis of trends

Overall Performance Trends

- **Consistently High Performance:** The majority of PLOs and CLOs show a 100% success rate across the three years, indicating that all students met the outcomes. This suggests a high level of effectiveness in teaching and learning, with students consistently achieving the expected competencies.
- **Uniform Achievement:** The uniformity in achievement (100% met) across most outcomes highlights a program that is delivering consistent, high-quality education and effectively meeting its educational objectives.

Lab Practice Skills Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

- The summary mentions specific SLOs related to history taking, medical and cardiac assessment scenarios, and radio transmission scenarios but does not provide specific data. Assuming these align with the high performance of other outcomes, it would suggest strong practical skills development among students in these areas.

3-Year Outcome Results

- **Overall Success:** The "2 Year Outcome Result" appears to be overwhelmingly positive, with the vast majority of outcomes being met by 100% of students. This indicates a program that is effectively achieving its educational goals over time.
- **Continuous Improvement:** The slight deviations in PLO 7 and PLO 10, as well as CLO LP.4, offer opportunities for continuous improvement. Focusing on these areas could further enhance the program's overall success.

Overall Performance

- **High Achievement:** Across almost all objectives, there's a consistent pattern of high achievement, with 100% of students meeting the standards in the majority of the learning outcomes. This indicates strong program effectiveness and student mastery of the material.
- **Improvement in Enrollment:** There's an apparent increase in the number of students from AY21-22 to AY22-23 across most objectives, suggesting growth in program enrollment or increased participation in these assessments.

Implications

- **Strengths:** The program demonstrates strong outcomes in teaching critical paramedic skills, as evidenced by the high percentages of students meeting the learning objectives. This suggests effective instruction and curriculum design.
- **Growth and Development:** The increase in student numbers meeting the objectives year-over-year could reflect positively on the program's reputation and its ability to attract more students or better prepare them for assessments.

Conclusion

The data reflects a highly successful program with consistently high achievement rates across most assessed learning outcomes over three years. The few areas with less than 100% achievement rates provide opportunities for focused review and improvement, but they do not detract from the overall excellence demonstrated by the program. Volunteer State Community College's Paramedic TC Program is showing strong performance and growth in its ability to prepare students for pre-hospital emergency care settings. Continuous monitoring of the few areas where not all students met the objectives will be important for maintaining and improving the high standards of the program.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Strategies to maintain and even improve these results could include:

- Continuing education and professional development opportunities for instructors to stay updated with the latest EMS practices and teaching methodologies.
- Implementing a feedback loop where students can provide insights on teaching methods and curriculum, ensuring that the program remains responsive to student needs and industry standards.
- Considering the establishment of a mentorship program where high achieving EMS students can provide guidance, support, and tutoring for their classmates.

Evidence:

- Paramedic Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23
- Paramedic TC PLOs AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

The analysis of the Volunteer State Community College's Paramedic course evaluations from Spring 2021 to Spring 2023 reveals several strengths and areas of opportunity.

Strengths

1. **Instructor Preparation and Content Delivery:** Across all semesters, high scores were given for the instructor's preparedness and the availability of class instruction content, with mean scores consistently above 4.5. This indicates a strong foundation in course material preparation and delivery.
2. **Adherence to Syllabus Policies:** The evaluations consistently show high ratings for instructors following the course syllabus, suggesting clear communication of expectations and consistency in policy enforcement.
3. **Engagement and Environment:** The instructors were successful in creating an engaging environment where students felt comfortable asking questions and participating in discussions, with scores again consistently high.
4. **Assignment Relevance and Application of Concepts:** Assignments were viewed as relevant and effectively designed to apply course concepts, indicating that the course effectively links theory with practical application.

Areas of Opportunity

1. **Feedback Timeliness and Instructor Accessibility:** While still rated highly, feedback timeliness and instructor accessibility have slightly lower scores in some semesters, pointing to potential areas for improvement in communication and support outside of class hours.
2. **Use of Technology:** Although the use of technology was generally rated positively, there is room for enhancing how technology is utilized in the course to aid understanding and application of material, as suggested by the slightly lower scores and comments for improvement.

Ideas for Improvement

1. **Enhance Feedback and Communication:** Implementing more structured timelines for feedback and ensuring more consistent availability for student inquiries can further support student success. Tools like online forums or regular Q&A sessions could be useful.
2. **Leverage Technology for Engagement:** Exploring additional technological tools and platforms that facilitate interactive learning and better engagement with course materials could enhance the learning experience. This could include more interactive simulations, virtual labs, or collaborative online projects.
3. **Continuous Improvement through Feedback:** Encouraging a higher response rate to course evaluations and incorporating an iterative feedback loop where students can provide mid-semester feedback could help identify and address issues more promptly.
4. **Personalized Support and Resources:** Offering more personalized support options, such as tutoring or study groups, and resources for struggling students can improve understanding and application of course concepts, particularly for those who may not fully engage through large group instruction.
5. **Professional Development for Instructors:** Continuous professional development opportunities for instructors focusing on pedagogical strategies, technology integration, and communication can ensure that teaching methods remain effective and responsive to student needs.

FACT SHEET:

The provided data for the Paramedic program at Volunteer State Community College from Fall 2019 to Fall 2023, along with graduate placement information for 2020 through 2022, presents a clear framework to analyze the program's strengths and identify areas where there are opportunities for improvement.

Strengths

1. **Consistent Full-Time Enrollment:** The program has maintained a high level of full-time enrollment, with 100% of the students enrolled on a full-time basis from Fall 2019 through Fall 2022. This consistency suggests strong interest and commitment from students entering the program, which is a critical foundation for student success and program stability.
2. **Graduate Placement:** The data provided for graduate placement indicates a consistent number of graduates finding placement from 2020 to 2022, suggesting that the program is effectively preparing students for employment in the paramedic field.

Areas of Opportunity

1. **Lack of Part-Time Enrollment Options:** The 0% part-time enrollment across all years suggests that the program may not be accessible to individuals who cannot commit to full-time education due to work, family, or other obligations. Providing part-time options could open the program to a wider demographic.
2. **Variable Enrollment Numbers:** The fluctuation in total headcount, especially the drop in Fall 2021, points to potential instability in enrollment that could affect program resources and planning.

Ideas for Improvement

1. **Introduce Part-Time Study Options:** To address accessibility issues, the program could introduce part-time study options or flexible scheduling. This would allow more potential students to enroll who otherwise couldn't due to time constraints, thereby also possibly increasing the program's enrollment numbers.
2. **Targeted Recruitment and Support Programs:** Addressing the fluctuation in enrollment numbers could involve targeted recruitment efforts to raise awareness of the program and its benefits. Additionally, implementing support programs for students at risk of dropping out or those facing academic challenges could help improve retention.
3. **Career Placement Services:** Although placement rates seem strong, enhancing career placement services with more networking opportunities, job fairs, and partnerships with local EMS services could further improve graduate employment outcomes.
4. **Feedback and Continuous Improvement:** Regularly soliciting feedback from students and graduates about their experience in the program and outcomes after completion can provide essential data for continuous improvement efforts. This feedback could inform curriculum updates, teaching methods, and support services to better meet student needs.

By focusing on these areas of opportunity and implementing the suggested improvements, the Paramedic program at Volunteer State Community College could enhance its accessibility, student success rates, and overall program effectiveness.

Evidence:

- Paramedic Student Course Evals AY20-23
- Paramedic- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicators	Timeline**	Baseline Data
1	Enhance the Clinical Skills Simulation Lab PLO 4 (SL)	To enhance practical skills in emergency medical response through hands-on simulation exercises, increasing student preparedness for fieldwork.	Faculty	1. Successful completion of simulation scenarios by 100% of students. 2. Positive student feedback on simulation lab experience from 75% of participants.	AY2023-2024 for lab setup and instructor training; AY2024-2025 for full integration into the curriculum and evaluation.	1. N/A 2. N/A
2	Integrate a Case Study Discussion Series PLO 3 (SL)	To improve critical thinking and decision-making skills in emergency scenarios through facilitated case study discussions.	Faculty Members, Guest Paramedics, Program medical director.	1. Engagement of at least 75% of students in discussion series. 2. Obtain positive feedback from 75% of	AY2024 for development and pilot series; AY2024-2025 for full implementation	1. N/A 2. N/A

				participants regarding the relevance and usefulness of discussions.	and ongoing evaluation.	
3	Establish a Peer Mentorship Program for New Paramedic Students	To support academic and practical success for incoming students through mentorship from senior paramedic students, enhancing retention and program completion rates.	EMS Faculty, Senior Paramedic Students	1. 100% of new students are matched with a mentor. 1. Obtain positive feedback from 75% of mentees and mentors on the mentorship experience.	AY2024 for planning and mentor recruitment; AY2025 for program launch and initial assessment.	1. N/A 2. N/A
4	Launch an Online Resource Hub for Paramedic Studies	To provide accessible, comprehensive online study and practice resources, supporting flexible learning and enhancing knowledge retention and application.	EMS Faculty, School IT	Increased usage of online resources to 75%.	AY2023-2024 for resource development and platform launch; AY2024-2025 for user feedback collection and content expansion.	Current usage of existing online resources. 69%

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

Budgeting for new EMS lab equipment is a critical component of ensuring that emergency medical services education remains both current and comprehensive. As the healthcare landscape evolves, incorporating the latest technologies and equipment into training programs becomes essential for preparing students to meet the demands of the field effectively. Investing in new lab equipment not only facilitates hands-on learning experiences that are vital for developing practical skills but also ensures that students are familiar with the most recent advancements in emergency medical care.

By prioritizing the allocation of resources towards updating lab equipment, educational institutions can enhance the overall quality of their EMS programs, better prepare students for the challenges of their future careers, and ultimately contribute to the improvement of patient outcomes in emergency medical situations. The current budget and Health Science fees are sufficient to meet all budget needs of the EMS program. We foresee sufficient monies for the next three years.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Section 1

The EMS program mission aligns well with the college mission. It focuses on community engagement, partnerships, and high-quality education.

Section 2a

EMT Report:

- The assessment plan is not clearly articulated in this section of the report. We do not see what the PLO or CLOs are, what the identified targets are for each outcome, etc. We are assuming that information is present in the attachments that we do not have access to in this part of the review process. Additional access to information is needed for more elaborate feedback.

Paramedic Report:

- The narrative does not delineate the separate aspects of the assessment plan as clearly as EMT report does. We do not see what the PLO or CLOs are, what the identified targets are for each outcome, etc. Additional access to information is needed for more elaborate feedback.

Section 2b

- Both reports:
 1. No 2020 data provided. An explanation for the missing data is needed.
 2. Need explanation why the 3-year outcome result not indicated/reported.
 3. The CLOs listed under the table do not comprehensively relate to or explain the data in the PLO table. More information is needed for the reviewers to understand this information.
- Paramedic Report
 1. PLO 9, 12 are missing data (0% met/not met).
 2. The *Lab Practice Skills SLOs* comment related to the table comments is presumptuous. Identifying high performance in some areas should not lead to an assumption that there is automatically high performance in areas not assessed.

Sections 3-4

Excellent job outlining and describing the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.

Are there correlations between certain questions in the Course Evaluations or Employer Surveys that relate to and support the PLOs? We suggest triangulating data/results where possible.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Paramedic program supports the mission of the institution by providing a high-quality, innovative program. It is led by Erik Jesse, Program Director, and has a team of dedicated full-time and adjunct instructors. The program is taught at the Cookeville and Gallatin locations and has a supportive and engaged Advisory Committee. Graduates obtain gainful employment with EMS providers throughout the communities. They demonstrate effective learning by passing the National Registry examination higher than the national average. In reviewing the APR, I noted the following.

- The assessment plan narrative does not identify the PLO being assessed. I understand that the 2020 data was absent due to the ramifications of the pandemic and the changeover in the research personnel. To add to the comment from the IA Committee, in the narrative, provide more details about what specifically is being assessed and connect it to the educational goals and objectives. In assessing the Paramedic Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23, I note a significant decrease in the percentage of students who exceed each lab category. I am also curious as to why EMSP.TC.9 and EMSP.TC.12 do not appear to have been assessed.
- I agree with the ideas for improvement regarding "Continuous Improvement through Feedback". Paramedic student course evaluation submission was 86% in 2021 and has trended downward to 26% in Spring of 23. Faculty should make more concerted efforts to encourage students to complete course evaluations. Students and stakeholders such as employers and graduates can provide valuable information about the program that may affect planned initiatives. An additional opportunity for growth is assessing the results of Graduate and Employer surveys.

In summary, I recommend a detailed analysis of the laboratory competency assessments. It should include the faculty who teach the course as well as the director. Since the program is offered at two sites, is there a difference in competency level between Cookeville and Gallatin students or is the data from one location? The program has a sufficient budget to order equipment and supplies that can increase student learning. I believe that additional training in completing the assessment section of the report and having adequate time to complete the APR, will be of benefit in future reports.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative

Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicators	Timeline	Baseline Data	Response	Year 2 Response
Enhance the Clinical Skills Simulation Lab PLO 4	To enhance practical skills in emergency medical response through hands-on simulation exercises, increasing student preparedness for fieldwork.	Faculty	Successful completion of simulation scenarios by 100% of students. Positive student feedback on simulation lab experience from 75% of participants.	AY2023-2024 for lab setup and instructor training; AY2024-2025 for full integration into the curriculum and evaluation.	N/A	Training has been conducted for five faculty members (Todd, Harley, Alex Smith, Rachale Turner, and Rob Demoss) to ensure proficiency in simulation operations. Training schedules varied based on instructor availability. Senior mentors, Gary and Cory, have volunteered to assist in simulation activities.	Ongoing training will continue to ensure all faculty are proficient.
Integrate a Case Study Discussion Series PLO 3	To improve critical thinking and decision-making skills in emergency scenarios through facilitated case study discussions.	Faculty Members, Guest Paramedics, Program medical director.	Engagement of at least 75% of students in discussion series. Obtain positive feedback from 75% of participants regarding the relevance and usefulness of discussions.	AY2024 for development and pilot series; AY2024-2025 for full implementation and ongoing evaluation.	N/A	N/A	Case studies have been integrated into the curriculum, specifically within the Lab class (2402), with involvement from the Medical Director. Student engagement is at 100%, as participation is required for medical director sign-off. All participating students reported a positive experience and perceived the case studies as useful.
Establish a Peer Mentorship Program for New Paramedic Students	To support academic and practical success for incoming students through mentorship from senior paramedic students, enhancing retention and program completion rates.	EMS Faculty, Senior Paramedic Students	100% of new students are matched with a mentor. Obtain positive feedback from 75% of mentees and mentors on the mentorship experience.	AY2024 for planning and mentor recruitment; AY2025 for program launch and initial assessment.	N/A	N/A	To date, student participation in the peer mentorship program has been negligible. It is surmised that the program's scheduling, following long lecture days on Mondays and Tuesdays, contributes to low engagement. Senior mentors Gary and Todd have volunteered. 100% of new students were invited to participate.

							Data supporting low participation is anecdotal.
Launch an Online Resource Hub for Paramedic Studies	To provide accessible, comprehensive online study and practice resources, supporting flexible learning and enhancing knowledge retention and application.	EMS Faculty, School IT	Increased usage of online resources to 75%.	AY2023-2024 for resource development and platform launch; AY2024-2025 for user feedback collection and content expansion.	Current usage of existing online resources. 69%		Evaluation of online resource platforms is ongoing. Platinum Planner and JB Learning were assessed but did not meet the requirement for providing students with meaningful, independent feedback. Students continue to utilize existing online resources.
							Software evaluation is still in progress.

Evidence:

- Initiative Paramedic

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis

	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Fire Science AAS & CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
The Fire Science program's mission aligns with the institution's mission by uniting in the desire to provide students with innovative education while building lasting relationships with students to prepare our students for successful careers. The program is designed to prepare current and future firefighters to be leaders and thinkers in the firefighting profession. The FESHE (Fire and Emergency Services Higher Education Initiative) certified program can be completed 100% online and provides the flexibility required by students working all shifts and hours. As the firefighting profession continues to make technological advances, the instructors serve students by providing current, relevant instruction on today's fire service topics and trends. The program focuses on the critical thinking and problem-solving skills not learned in training or on the job. Students can acquire a broader base of knowledge and a new perspective on the fire service profession.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

1. **Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes** focus on students' ability to understand the scope, purpose and structure of the various fire and emergency services, understand the broad concepts of fire prevention, and to demonstrate a basic understanding of the relationship of materials and their relationship to fire.
2. **Assessment Methods** involve quizzes to measure students' competencies in these areas, discussions covering relevant content in the textbooks, self-studies to supplement the textbook with external learning, and final projects that focus on local concerns for respective students.
3. **Achievement Targets** are set to ensure that students meet or exceed the expected standards in their theoretical knowledge.
4. **Assessment Schedule** outlines when these evaluations take place, ensuring a structured approach to student assessment throughout the academic year.
5. **Assessment Rubric** details the criteria for grading student performance from excellent, down to unsatisfactory. All graded assessments utilize rubrics, which are provided to students at the beginning of class and are always available for them to view to ensure they understand the grading criteria. The detailed rubric and assessment methods ensure that students are evaluated fairly and comprehensively, providing a clear pathway for demonstrating knowledge and proficiency in the Fire Science field.

Evidence:

- FIRE, AASCERT Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

FIRE AAS

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%	95.56%	4.44%	
PLO 2			100%	0%	95.24%	4.76%	
PLO 3			100%	0%	97.62%	2.38%	
PLO 4			95.28%	4.72%	97.58%	2.42%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	95.65%	4.35%	
Course Learning Outcome 1320.1			100%	0%	92.11%	7.89%	
Course Learning Outcome 1320.2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 1320.3			100%	0%	96.55%	3.45%	

Course Learning Outcomes FIRE1320 1320.1 Implementation 1320.2 Develop Solutions 1320.3 Communication

1. Analysis of trends

There was a slight decrease in outcomes being met from 2021 to 2022. While the outcomes met percentage for 2022 remained high, any decrease demands a closer look at the reasons for that decrease.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.
Student learning can be improved by analyzing the specific areas that slipped between 2021 and 2022 and focusing on their improvement through targeted initiatives.

FIRE TC

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%	95.56%	4.41%	
PLO 2			100%	0%	97.83%	2.17%	
PLO 3			100%	0%	97.62%	2.38%	
PLO 4			95.28%	4.72%	97.58%	2.42%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	95.65%	4.35%	
Course Learning Outcome			100%	0%	92.11%	7.89%	
Course Learning Outcome			100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome			100%	0%	96.55%	3.45%	

Course Learning Outcomes FIRE1320 1320.1 implementation 1320.2 Develop Solutions 1320.3 Communication

1. Analysis of trends

Like the trends of the Fire Science AAS program, there was a slight decrease in the outcomes being met percentages from 2021 to 2022. While the TC numbers are slightly higher and some areas, they still demand further analysis to make improvements.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Again, these results can be analyzed in order to identify specific areas that need improvement. While the percentages are high as they are, improvements will continue to be made until outcomes are met 100%.

Evidence:

- FIRE 1320 CLOs AY20-23
- FIRE AAS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- FIRE AAS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- FIRE TC PLO_s AY20-23
- FIRE TC PLOs Gender AY21-22
- FIRE TC PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- FIRE TC Pell First Gen PLOs AY21-23
- FIRE, AASCERT Assessment Plan
- Fact Sheet FIRE AAS & TC FA23
- Fact Sheet FIRE AAS FA23
- Fact Sheet Fire Science TC FA23
- Fire AAS PLO_s AY20-23
- Fire AAS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- Fire Student Course Evals AY20-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Strengths:

Experienced and knowledgeable Faculty: The Director and nine adjunct faculty members all have multiple years of fire service experience and teaching experience that combines for a well-rounded, excellent source of information for the students.

Increasing enrollment: Enrollment of current firefighters continues to increase on a consistent basis.

Transfer for credits for certifications: The Fire Science Program offers many transfer credits for fire service certifications and medical licenses, which rewards students for their prior experiences by reducing the number of courses they must complete at Vol State.

Areas of opportunity:

Recent high school graduate enrollment: While enrollment of current firefighters continues to increase, there is a need to attract younger potential firefighters to the program.

Diversity: While there is some diversity, the program continues to try to attract a broader demographic of students.

Limited retention data: Persistence data is missing, making it difficult to assess student retention within the program.

Ideas for improvement:

Networking with local fire departments and their respective high schools: Coordinate with members of the Fire Science Advisory Board to visit area high schools to ensure students are aware of the job opportunities in the fire service field. This can attract a broader demographic, as well as younger students to supplement the large amount of current firefighters already in the program.

Increase the personal aspect of instructor to student relationships: Due to the online-only format of fire science classes, better relationships with the students need to be established by the faculty. This can be accomplished by increased communication in discussion forums and reaching out to individual students to encourage those who are struggling, and to praise those who are succeeding.

Increase retention data by working closer with the Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment.

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
	Student Learning:					

1	Increase external learning opportunities for students within course content. PLO 2 (SL)	Provide students with knowledge beyond that of the textbook and instructor experience through resources such as free self-studies.	Program Director and Adjunct Faculty	Adaption and completion of external studies into eLearn courses.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data needed.
2	Improve student to student and instructor to students interaction within eLearn. PLO 4 (SL)	Provide students with increased knowledge and information by increased use of discussion forums.	Program Director and Adjunct Faculty.	Improved module discussion grades and course evaluation feedback.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline discussion grade data needs to be recorded and tracked.
Student Success:						
3	Provide advising to all Fire Science students prior to each semester.	To ensure students know their progress in accordance to their goals, and to ensure students take the correct classes each semester accordingly.	Program Director	Continued and increased enrollment and retention, as well as decreased drop/add of classes by students.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline retention data needed.
4	Provide a mentor to Fire Science students.	In addition to the Program Director, students can be mentored by program graduates. This could be especially effective for current firefighters who have co-workers that	Program Director, current students, and past Fire Science graduates.	Increased retention, increased enrollment, job placement for graduates.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data needed.

		are program graduates.				
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4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

No additional expenses are required.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Mission Statement Alignment

The Fire Science mission statement aligns well with the college mission statement. Internal and external engagement are addressed as well as career-focused skills.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcome Assessment

The information is clearly articulated with easily identifiable sections. It is brief but it is assumed more detail is on the AASCERT Assessment Tool. I did not have this instrument to review.

Evidence of Student Learning

Both reports have no 2020 data provided nor an explanation for the missing entries. Seemingly good analysis of give data but I could not see the supporting documentation

Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

Great job identifying strengths and areas of opportunity!

One small item to be changed under *Increase retention data*. The office name is now Research, Assessment and Special Initiatives (RASi) isn't it?

1. Improvement Initiatives

1. Matrix- 2 Student Learning and 2 Student Success Initiatives (no more than 6 total)

Both sections are clear and well defined.

2. Initiative Budget- Budget details on any initiative that need financial consideration.

“No additional expenses are required.” Amazing! The overall report was excellent in content and focus.

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

Under the leadership of Jeremy Stewart, Director of Fire Science, students have flourished in the 100% online format of the program. He has an active and engaged Advisory Committee that has a vested interest in the development and recruitment of firefighters throughout the state. Mr. Stewart plans to address the area of opportunity section regarding recent high school graduate enrollment by the following:

- Ordering equipment and/or supplies for the Gallatin High School dual enrollment cohort to increase interest in the career field and to allow students to participate in hands-on learning. The program has sufficient funds to support this area.
- Increasing recruitment at high schools by visiting in uniform accompanied by a firefighter closer to the students' ages who is currently employed at a fire station in their county. A bonus would be if the firefighter is a graduate of the high school in hopes that prospective students can better envision themselves in the role.
- Note: there is no 2020 data due to the pandemic and changes in IE personnel.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
	Student Learning:					
1	Increase external learning opportunities for students within course content.	Provide students with knowledge beyond that of the textbook and instructor experience through resources such as free self-studies.	Program Director and Adjunct Faculty	Adaption and completion of external studies into eLearn courses.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data needed.
2	Improve student to student and instructor to students interaction within eLearn.	Provide students with increased knowledge and information by increased use of discussion forums.	Program Director and Adjunct Faculty.	Improved module discussion grades and course evaluation feedback.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline discussion grade data needs to be recorded and tracked.
	Student Success:					
3	Provide advising to all Fire Science students prior to each semester.	To ensure students know their progress in accordance to their goals, and to ensure students take the correct	Program Director	Continued and increased enrollment and retention, as well as decreased drop/add of	AY 2024-2025	Baseline retention data needed.

	classes each semester accordingly.		classes by students.		
4 Provide a mentor to Fire Science students.	In addition to the Program Director, students can be mentored by program graduates. This could be especially effective for current firefighters who have co-workers that are program graduates.	Program Director, current students, and past Fire Science graduates.	Increased retention, increased enrollment, job placement for graduates.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data needed.

1. All 21 FIRE classes, with the exception of two classes, FIRE 2310 and FIRE 2340, now include external learning assignments. Those two classes are anticipated to include external assignments the next semester they are offered after the current spring 2025 semester. Student learning for these external assignments is tracked by requiring students to submit proof of completion of these assignments to eLearn dropboxes. These external assignments help improve student outcomes in their respective courses because every external assignment is linked to at least one of its' respective course outcomes.

2. All FIRE adjunct instructors were directed by the Fire Science Program Director to increase online interaction with their students by replying to all student introductions. Additionally, adjuncts were directed to participate in module discussions on a frequent basis, by replying/participating in at least one thread per module. There has been increased online interactions between instructors and students based on periodic checks conducted by the program director. However, detailed checks will be conducted of all class interactions at the conclusion of the spring 2025 semester. The Year 2 evaluation for this initiative was conducted by the program director comparing the number

3. The Program Director has made excellent progress in providing advising to all Fire Science students. To facilitate this initiative, a list of all current and prospective Fire Science students is maintained by the Program Director. The list includes contact information and program status. The list is used to email or call to advise students on a regular basis, at least once prior to each semester. At the time of this narrative, there are 139 students on that list, and all 139 of them who were on the list at the time were advised prior to the fall 2024, spring 2025, and summer 2025 semesters. Currently, the program director is working on advising all students on the list for the fall 2025 semester.

4. Providing a mentor to each student is still a work in progress. Some progress has been made, but without a formal mentoring system in place, along with a sufficient number of mentors with time and interest to provide the service, this initiative has not proven to be feasible. Moving forward, the program director will continue to gather information about students, and when students are employed in the fire service, they will be provided with names of others at their place of employment to be used as possible resources. Students without co-workers or peers in a position to provide mentorship will continue to be advised by the program director.

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress

	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Medical Laboratory Technology AAS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
It is the mission of the Medical Laboratory Technology Program to provide well-trained, professional, knowledgeable, and competent Medical Laboratory Technicians to serve the healthcare community and public at large. The program is designed to prepare students to enter the work force as Medical Laboratory Technicians, knowledgeable and skilled in assisting physicians in the identification, monitoring, and treatment of diseases.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The assessment plan, including method, targets, and schedule, for MLAB 1520 and MLAB 2510 was evaluated and determined to be appropriate. The MLAB Clinical Assessment Rubric requires updating to remove the AAA.6 TN Medical Laboratory Board Licensure. TN Medical Laboratory Board Licensure is no longer required for all clinical laboratory personnel. Both MLAB 1520 and MLAB 2510 are taught later in the Medical Laboratory Technology Program. It would be valuable to assess

MLAB 1510 in addition to the other assessments since it is taught earlier in the program. This would provide assessments throughout the program.

Evidence:

- MLAB, AAS Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 3			98.75%	1.25%	100%	0%	
PLO 4			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 6			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 7			0%	0%	0%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome MLAB.2			95%	5%	90.91%	9.09%	
Course Learning Outcome MLAB.7			100.0%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome MLAB.9			100%	0%	100%	0%	

MLAB Clinical Assessment Outcomes MLAB.2 Psychomotor Clinical MLAB.7 Cognitive Decision Making MLAB.9 Cognitive Critical thinking

1. Analysis of trends

Students have successfully met at 100% all program learning outcomes (PLO) in 2021 except for PLO 3, Technical Skills, which requires demonstration of entry-level technical competency in all skills necessary to fulfill their role as a Medical Laboratory Technician, 98.75%. In 2022, students successfully met at 100% all program learning outcomes. It is possible that the evaluations did not accurately reflect the technical skills of the students in 2022.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

To improve the student's technical skills, we have created a student simulation lab in Fall 2023 allowing students to practice laboratory skills prior to their clinical practicum. Although the simulation lab is operational, procedures for the use of the equipment are still in development.

Evidence:

- AY21-22 and AY22-23 CLO Report
- MLAB AAS PLOs AY21-23
- MLAB Clinical Assessment MLAB1520 MLAB 2510
- MLT AAS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- MLT AAS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- MLT AAS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Program Strengths

For the 2020-2021 graduation classes, the program has a 100% first-time pass rate for the national ASCP Board of Certification exam. For the 2022 graduation class, the first-time pass rate was 90%, 9 students passed, 1 failed. Analysis of certification data shows that the mean scaled score for VSCC program graduates is consistently above the national mean scaled score for this exam for all three years. This is well above our national certification agency, NAACLS, requirements of a three year average of at least 75%.

Course evaluations consistently show a median score of 5.0 out of 5.0 for all questions for the last three years. A strength that has remained consistent is that the instructor regularly prepared content for class instruction and the online content of the program was readily available for use when needed. There is an extensive amount of on-line content used in the program. We have also seen an increase in scores in Fall 22 and Spring 23 for creating an environment where students were able to ask questions and engage in discussion. We added group discussions and interactive activities, involving both instructor and student, to program courses to increase student engagement and interaction.

The program has a 100% placement rate within the first year of graduation. There is a high demand for qualified Medical Laboratory Technicians both locally and nationally.

	2020 Graduates	2021 Graduates	2022 Graduates
# who found employment in the field or in a closely related field within one year of graduation	11	9	6
# who did not find employment in the field or in a closely related field within one year of graduation	0	0	0
# for which you do not have any information	0	4	4
Yearly Average Placement Rate for those who submitted information	100%	100%	100%

Opportunities

Although we are above the certification pass rate required by our national accreditation agency, NAACLS, we strive for 100%. We added a new review book, *Medical Laboratory Science Review*, to the MLAB 2270 course for Spring 2024 which should help students prepare for their national certification exams. We are also leveraging digital technology to offer practice exams to the students for certification preparation.

Since there is a high demand for trained clinical laboratory professionals in this area, expanding the program to accommodate additional students would be a benefit to prospective students and the

community. According to a Lightcast Q3 2023 Data Set report, there is a high unmet demand for jobs within a 30-mile radius from Gallatin. There is a higher-than-average number of jobs in this area for medical laboratory personnel. In 2023, this area had 3,173 jobs in the field and the national average for this same size area was 1,624.

Another opportunity for improvement is to increase accessibility to the program. Many of those interested in the Medical Laboratory Technology Program are non-traditional students. Non-traditional students may not be able to attend school full time because of family commitments or employment obligations. A part-time program would be beneficial to this student population.

Evidence:

- 20-21 MFT 6 MLAB ASCP BOC 2020
- 2021 Placement Rates
- All Results Report MLT _ Placement 2022 Graduates
- MLT Student Course Evals AY20-23
- Medical Laboratory Technology- Fact Sheet FA23_King_Updated ER
- Occupation_Overview_Clinical_Laboratory_Technologists_and_Technicians_30_Mile_Radius_from_Gallatin_2023-28 10122023
- Y2 MedLab
- Yr3 Med Lab May 22 - Nov 22

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

Matrix of Improvement Initiatives						
YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)	Timeline	Baseline Data
1	Expand the program by increasing program capacity, adding clinical sites, classroom and lab space, and faculty.	To provide a greater number of graduates to support the demand for medical laboratory technology personnel.	Program Director and MLAB faculty	Increase the number of Medical Laboratory Program graduates to >15.	AY2022-2024 Seek approval from TN Lab Board to increase capacity, add additional clinical sites, add faculty to support growth, add a	Program graduates (three-year average) 11

					classroom and another student lab.	
2	Increase accessibility to the program by creating a part-time program.	To provide greater accessibility for non-traditional students.	Program Director and MLAB faculty	Create a part-time program.	AY2022-2024 Seek approval from TN Lab Board, create curriculum and class schedule.	none
3	Increase the Board of Certification pass rate by incorporating a review book and practice exams into MLAB 2270, Seminar II. PLO 6 (SL)	To provide additional review material to assist students with passing board exams.	Program Director and MLAB faculty	Increase the pass rate on Board of Certification (BOC) exams to 100%.	AY2023-2024 Add a review book, and additional practice exams to the course.	BOC pass rate (three-year average) 97%
4	Create a student learning outcomes assessment for MLAB 1510 to evaluate students earlier in the program. PLO 3 (SL)	To evaluate students early in the program allowing time to correct unsatisfactory outcomes.	Program Director and MLAB faculty	Create a student learning outcomes assessment for MLAB 1510.	AY 2024-2025 Create learning outcomes, assessment rubric, assessment map, define the method, and establish targets.	none

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

For program expansion to accommodate additional students, the following items are needed:

ITEM	COST PER UNIT	UNITS	TOTAL COST
Vinyl chairs	680	12	8160
Lab grade tables	1800	10	18000
Incubator for Micro samples	3500	1	3500
Pipettors	600	20	12000
Total Monies			41660

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Section 1

Program mission aligns well with the college mission. It focuses on education for service to healthcare and greater community at large.

Section 2

- The assessment plan was not clearly outlined in the report we received. The report indicates they reviewed it and found it appropriate but without clearly communicating the plan's details to the reviewers. We do not see what the PLOs are except by numbers. The summary includes plans for future changes to the assessment plan.
- Suggestions: Include the PLO specifics and more detail about the assessment plan as it was defined so that the reader understands the data. Move information about changing the assessment plan after the data analysis.
- We assume that the PLO data provided is from clinical observations, not pre-clinical. Additional clarification is needed.
- No 2020 data provided. An explanation for the missing data is needed.
- Need explanation why the 3-year outcome result not reported.
- Is the Course Learning Outcome MLAB.2 the same as (or aligned to) Technical Skills as PLO#3 is? The Course Learning Outcome indicates under 100% met, but it is not discussed in the report.

Section 3

Is the ASCP Board Certification exam (referenced in the program strengths) required for all students? Is this board exam the same as the AAA.6 TN Medical Laboratory Board Licensure mentioned in part 1?

Are there correlations between certain questions in the Course Evaluations or Employer Surveys that relate to and support the PLOs? We suggest triangulating data/results where possible.

In the placement data table, we suggest adding a row to indicate the actual average placement rate – not just those who responded.

Section 4

Improvement initiatives are good. No suggestions.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Medical Laboratory Technology program supports the institution's mission by providing a quality and innovative program. It is growing at an impressive pace under the leadership of Eileen Ricker,

Program Director, and the remaining team members such as Robin Ward, Clinical Coordinator. Graduates demonstrate learning by successfully passing the national board examination at a high level and by obtaining gainful employment at facilities within our local communities. Job placement is at 100% for all who pursue. In addition to the comment from the IA Committee regarding including a detailed narrative for the assessment plan section and Yr 3, I noted the following.

- Stakeholders can provide valuable information about the program that may affect planned initiatives. An opportunity for growth is noted in the amount of feedback obtained from stakeholders through graduate and employer surveys as well as course evaluation responses. The number of students submitting course evaluations has trended down from 100% in 2020 to 45% in 2023. Graduate and employer surveys are also at a low threshold. You have an engaged and communicative Advisory Committee. I would like to see a detailed analysis of feedback, particularly from employers and graduates to ensure that all growth opportunities are being addressed. This would also relate to the IA Committee's questions regarding correlations between evaluation instruments.
- To address a question from the IA committee, the State of TN does not require licensure for medical laboratory technologists. Licensure is separate from the ASCP Board Certification examination. Upon completion of the board exam, graduates obtain credentials. Overall, the program has an excellent first-time board examination pass rate that is well above the minimum passing score. If not already completed, consider completing a detailed analysis of each section of the board exam results to determine curricular strengths and weaknesses as the total score per student trended downward in 2022. Utilizing the new MLT review textbook, and the addition of the simulation lab may also help.
- The program's budget and Health Science course fees were insufficient to meet the need of new equipment for the simulation lab. Several areas around campus shared their budget monies to assist with this dilemma. As of today, 4/11/2024, the simulation lab is up and running.

In summary, this is an effective program with increasing incidents of student success and a positive employment outlook. The progressive initiatives, which I approve, will help meet the needs of the community at a more rapid pace. The ability for students, many of whom are most likely non-traditional, to pursue the part-time pathway to secure gainful employment is unique in the state. I look forward to a follow-up next year.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	Expand approved MLT Program Seat Capacity and surpass base line of 11 graduated students listed in 4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives.	a. State Lab Board Approved to seat 40 students up from 20 b. Student lecture classroom – 400 Building, Room 102 c. 2nd Student simulation lab now functional – 400 Building, Room 106 d. 5 new clinical practicum (CP) sites added	1. Qualified applicant base 2. Quantity of Microbiology clinical practicum rotation sites due to affiliation consolidation 3. Program Director retired leaving the need to add faculty 4. Student academic performance - Tutoring opportunity for student learning to increase retention/completion	1.a. – complete 1.b. – complete 1.c. – complete 1.d.– lost all Ascension lab affiliations due to LabCorp management 1.4. Add tutoring for MLT students taught by MLAB Adjunct faculty	Indicator - Met AY – 2023-2024 15 students graduated. AY – 2024-2025 16 students total - Projecting 14 to graduate in 2025. This is 1 student less than in 2024 (15).
2	Add Part-time MLT Cohort to better	a. Approval from TN	1. Qualified applicant base		Indicator – Met

	meet needs of nontraditional students	Med Lab Board 2023 b. Approval from NAACLS c. Approval from VSCC Admin 2023 d. 1st Part-time cohort began January 2024 & will graduate May 2025 e. 2nd part-time cohort began January 2025 & will graduate May 2026	2. Quantity of CP sites due to Ascension labs & Graves Gilbert Lab being managed by LabCorp causing need for new contract and TN Med Lab Board approval		AY – 2024-2025 1st cohort of Part-time MLT students will graduate 2025 with 18 applicants and 6 being offered seats in the cohort AY – 2025-2026 2nd cohort of Part-time MLT students had 35 applicants with 10 being offered seats in the cohort.
3	Increase Certification Exam pass rate to 100% by incorporating new textbook into MLAB 2270	a. Spring 2024 adopted review textbook: Medical Laboratory Science Review (5th Edition, Robert R. Harr, 2019, ISBN-13: 978-0-8036-6827-0) b. AY – 2023-2024 ASCP & AMT combined pass rate 73.3% (1	1. Didactic online exam result integrity in question - adding textbook does not address this 2. Students not registering to take certification exam by 1 month post graduation - siting cost of exam for postponing exam - adding textbook does not address this 3. Adjustment needed to grade requirement to enter the MLT Program? 4. Adjustment needed to grade requirements for course completion	Due to falling short of NAACLS pass rate threshold for 2024 graduates, the certification exam pass rate target for this metric has been adjusted down to 90% overall to allow for additional measures and further remediation.	Indicator – Not Met

		year testing window closes 5/4/25.)	while in the MLT program 4. NAACLS pass rate metric is within 1st year of graduation - has been challenging to get students to register to retake certification exam after initial fail attempt 5. Students not utilizing the exam proctoring website	More adjustment needed than simply adding a book - Spring 2025 prereq GPA updated to 2.7, MLAB course completion updated to 75% from 70%. Students moved to in-person proctored exams instead of virtual proctor. Additional remediation added for performance on section exams. Students retain access to exam proctoring for the first year post graduation until they pass their exam	
4	Student Learning Outcomes Assessment for MLAB 1510	a. VIA Assessment created and entered for			Indicator - Met

		MLAB 1510 Fall 2024			
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Close

Evidence:

- Exam Results 2024 Class
- Graduated Student Exam Simulator Access
- MLAB College Catalog Grade Requirements Modification SP 2025

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?

EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Entertainment Media Production - AAS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
The Entertainment Media Program is a close fit with the mission of the college. The EMP works continually to develop and incorporate innovative ways to use new industry techniques such as immersive audio into the classroom. In their professional work, faculty stay up with current industry standards and practices, using current equipment and techniques. This knowledge is brought back to the classroom and informs curriculum development and teaching practices. The faculty are all professionals in their respective fields which allows for partnerships with industry companies to form naturally. These partnerships allow opportunities for internships and employment for graduates. The Capstone class has students forming groups that conceive, develop and build a project that is presented to a panel of industry professionals, From these experiences, Volstate students have secured multiple internships, direct employment, and industry contacts critical to career development and success.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The current rubric and plan are new to this assessment cycle as they recently underwent a major revision. They were revised to capture data useful to the program for assessment of student learning and to better inform program tweaks.

This new plan is much more effective in all of the prompt categories, but still needs some expansion and adjustment. Since the last cycle, the EMP has developed and implemented a new pathway, Digital Media, which covers podcasting, radio and other types of voice work. This pathway is not yet included in the overall assessment rubric, but needs to be by the time Digital Media students appear in Capstone. The plan would be to include the revision during the Summer session of 2024.

A second revision to be made at the same time would be a language tweak. PLO 5 : "Students will be able to work as a team to create an effective new artist presentation for industry representatives." should read "Students will be able to work as a team to create an effective entertainment project for presentation for industry representatives."

This change will better represent the expanded scope of the EMP and student projects

Course sequencing will undergo a major revision as the EMP will be adding three options for students to reflect the continual change in student needs.

1) The EMP will offer a 'smorgasboard" degree path option for students whose interests lie outside the 5 current pathways. This need was identified through discussions that arose during student advising sessions - a reason the EMP is choosing to keep advising in house - and through inquiries from prospective students, and through discussions with advisory board members. It will allow students to pick and choose from among a menu of classes to build a customized path that will serve their individual needs.

2) Course sequencing will also be tweaked to accommodate the needs of the English and other General Education department scheduling.

3) The EMP will be developing two certificates: 1) A beginning certificate that will provide a condensed curriculum that won't include General Education classes and will be an option for students who only want skill classes, and to service returning students who may already have a degree and who are looking to take classes to sharpen or advance their current skills. 2) An advanced certificate for students continue learning past the available classes in a two-year degree but who don't want to attend a four-year school, and to serve the same returning/skill advancement cohort mentioned for the first certificate.

Evidence:

- EMP, AAS Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%	100%	0%	

PLO 2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 3			100%	0%	95.24%	4.76%	
PLO 4			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	95.24%	4.76%	
Course Learning Outcome 299P.1			93.75	6.25%	85.71%	14.29%	
Course Learning Outcome 299P.2			97.92%	2.08%	95.24%	4.76%	
Course Learning Outcome 299P.3			100%	0%	100%	0%	

Course Learning Outcome COMM299P Capstone 299P.1 Time Management 299P.2 Collaboration 299P.3

1. Analysis of trends

The EMP numbers look very good for the program and learning outcomes. We've worked hard to prepare students for the jobs market. Students are passing the outcomes at a very high rate. There was a slight dip year over year from 2021 to 2022 in PLO 3 and PLO 5 as well as CLO 1 and CLO 2, but with only two years of data there is not enough to tell if it is a trend or a fluctuation. It is something that will warrant tracking.

The numbers are high enough that it seems the EMP is doing well preparing students to face the "real world" and the challenges of building a career.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

PLO 3 addresses students technical knowledge in the manipulation of images on a professional level. Critical to this skill is the ability to train on industry standard equipment and software as the level that is considered "professional" is rising and follows a stairstep model: new software and equipment are developed which allow new and innovative techniques to become commonplace which means the starting level is new and higher, requiring teaching to rise as well.

PLO 5 involves students working as a group to achieve necessary goals. This one is somewhat dependent on group dynamics. EMP faculty strive to instill the need for successful interaction to realize a satisfactory outcome. The director of the EMP has started working on directed group work in the early Intro to Entertainment Business class to work on soft skills and how to thrive within a group, so tracking of this outcome will inform the program of the effectiveness of those efforts.

CLO 1 and 2 are tied in large part to PLO 5 and will likely rise and fall in generally the same manner and will benefit from similar actions. This will bear watching as well.

It is possible we should tweak CLOs 1 and 2 to gather different data since they are close to PLO 5

The EMP is continually looking for ways to improve student learning. All faculty are involved at a professional level within the entertainment industry which serves as constant professional development. This constant development is reflected in the classroom as exposure to the latest techniques and trends. When students have access to, and hands-on experience with, industry standard equipment, their usefulness as interns and employees is obvious and less time is spent by the employer in training and students more quickly become productive in their chosen areas.

Evidence:

- EMP COM299P Capstone SLOs AY21-23
- EMP PLOs AY21-23 Standard Report
- EMP PLOs Gender AY21-23
- EMP PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- EMP PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

The EMP is showing good growth in graduates. This is exactly the result we are hoping to see. From 2020 to 2022 the graduate number has increased by approximately 60%. Part of this increase is attributable to recovery from the COVID downturn, but still it shows good growth. The EMP is also seeing an increase in returning students. One benefit of this mixing of younger and older students is the learning going both directions and the exposure to unexpected perspectives. Both sets of students gain knowledge for the experience.

We anticipate even greater growth in numbers as we see fruits from our work to build relationships and DE opportunities with high schools in the Vol State service area. In the Summer session of 2022 we are developing one class for Fall semester in Robertson Co and have two more targeted to offer soon. These relationships serve the dual purpose of offering secondary students a unique educational experience and raising awareness of the program as a whole to a population that has not been tapped fully for the EMP at Vol State.

We are hoping to increase our student numbers by 10-15%. To prepare for these possible increases the faculty and the director have been meeting regularly within the dean to form a plan, and to recruit suitable faculty to the adjunct pool to cover the need for additional sections of classes that will be needed.

To make sure the EMP prepares for increased student numbers and to keep the curriculum in line with evolving industry needs, the EMP relies on input from the advisory board. The EMP advisory board has been expanded with new members as needed to advise new directions.

One of these expansions is the addition of a new pathway - Digital Radio Media This pathway was developed to serve students interested in new media outlets such as podcasting and for more traditional outlets such as sports announcing, traditional radio, and voice over work.

The EMP is developing several collaborative opportunities for students. The EMP faculty work well together and are creating classes that will see DRM , audio, and video students working in shared classes on collaborative projects. This is reflective of the industry at large and it is felt the more practice students during their tenure at Vol State, the more seamless their transition into industry after graduation will be.

Students already have one collaborative opportunity in the Capstone class. This class is at the end of the schedule and is a practicum in which teams of students formed with at least one of each of the pathways conceive, develop, and present a project to a panel of industry professional for feedback and advice. A film project from the Spring 2023 Capstone class has garnered 9 awards in various categories from film festivals in which it has been entered.

Additional collaborative opportunities presented in different ways in other classes we feel will only raise the bar for the already fine work form EMP students.

Evidence:

- Entertainment Media Production- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Increase availability of hands-on learning with state of the industry equipment. PLO 3 (SL)	Increase value of students to internships and employers as students will already be experienced in the operation of this equipment, streamlining students path into industry positions, and lessening employers need to spend valuable resources and time on training	EMP faculty will teach students the latest techniques on the state of industry equipment	Students will more quickly secure employment and /or will increase likelihood of hire at the end of an internship	EMP is awaiting word of a major grant application. If awarded, the grant will be used by June 30 2023	Awaiting word on funding
2	Develop an advanced learning certificate for students who don't want a 4-year degree or are, along with certain community populations, interested in furthering certain skills or honing existing skills	Maximize skills for current or returning students to aid career building	EMP faculty will develop curriculum with approvals through the offices of the Dean and the VPAA	Students will show career growth, acquire advanced certifications , and will secure more opportunities based on larger skillsets.	Create and receive approvals in the 2025-2026 academic year with a Fall 2026 start.	Certificate does not currently exist

3	Develop pathways for secondary schools to take DE courses and provide seamless transition to EMP at VSCC	Increase prospective student awareness of EMP opportunities and increase likelihood of students coming to VSCC and with credits in desired pathway already in hand, stay for completion of certificates and/or degree	Director will work with appropriate VSCC offices and target service area secondary schools to develop curriculum to be offered	Student growth from target schools will be tracked, along with completion data	Create curriculum 2023-2024 academic year with start date of Fall 2024	Work has been ongoing and interest is high in the first target school. The director is working with secondary school teachers to develop classes.
4	Increase the retention rate of students (inclusive of non traditional students) to 70% within 3 years by bringing more industry standard technology into the classroom earlier in the curriculum through the development of an embedded skills first certificate (starting Fall 2025) within the AAS program	Keep students on path to completion by offering options that fit students' needs. Hands on with industry equipment will keep students involved as they acquire valuable experience that will translate to career building success	Program director and EMP faculty with approvals through Dean and VPAA offices	Measuring retention over the period	AY 2023-2024 develop curriculum AY 2023-2024 pass VSCC curriculum committee and secure TBR approval Fall 2025 offer certificate	Retention data is unavailable for recent periods. This will be gathered at earliest opportunity to form baseline

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

The major funding for the initiatives is for 4A.1

Funding for this increase in state of the industry equipment is currently waiting news of award of a grant in the amount \$492,000. This funding will thoroughly revamp and expand the EMP equipment inventory and increase capabilities mentioned in the initiatives.

An example of the value of this equipment: a recent graduate of the EMP Video Production pathway secured an internship with a local company. The first thing the student was trained for was the use of the very equipment sought by EMP via this grant. The employer indicated that had the student already

been familiar with the equipment, the students would have been put immediately into a paying position.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

1. Mission Statement Alignment
 1. Program mission alignment to Institutional mission

The EMP program mission statement aligns well with the college mission statement addressing partnerships, engagement and economic development.

1. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcome Assessment
 1. Assessment Plan- Review and Rationale

It was not clear which of the 5 areas were being addressed by the text. I was not able to see the *Evidence: EMP, AAS Assessment tool* so I can only assume items were addressed. I would prefer another description instead of “smorgasboard” degree path.

1. Evidence of Student Learning
 1. *Analysis of Trends- Program Learning Outcomes- Data (2 years of data)*
 2. *Results – Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.*

This section had identifiable section headings and the chart was present. Data was not listed for 2020 and no explanation for the missing data. One assumes a COVID impact, but an explanation would have been helpful. Again, The PLOs and CLOs referenced were not present. I need more information to fully understand the specifics.

1. Improvement Initiatives
 1. Matrix- **2 Student Learning** and **2 Student Success** Initiatives (no more than 6 total)
 2. Initiative Budget- Budget details on any initiative that need financial consideration.

The information clearly showed a well-thought out plan but again it was not outlined in a way that a layperson could differentiate the Student Learning vs Student Success. The ideas are great. The budget information seems sufficient.

Overall Comments, Suggestions, or Recommendations

This is my first year on this committee and perhaps I should have had more guidance on what to look for in these reviews. I can did gain a better understanding of where the EMP program is going and I agree that a program that is technology driven must stay current with industry standard technology and skills.

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their

review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	Increase availability of hands-on learning with state of the industry equipment.	The grant was approved. A 3 year Perkins grant was awarded. Equipment updates are in progress	Proper grant language to make purchases of required equipment	No changes	Equipment for ATMOS upgrade of Ramer studio has been purchased, delivered, and is being installed. Video equipment for this year's grant has been

		for all sectors of the EMP			delivered and is being used by students
2	Develop an advanced learning certificate for students who don't want a 4-year degree or are, along with certain community populations, interested in furthering certain skills or honing existing skills	Curriculum planning is ongoing	The studio refurbishment is a key part of the certificate facility needs	Time line is partially dependent on completion of facilities upgrades	The EMP faculty have developed a list of classes to be included in the certificate and which classes need to be developed. The development is scheduled to begin Summer/Fall 2025
3	Develop pathways for secondary schools to take DE courses and provide seamless transition to EMP at VSCC	Meetings with and initial agreements with three secondary schools have been held and are being codified	Pay for secondary school teachers was an issue. The issue has been resolved .	A one year delay was the result of the pay issue	Since resolution of the pay issues has been achieved, development of suitable curriculum formats is slated to be completed for some classes by Fall 2025 as the DE sections should be active.
4	Increase the retention rate of students (inclusive of non traditional students) to 70% within 3 years by bringing more industry standard technology into the classroom earlier in the curriculum through the development of an embedded skills first certificate (starting Fall 2025) within the AAS program	According to Factbook, the Fall to Fall retention rate over the last three years is 43.8%.	Cyclical ups and downs in the retention rate	No changes	Students support has been increased. The EMP has undergone a major curriculum realignment designed to address this issue. The new alignment allows students to design most of their own curriculum, thus removing the need to take classes the students deem unnecessary and will increase the likelihood of completion.

Close

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Fine Arts AFA - Studio Art Emphasis

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The art curriculum for the AFA Degree provides the standard pre-professional degree for artists and designers with an intensive education in problem-solving strategies, and skills for students looking to transfer to another Tennessee public university or select regionally accredited, non-profit Tennessee private colleges and universities to completed their baccalaureate degree. Additionally, this program serves students looking to take classes for personal growth, increased awareness of issues in art and design, and understand artistic practices within the community.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

As for the Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes, numbers for all areas meet goals to at least 70% with the lowest ranking being Expressive Platforms which is most likely due to each studio area focusing on specific skills within fine arts rather than on a wide variety of platforms in each course. Overall, our percentages of meeting each goal has increased between the assessments years 21-22 and 22-23 by an average of 4%.

Overall, the assessment plan to review each of the foundations areas (Drawing I, Drawing II, Foundations I and Foundations II) for the next few semesters will help us understand what achievement targets should change or if our assessment methods need adjusting. The course sequencing of students taking Drawing I and then Drawing II creates a logical path for students to complete the required courses within two years while scaffolding learning outcomes for great effectiveness.

Evidence:

- ART Studio, AFA Assessment Tool-1
- Assessment Rubric

- Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			90.21%	9.79%	95%	5%	
PLO 2			92.56%	7.44%	94.65%	5.35%	
PLO 3			75.12%	24.88%	76.88%	23.12%	
PLO 4			75.59%	24.41%	77.30%	22.70%	
PLO 5			71.83%	28.17%	70.97%	29.03%	
Course Learning Outcome 1350.1			93.33%	6.67%	66.66%	33.33%	
Course Learning Outcome 1350.2			93.33%	6.67%	83.33%	16.67%	
Course Learning Outcome AFA.4			86.67%	13.33%	50%	50%	

Course Learning Outcomes ART1350 1350.1 Formal Qualities 1350.2 Conceptual Ideas 1350.4 Craftsmanship

1. Analysis of trends

2.B Evidence of Student Learning

Overall, the trends show that there is an increase in overall student learning between years 21-22 and 22-23 in each of the categories being evaluated. However, in relation to ART 1350 Foundations II Studio in particular, there are inconclusive results due to the lower number of assessments completed from the first round of assessments to the second round of assessments.

There are lower increases in Black and African American, as well as Asian student learning, with a larger gap in the percentage of goals met. However, there is still an upward trend showing that student learning is increasing, but there needs to be more effort in reaching these groups of students to reach the same level as other groups.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

The Art Department could try to include a wider range of student examples, artist examples and resources for a wider variety of students in the classroom to reach students who may not have representation.

To increase student learning in artistic skills, there could be more focus on scaffolding projects and faculty working as a team within the art department to understand better how each class might influence one another so that students graduate with a more well-rounded foundational college art

education in which all studio areas relate to one another more cohesively. In doing so, students may find more relationships between these learning objectives in each course.

Evidence:

- AFA PLOs AY21-23
- AFA PLOs Gender AY21-23
- AFA PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- AFA PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- ART 1350 SLOs AY21-23
- AY21-23 AFA SLP Assessment Results

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Vitality Response

1. The program is growing in student population overall, particularly from Fall 2020 and 2021 to Fall 2022 when the student population in this area grew to 119 full time students. The participation in course evaluations has gone down quite a bit between Fall 2020 and Fall 2022, which shows the need for more encouragement to complete course evaluations or a wider range of course evaluations to be given in order to reach the most students effectively.
2. These results could be used to improve student success if we focus on the lower percentages within the student course evaluations, specifically the category that indicates a higher degree of students needing more access to faculty. As we are a department of just 4, and one of our full-time faculty travels between other campuses, we are in need of another full-time faculty member to help even out the class loads. Three of the four full-time faculty are consistently in an overload schedule of classes because we don't have enough studio space to teach more courses or faculty to teach them.

Evidence:

- ART Student Course Evals AY20-23
- Fine Arts- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1

	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Increase AFA Artistic Knowledge through expanding opportunities for students to meet with and understand methods used by contemporary artists in the field. PLO 4 (SL)	To provide students with a wider range of opportunities to understand contemporary practices within the art field, learn about job opportunities, and further their career goals within the arts.	Program Chair and VSCC Art Faculty	Increase PLO AFA 4 percentage of goals met to 80%.	AY 2023-2024 Discuss with faculty more visiting artists or gallery visit opportunities, and/or trips for students. AY 2024-2025 Set schedule for any or all of the above opportunities for students.	1. Average 77% goal met in AFA 4.
2	Increase the percentage of AFA 5 Expressive Platforms to 73%. PLO 5 (SL)	Offer students a wider variety of places and spaces to showcase their artwork as they create it throughout each semester, in addition to the Annual Student Art Show.	Program Chair and VSCC Art Faculty	Increase AFA 5 percentage of goals met to 73%.	AY 23-24 Work with our gallery coordinator and faculty to organize more student showcase opportunities, including summer student shows, t-shirt competitions, and flyers for school events. AY 24-25 Launch t-shirt competition, and post more opportunities for student engagement within the art department.	1. Average of 70% goal met.
3	Increase overall student success and	To allow faculty more time with students and	Program Chair, Administration	Student Course Evaluations	AY 23-24 Examine the courses needed most	1. 74% students agreed that they had

	respond to student evaluations pointing to need for more access to faculty.	to avoid the necessity of course overloads due to lack of space and faculty to meet the growing needs of students.			to avoid overloads for all faculty. AY 24-25 Explore solutions to spaces that might be used for studios, and possibility for a new faculty member.	access to their instructor.
4	Increase the success of Black and African American students according to student success results within the art department	To reach all students, including minority groups, and increase student success.	Program Chair, VSCC Art Faculty	Student Course Evaluations	AY 23-24 Assess the need for more representation of all student populations and groups. AY 24-25 Implement a wide range of examples for each class to include different perspectives, backgrounds, and cultures.	1. 26% goal met of Black or African American students for AFA 4 "Artistic Knowledge" 2. 20% goal met of Black or African American students for AFA 5 "Expressive Platforms"

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

Initiative related to AFA 4 Artistic Knowledge: In order to create a sustainable visiting artist program, we will need a stipend/budget of at least \$200 for each visiting artist, and preferably, accommodations paid for each artist to stay and visit with students for a day. We would like to host at least 1 visiting artist each semester, and rotate the media each artist works in to expose students to a wide variety of art techniques.

Initiative related to AFA 5 Expressive Platforms: The art department will need more studio space to accommodate the growing number of art majors, as well as at least one more full-time faculty member to fulfill needs of students and allow for fewer overload assignments.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Academic Program Review

1. Mission Statement Alignment
 1. Ties directly back to mission statement in terms of specifics related to curriculum, but also “personal growth” elements
2. Curriculum and Student Learning
 1. Review and rationale seem solid – goals being met at least 70%; rising between assessed years.
 1. While I don’t disagree with the plan to assess Drawing I/II and Foundations I/II, are there any other courses that would make sense to also assess, such as specific studio courses?
 2. Improvement in each PLO; amount of increase varies. CLOs not demonstrating the same increase; in fact, substantial decrease evident year over year.
 1. Decrease in CLO blamed on low response rate/small n value, but number of responses are not provided.
 2. Results include some initial ideas to increase student learning.
3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information
 1. Strengths = continued growth; Opportunities = focused effort to get evaluations submitted or more evaluations administered
 2. Evaluations can then be used to identify lower-scoring targets, and potentially identify or justify the need for additional staff.
4. Improvement Initiatives.
 1. Initiative 1: Expand opportunities for students to interact with artists in the field; Initiative 2: Offer students wider variety of places to display artwork; Initiative 3: Increase response rate on evaluations, respond accordingly to suggestions indicating need for more staff; Initiative 4: Increase success of African American Students
 1. How will the department proceed with Initiative 4 in light of recent changes to federal law (SFFA)?
 2. Budget needs are focused on Init. 1 (stipends/travel costs) and 2 (more faculty and studio space to accommodate growing program).

Overall Comments, Suggestions, or Recommendations

Overall, the report and findings are solid and thorough. Through the course of the program review, faculty identified key areas where the program tends to struggle, such as providing regular and frequent opportunities for students to display their artwork or identifying different career pathways for students and mentoring along those paths. Using that information, faculty then proposed solutions to these issues; these solutions could appeal to students in several ways while also allowing the College to develop new partnerships with external organizations and/or other artists in the field.

I’m interested in knowing more about the plans for how Initiative 2 will be accomplished if funding for additional faculty cannot be obtained. Have faculty already identified potential options for additional studio spaces that could be used? I’m aware this is part of the initiative; more information in this initiative may be helpful in determining whether the initiative is a success in future years. Further, there was an emphasis on increasing the number of evaluations submitted, but how specifically will faculty address this issue?

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No

EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Volunteer State Community College
Associate of Fine Art Degree Program
Academic Audit
Self-Study Report 2021-2022

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Part I: Introduction

The AFA Degree at Volunteer State Community College is offered in two disciplines: Art and Music.

The AFA in Art (Studio) is a degree program that was first offered in Fall 2017. Since then, enrollment has grown significantly, more than doubling since the previous academic audit was submitted (see appendix D). The program is a Tennessee Transfer Pathways (TTP) degree option designed to prepare students for transfer into BFA programs in art and design. This degree allows students to focus more on developing their studio practice and technical and conceptual art skills, leading to stronger portfolios of work for transfer applications. It also helps to lessen the challenge these students face after transfer of having far too many studio art courses still to take and far too few general education and lecture courses to balance them out each semester during their junior and senior years.

The Art Department consists of four full-time faculty and between 7-12 adjunct instructors. Students in the Art AFA program take courses in drawing and foundations instruction, including two-dimensional and three-dimensional design, and choose from a variety of additional media-based studio courses including painting, printmaking, photography, graphic design, ceramics, and the occasional special topic studio course. Art majors normally participate in an annual art exhibition each spring in the college art gallery, and sometimes at off-campus sites as well, to showcase their work.

The AFA in Music, created Fall 2011, upon graduation provides a seamless transfer to any state of Tennessee four-year institution. As part of the TTP, it recognizes and promotes students' success in degree completion. The AFA offers students academic courses and performing opportunities, which align with the first two years of a Bachelor of Music degree at Tennessee institutions. The AFA offers private instruction in voice, piano, brass and guitar. Other performing opportunities include two choral groups, traditional and commercial, guitar ensemble, brass ensemble, and a commercial music ensemble. Students have the opportunity to record solo performances as well as departmental ensemble pieces showcased at the end of each semester and housed on our departmental [YouTube Channel](#).

As an outcome-based degree, the AFA is associated with behavioral objectives for the student at the course level. Learning objectives are designed for educational success and individual student growth, listed in course manuals. These goals and learning objectives are optimized to focus on student progress, promote collaboration in areas of study of lecture and lab courses and create numerous performance opportunities.

The Music department, part of Performing Arts, includes four full-time faculty members and approximately 13 adjunct faculty. The current number of AFA Music majors has declined since the previous Academic Audit in part due to COVID-19 but has seen an increase in the fall of 2021 and is currently at 28 students (see Appendix D).

This self-study was a collaboration between the Chairs of Performing Art and Art Departments, Professors Nicholas Reynolds and Nate Smyth, with input from faculty and students from both departments, as well as data collected from the Humanities Division, feedback from graduates, and meetings with members of the Volunteer State community who have important objective perspective about the self-study process. In addition, this study was reviewed by the Dean of Humanities Division, Erin Mann, and the Dean of Academic Support, Rhonda Gregory, as the academic audit coordinator.

Part II: Overall Performance

The Art and Music departments assess quality in our programs by collecting data (see appendices B and C) surrounding student performance in their studies, and by judging the quality of student work in the annual art exhibitions, music showcases, juries, concerts, and recitals. In addition, we make a habit of continually speaking with both students and stakeholders about what should and should not be included in the curriculum, what they would like to see changed or improved, etc.

Strengths

Although the courses in the Music and Art AFA degrees are mandated by TBR via the TTPs, Vol State shows its individual strength via commitment to our students:

- The variety of studio offerings in the Art AFA track: Unlike smaller colleges, we are able to offer regular courses in ceramics, photography, graphic design, printmaking, and painting, with dedicated spaces for each and studio access for students outside of regular classroom hours. This means students who begin their studies at Vol State before transferring to a BFA program elsewhere will have had very similar studio options to those available to them at university.
- The Art Gallery: The exhibition space in our SRB Humanities Building is a fantastic way to both display the work of our art students as well as to expose the whole college to fantastic art from around the country. We have also been able to bring many of the exhibiting artists to campus to lecture and engage in class discussions, lead studio critiques, and give technical demonstrations.
- The Music Theory course sequence in the Music AFA track: Beginning with Fundamentals of Music, students complete four semesters of music theory study, presently using Norton's *The Musician's Guide to Theory and Analysis* (Clendinning/Marvin). This is a comprehensive text, and by the end of Music Theory III, students have usually covered more than half of the book, which prepares them for continuing as juniors upon transfer into a Bachelor of Music program.
- Our Ensemble program in the Music AFA track: We offer a wide variety of student performance ensembles for credit (four semesters are required for graduation), including Commercial Music Ensembles with a focus on pop/rock and jazz, Commercial Vocal Ensemble (popular music), Vol State Singers (art music), Bluegrass Ablaze (bluegrass ensemble), Wind Ensemble, and Guitar and String Ensemble.

Key Findings

Here are some observations about deficits of our programs:

- The Visual Art Department has improved the deficit of full-time to part-time instructors, but we are still working near capacity for our physical studio spaces. We have had to offer studios on Fridays many semesters due to this limitation, and it cuts into our ability to provide studio work time for students to complete work outside of the scheduled class times. If our programs grow any more, then we will need additional space.
- Need for outreach/recruitment: the music program has seen a decline in enrollment since the last academic audit. High School Music Day was created as a recruiting tool but was not held during the spring of 2021 due to COVID-19. Significant improvement has been made in establishing relationships with local area high schools and coordinating the date for High School Music Day to be held when most high school music students are able to attend.
- In terms of physical resources, the Music department would benefit from a concert grand piano to be permanently housed in Caudill Hall, the performance hall.
- With the rate of pay for adjunct faculty (as well as full-time, although we feel there's much more room for improvement in the adjunct scale), we are severely limited as to the number and caliber

of instructors that we can attract and keep, and who can thus learn effective methods of imparting course material over time. As we have very little control over this directly, we plan to continue to include the problem in reports like this and to remind our administrators regularly to keep bringing it up in meetings with the people who *do* have some control in this area.

Part III: Performance by Focal Area

1: Learning Outcomes

The AFA in both Music and Art maintains learning objectives for each course offered in the catalog, and these objectives are clearly stated in the course manuals and in individual syllabi for all courses. With the adoption of TTPs, the process of preparing students for successful matriculation to senior institutions has been facilitated in some areas. We continue to emphasize practical preparation for entry-level opportunities in Nashville's music and design industries.

1.1 Program Learning Outcomes

Art

Art faculty discuss program learning outcomes (described in more detail in section 2.1) at the start of each school year and on a regular basis during the semester as it comes up in classes. They expect art students to practice theoretical understanding and hands-on creation. Graduates from the Art Program will:

- Demonstrate skills in critical thinking and visual analysis;
- Demonstrate fundamental skills in drawing, design, and composition;
- Demonstrate knowledge of functions, materials, and history of art;
- Demonstrate knowledge and skills in at least one area beyond drawing and design.

Music

Music faculty meet on a semesterly basis to discuss goals for our majors based on their performance in private lessons, ensembles, and music theory/ear training. Upon graduation AFA music majors will:

- Demonstrate an understanding of styles and structures of music and be able to apply this knowledge through performance;
- Demonstrate competencies in theory and aural skills through sight-singing performance, generating and analyzing harmony, creating and notating self-generated musical ideas, and the graphic dictation of aural sounds;
- Demonstrate cooperative learning and creative expression through performance as a member of performing ensembles;
- Demonstrate high level of performance attributes through private lessons and end-of-semester juries.

1.2 Student Learning Outcomes

Student learning outcomes in Art and Music are specific to each course and are explicitly listed on the syllabi for core courses within the respective AFA curriculum for each area. Syllabi may be found in the Humanities division office files for all classes.

Art

As described in more detail in section 2.1, Art faculty review courses for appropriate goals and learning outcomes at the start of each semester, as well as whenever a problem or question arises, both through written updates and through discussion with the teaching faculty. A master syllabus template is maintained for every course to assure uniformity as courses may change hands from semester to semester. Assessment of objectives is also reviewed. Some Art course student learning examples are:

- Understanding of the fundamental visual elements and principles of art and design. (ART 1340 Foundations Studio I)
- Connecting relationships of works of art to the social processes of its culture including, but not limited to: economy, religion, geography, technology, science, intellectual development, political structures, philosophy, and social structures. (ART 2000 Art History Survey I and ART 2020 Art History Survey II)
- Organize and construct 3D forms using the elements and principles of design. (ART 1350 Foundations Studio II)
- An ability to record visual impressions from the environment through the use of line and tone with acceptable accuracy. (ART 1045 Drawing I and ART 1050 Drawing II)

Music

Music remains an outcome-based discipline, with numerous behavioral objectives at the course level. Learning objectives designed for educational student success and individual student growth, while still stated on course syllabi, are also available to students for every assignment in their Connect software, and/or are stated on course syllabi specific to the skill or application (instrument or voice). Music faculty use these goals and other stated learning objectives from syllabi to discuss student progress, to collaborate in areas such as Music Theory lectures and lab courses, and to create numerous performance opportunities for students in all areas of music. Some examples of syllabus-level course outcomes are:

- A fundamental understanding of music theory and ear training (MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music, MUS 1057/1058 Theory I/Ear Training I, MUS 1555/1156 Theory II/Ear Training II, MUS 2055/2056 Theory III/Ear Training III)
- A basic knowledge of keyboard skills, ability to perform all 12 major and minor scales. (MUS 1027 Class Piano I and MUS 1127 Class Piano II)
- Introductory competencies in private lessons (voice, piano, guitar, woodwind, percussion, strings, and brass).
- Preparation in a general education core for success in transferring to four-year universities.

1.3 Evaluation

A desired outcome of our AFA programs is the common goal of helping students transfer to senior universities, a process that has been greatly facilitated by the TTPs and University Parallel. To that end, our learning outcomes are largely modeled after those in the university programs that our students would be transferring into, particularly those institutions that adhere to the TTP. The majority of these outcomes are relatively universal for higher education programs in these areas, usually requiring adjustments only to keep up with changes in professional practices, new equipment, or when we identify an unaddressed student need through discussions with relevant stakeholders and student performance in exhibitions, recitals, juries, and general coursework.

2: Curriculum and Co-curriculum

The AFA degrees offer an array of co-curricular activities in addition to, and in support of, their curricula. These activities aim to reinforce the learning outcomes described in the previous section and to improve the students' skills as artists and performers. Curriculum continues to fall in line with other state schools in keeping with the TTP.

2.1 Collaboration

Art

The foundation of the department is based on a belief that art is a way of learning that enriches life and builds creative and skilled individuals. When not prohibited by the recent pandemic, the Art Department holds annual faculty meetings/retreats that include adjunct faculty. During remote instruction, this took place on Zoom. Full-time faculty have ongoing discussions of department and student needs at least weekly. Since it is such a small department, meetings happen as needed between classes or over lunch (or more recently, in the form of phone calls, text messages, and video conferencing) to assure that everyone stays informed and connected. This ongoing discussion allows for an evolving flow of ideas that facilitates true problem solving. It also promotes collaborative planning and awareness of the Art Department as a whole that plays to the overall strengths of our faculty and facilities.

Additional examples of collaboration include planning with the Entertainment Media Production (EMP) program, which requires students to take art courses, and working with faculty and the new Gallery Coordinator to increase in the number and quality of artists exhibiting in the gallery and giving lectures, presentations, and demonstrations for students. During the height of the pandemic, with in-person exhibitions and visits off the table, emphasis shifted temporarily to building our social media presence.

Music

Music faculty meet at least once a semester to collaborate regarding curriculum changes and additions. Meetings have agendas but formal minutes were not kept. We will begin keeping minutes this spring. Examples of collective decisions made recently at such meetings include:

- Adjunct theory instructor William Fitzhugh is completing a course update for MUS 1002 to remove *Introductory Musicianship* (Lynn) from the required course materials. Instead, he will supplement the course with his own worksheets, preparing students for Theory/Ear Training 1.
- Addition of Fall sections of Vol State Singers and Spring sections of Showstoppers (now called Commercial Voice Ensemble) to provide AFA students more ensemble opportunities.
- Our annual High School Music Day will take place in Spring 2022 for the fifth time, involving all full-time music faculty and some adjuncts collaborating with Steve Bishir from the EMP program in an “open house” style effort to give local high school students an opportunity to come and experience our faculty and facilities in action.

2.2 Content and Sequencing

Routine advising (Campus Connect throughout the Summer and full-time faculty advising during the semester) provides faculty an opportunity to regularly review the sequence of our courses and even methods for teaching them. Sequencing and teaching effectiveness is also a regular consideration as part of schedule management.

Art

First available in Fall 2017, the Art AFA grew out of the AA in Art (Studio) program and the need for a program that would better equip students for transfer to university and for work in the arts. Some flexibility in sequencing is required, since students go in different directions with their studio work and because the need for learning support classes is so common in art students during their first year. One-on-one faculty advising is very important.

In the general education requirements, students are encouraged to take English Composition I and II, any required learning support courses, and Art History I and II during their first year. They are also normally scheduled for Drawing I and II and at least the Foundations I studio courses their first year, before

sampling the other studio courses. There is some flexibility for students, but there are scheduling challenges with courses that are only scheduled yearly rather than every semester. There are also some pre-requisite requirements in place:

- Drawing I is a prerequisite for Drawing II as well as Painting.
- Foundations Studio I is a prerequisite for Graphic Design and Printmaking.

Music

Curriculum in the Music AFA degree is comprised of several categories. Perhaps the most emphasis is placed on Music Theory, Ear Training, Private Lessons and Ensembles, although much time is spent norming our approach to our MUS 1030 Introduction to Music classes since we offer most sections of that class. The five different areas of focus that we have in our curriculum are:

- Music Theory/Ear Training
- Private Lessons
- Ensembles
- Class Piano track (two semesters)
- MUS 1030 (Introduction to Music)

Faculty recommend that students enroll in Introduction to Music and Class Piano I during their first semester of study. Introduction to Music covers a broad overview of musical history, helping students better understand a variety of styles, and Class Piano I outlines the basics of playing the piano, note and rhythm reading, and understanding basic harmony. Students have the option to test out of our prerequisite theory course (MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music); however, most students are advised to enroll in it.

2.3 Curriculum Review

Art

Full-time Art faculty have regular discussions about the curriculum and ways to improve it based on student performance and faculty feedback. Discussions over the last couple years have included requiring Foundations Studio I as a prerequisite for the Printmaking course (which is now the case), and integrating ePortfolios into studio courses as a way of evaluating learning outcomes (which turned out to not work well at all no matter how we tried to fit them in).

Currently much of the discussion is centered around developing and rolling out additional graphic design courses, as conversations with students have shown this to be the clear direction that they are most interested in going with their studies. We are interested in the possibility of developing a new program around graphic design. We've already gotten a new design course approved as of January 2022, and are beginning to look at how this program would impact this AFA program in terms of enrollment and course offerings. We have also started to pool our knowledge to compile a shared resource listing recent events, artists, and art movements outside of the generic art history canon that we can use to expand what we are teaching to include more interesting examples outside of the straight white males that dominate the field.

As a TTP program, the basic outline of the Art AFA curriculum was agreed upon by a TBR committee made up of representatives of TBR and UT art departments, as well as other local art departments, and cannot be changed without TBR approval. This has been a problem to an extent, as it prohibits us from offering some courses to our AFA students that they really want to take in order to improve their skills.

Music

As with the Art AFA, TBR representatives from area school music departments formulated the basic outline of the degree. It is difficult to effect much change, but a few minor changes have been successful:

- Ben Graves rebranded Show Stoppers as Commercial Vocal Ensemble in Spring 2022. This was a decision to align our courses with the name most listed in the Tennessee four-year institutions. This change offered a more recognizable name upon transfer to another music department, producing less confusion about the content of the course.
- Collective reviewing of adjunct faculty applications, resulting in the discussion and hiring of a new adjunct piano instructor in Spring 2020. This allows the students to continue with Class Piano I and II, while providing an additional opportunity for private lessons, which raises the performance skill level to meet requirements in the four-year institutions.
- Since the bulk of our students attend the following schools, we continue to consult with ETSU, MTSU, Cumberland, APSU and Belmont for articulation concerns. This affects course assignments, such as repertoire and ensemble choices.
- MUS 1030 Introduction to Music represents the fine arts credit in the department. Full-time and adjunct faculty teach the course. This course was redesigned in summer 2021 by adjunct instructor William Fitzhugh, to reflect the updated 10th edition of the Roger Kamien textbook, which includes a more diverse, equitable, and inclusive approach to the composers in the text, plus easier integration of the e-book with the audio/video material.

2.4 Co-Curricular Activities

Music and Art have no shortage of co-curricular activities, most of which serve to give our students real-world, if not professional, experience, prior to their entering the job market/workforce. Each department's faculty establish opportunities independently to align with performance and skill outcomes within the program.

Art

Many of the activities we do are regular, annual events that require just some tweaking each year (like finding a new juror for the student art exhibition). Others are proposed by faculty or decided as a group (such as setting up student profiles on our social media pages in lieu of a gallery exhibition during the pandemic). Examples of recent co-curricular activities include:

- Annual Juried Student Exhibition. Students learn to prepare for exhibition, experience the competitive environment, install an exhibition and interact at a public reception. This exhibit is juried by a different visiting artist/educator each year. Awards and prizes are given.
- Social media student profiles. During the pandemic, instead of a physical gallery exhibition, we encouraged students to participate in our social media presence with a campaign displaying student work and brief profiles of advanced students and their inspirations.
- Participating in and hosting the Intercollegiate Art Exhibition, a group show of work done by students in all of the TN community college art programs. This is organized and curated by a different TN community college each year.
- Every year or two we schedule student visits to nearby university art programs, such as MTSU, where our students most recently got a print demonstration from local printmaker Nick Satinover.
- We work to bring local and national working artists to campus for exhibitions, lectures, demonstrations, and to interact with our students whenever possible. These are proposed by faculty and decided by group vote in collaboration with our gallery coordinator. Some recent examples include: Eric Beehn, Landon Crowell, Richard Painter, Connie Smith, Cortland Jones, Heather Jones, Rachel Mauser, Chip Boles, Monica Stewart, Erinn Nordeman, Kathryn Polk, Jeffrey, and Ted Jones.

Music

Individual faculty in music ensemble and private instruction courses plan for their students to perform multiple times per semester in various events both on campus and off-campus. In a normal, non-pandemic year, off-campus performance opportunities are common. Commercial Music Ensembles perform at Squarefest and donor events such as the Harvest Moon Soiree, Vol State Singers has performed in collaboration with West End United Methodist Church, and vocal students have performed at the Gallatin Public Library's Bach's Lunch series. For the MUS 1030 Introduction to Music courses, students attend and write reports on two concerts per semester (and moved to online videos during the beginning of the pandemic). Mostly in conjunction with the Private Lessons and Ensembles components of the Music AFA program, there exist a host of opportunities for co-curricular involvement for students:

- Although aimed at area high school students, High School Music Day takes place annually in February (apart from February 2021, due to COVID-19), and involves select AFA Music students. Events include guest presentations and performances, tours of the facilities, and a variety of breakout sessions led by music faculty (see Appendix F, "Professor Ben Graves," for sessions).
- While part of the curriculum and required, our ensembles routinely engage in off-campus and "outside the classroom" activities; Vol State Showstoppers, Commercial Music Ensembles, students from Songwriting classes and Bluegrass Ablaze take part in the Spring Showcase and the Vol State Winter Showcase, and the Vol State Singers and select voice students perform in off-campus concerts and recitals, all arranged by the instructors.
- Vocal students of Professors Nancy Slaughter and Mark Granlund perform in the Gallatin Public Library's Bach's Lunch series, a free public event on the first Tuesday of every month.
- AFA Voice and Piano majors present sophomore recitals (vocal majors rehearse and perform with Chair Nicholas Reynolds on piano). Upon successful graduation, Austin Peay State University allows vocal students to use a recording of the recital to substitute as the students' junior level hearing, allowing students to transfer as a junior.
- Students continue to contribute to performance events for the VSCC Foundation, the local community (such as Spring and Fall Squarefests), and numerous VSCC campus events including the Festival of Lights and the semesterly Commencement Ceremony.
- The department produces at least two live performances a year that are videorecorded and shared to the department's [YouTube Channel](#). Pre-Covid, Music and the EMP program collaborated on the Interdisciplinary CD project, producing two original CD recordings in support of the Songwriting curriculum and Winter Show.
- Piano students enrolled in MUS 174 Piano Lessons often participate in studio classes in which students perform for each other and receive constructive feedback.

3: Teaching and Learning

The ongoing evolution of individual instructors and their teaching methods is at the heart of the AFA degree programs; our programs are only as good as the faculty who teach them! All the full-time and most of the part-time faculty are practicing artists, which is crucial in the teaching of art and all its disciplines. Art faculty are privy to individual methods by monitoring fellow faculty members' classes, while the Music faculty often spend time discussing individual students' progress, since it often involves individual instruction or multiple classes, all of which work together to achieve a common purpose.

3.1 Collaboration

Art

Faculty in the Art Department have ongoing discussions about course content and the best way to teach classes. We regularly share relevant articles, web links, and videos to share with our classes, and we let

each other know when we have found an especially effective activity. Faculty in Art also communicate with each other throughout the semester about students who may need special attention or intervention. We have recently partnered with our EMP program to share storage and a new checkout system to facilitate students checking equipment out for use outside of the classroom.

The art department collaborates locally with Sumner County elementary schools, hosting an annual art exhibition of student work from nearby elementary schools with a very highly attended reception each spring. And in the summer of 2021, we also hosted an exhibition celebrating the career of local art educator Doris Bills and the work of her students.

Music

Educational approaches can vary in creative fields such as music, and in classes such as Ear Training or studio instruction, faculty can deploy techniques unique to everyone to achieve a desired learning outcome. As previously mentioned, this makes communication and sharing of ideas imperative within the department, and frequent meetings are required to discuss the practicality of various approaches. Given the Theory/Ear Training requirements of the EMP program, there is an overlap between the Music AFA, EMP, and Recording Industry Management programs, resulting in greater collaboration between faculty.

High School Music Day began in Spring 2017 and offers opportunities for collaboration between faculty and members of the professional musical community. We offer a variety of breakout sessions for high school and middle school students to recruit for our programs, but also simply to foster awareness of our degrees and educational tracks for students who may not yet be thinking seriously about college.

End-of-semester juries are another opportunity for collaboration within the music program, aimed at Music AFA majors. Although AFA juries have different sub-sets (voice, piano, brass, guitar, and string), faculty members from different instrumental areas often evaluate more than just the jury involving their applied instrument. Finally, end-of-semester showcases and voice concerts provide other collaborative opportunities for students and faculty.

3.2 Effective Use of Instructional Materials and Technology:

Teaching materials vary from instructor to instructor in some areas of Art and Music. As in all fields, technology is increasingly prevalent in the AFA programs.

Art

Examples of technology and instructional materials we use in the Art AFA program that are standard equipment in their respective industry fields include:

- An Apple computer lab with laser and inkjet printers, a large flatbed scanner, and the Adobe Creative Suite of design software,
- A class set of Wacom digital drawing tablets,
- A full class set of DSLR cameras for student use,
- A digital ceramics kiln,
- Ventilation booths for using spray fixatives and ceramics glazes, and
- High-end flashlights with colored filters to demonstrate additive color mixture and Enchroma glasses that “correct” for color blindness. (These two aren’t industry standards, but are effective in demonstrating phenomena to students in class.)

Newly acquired equipment that is now being phased into regular use includes:

- A class set of MacBooks equipped with current design software,

- A class set of iPad Pros with Apple Pencils to be used in design, drawing, and painting classes as well as Intro to Art lecture courses,
- A full class set of new DSLR camera kits, and
- An upgraded photo printer and a new color laser copier.

Music

Examples of learning materials and technology that have been found to be effective in the Music AFA degree program are listed below. Effectiveness of these tools over time will be evaluated based on student success in academic courses and students' observed progress in performance courses.

- The Music Department continues to use McGraw-Hill's Connect software for teaching MUS 1030 Introduction to Music. The software provides an electronic copy of the book as well as all homework assignments and tests in an online format. Although this approach has its pros and cons, it has become the norm, and the opportunity it affords for the "flipped classroom" where class time can be devoted to conceptual demonstration and discussion, has proven particularly advantageous. So much so, that hybrid sections that allow for one discussion day (rather than two) but otherwise resemble an online section, are being integrated into the schedule. With this change, which took place in 2015, we can establish a greater consistency in our approach to teaching this class by using a Model Course shell in eLearn, and the sharing of strategies has proven easier and more fruitful. The student success rate in MUS 1030 has proven to be very high, with the majority of the students receiving As and Bs.
- uTheory and Aurelia are web-based applications used in theory instruction. uTheory, used in Fundamentals of Music, is an individual tutorial practice and response, giving students immediate feedback. Aurelia is a music dictation and ear-training tool used in the upper-level Music Theory and Ear Training classes. During the pandemic, additional phone apps like MyEarTraining, Chords Pad, Music Theory, and Solfa were used to help raise students' skill level and grades. After using these phone apps, the average grade improved from a C to a B in theory courses.
- The Clendenning series of texts and educational materials have been invaluable for our Music Theory and Ear Training class sections. They have proven to be successful at preparing our graduates for transition to 4-year schools' theory and ear training courses.
- Recent technology purchases include 25 iPads and Apple Pencils and 25 MacBooks, available for music students and faculty to check out. These feature apps and programs for music reading and notation, composition, ear training, and music arranging, helping prepare students to be a 21st-century musician by embracing technology.
- When the Covid-19 pandemic forced education online, instructors embraced Zoom for musical instruction and the Acapella app for pre-recorded collaborative musical collages, showing students that online musical education is possible and effective.

3.3 Evaluation of Effectiveness of Teaching Methods/Materials

Faculty are regularly evaluated by their supervisors and their peers:

- Full-time faculty undergo peer observations annually, or every three years after receiving tenure.
- Full-time faculty submit a detailed self-assessment and are evaluated by the Dean of the Humanities Division annually.
- Part-time faculty are observed and evaluated by full-time faculty from their department, or by the Humanities Adjunct Coordinator, and meet with their evaluators to discuss the results and how best to act on them.

Art

The Art Department faculty, in their regular discussions and meetings, evaluate the effectiveness of course materials and teaching methods. Some recent changes resulting from these discussions include:

- Out of necessity, we have completely reimagined how we can offer our courses remotely or in a hybrid format where fully remote learning is feasible. We are now transitioning back to campus as much as we are able to safely (remote learning isn't ideal for the majority of our studio courses), but there are a lot of discussions taking place right now about all of the ways we can continue to use some of the things we have learned from this experience. For example, video conferencing could be an option for some work sessions when the instructor cannot be on campus, our eLearn learning management system is now being used to perform many of the functions we had hoped to use ePortfolios for, and we are now beginning to post important demonstrations and lectures online as recordings for students to refer to as needed.
- We have worked with our Institutional Effectiveness team to create standardized rubrics (see Appendix B) for evaluating student work and the effectiveness of our studio instruction. We are embedding the rubrics into our eLearn course shells to streamline the process, and we will be able to gauge a baseline score for this metric once we have had the rubric in use for a bit longer.
- The department has added 20 more DSLR cameras to our equipment to help students be more successful in the Photography course without having to purchase their own cameras. We also reevaluated and revamped the checkout process for borrowing cameras in collaboration with the EMP program. This helps make the course less prohibitively expensive for students, and thus more equitable.
- As mentioned before, the department has also recently acquired classroom sets of MacBook laptops and iPad Pros with Apple Pencils. We will begin using them in Foundations I classes where students don't normally have easy access to computers, and in Drawing I and II and Painting classes to be able to explore digital drawing and painting, and from there we will be exploring additional uses.

Music

Music has seen examples of evaluation of teaching methods and materials recently:

- The MUS 1030 Introduction to Music instructors have been using the McGraw Hill Connect software since the last academic audit. Student success rate in these courses is quite high in all three methods of instruction: face-to-face, hybrid, and asynchronous. This past summer, adjunct instructor William Fitzhugh (who teaches Fundamentals of Music and guitar lessons), rebuilt the course to accommodate the newer, 10th edition of the Roger Kamien textbook. This text includes more composers who have been historically underrepresented (particularly BIPOC and female composers) and has an easier integration of the e-book with the audio/video material.
- The music library, complete with moving storage racks, recently acquired new choral, vocal, and piano music that students have already been using and performing.
- During the pandemic, it became necessary for students enrolled in Piano Instruction and Class Piano to continue instruction and practice remotely from home, and 11 new Yamaha P71 keyboards (complete with keyboard stand, pedals, music stand, and adjustable bench) were purchased. Even though instruction is now in-person again, students without pianos at home continue to checkout keyboards. Snowball microphones were purchased for faculty to use, providing a much higher-quality sound on the student's end when participating in Zoom lessons and classes.
- Within the past year, the music program purchased MacBooks and iPads with Apple Pencils for both students and faculty to use. Programs and apps allow students to compose, arrange, and mix music, read and annotate scores. The keyboard lab has been upgraded to include a brand-new Yamaha keyboards with instructor's station; the newer keyboards provided a better touch and sound for Class Piano students.

- Due to student interest and to grow our instrument collection, we recently purchased a tenor saxophone, trombone, and a professional-level clarinet, available for student checkout.
- MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music, as mentioned earlier, underwent a course revision to remove *Introductory Musicianship* (Lynn) from the required course materials. Adjunct theory instructor William Fitzhugh will supplement the course with his own worksheets, preparing students for Theory/Ear Training 1.

3.4 Analysis and Modification of Teaching Methods

As mentioned above in section 3.3, faculty meet with their evaluators after observations and/or assessments are conducted. They discuss strengths, weaknesses, and brainstorm ways to improve their teaching methods. Faculty also meet after receiving data from course assessments (pre- and post-test data, QEP rubrics, grade distribution, etc.) and student evaluations to see if any areas can be improved.

Art

Faculty discussions of student progress often lead to changes in teaching methods in art studio courses. This is especially true of Foundations I classes, which include constantly changing student projects as instructors share ideas and reevaluate what might work best based on the overall quality of student output, student understanding of underlying learning objectives independent of output, and overall student engagement with and enthusiasm for the assignment. Drawing I and II classes tend to share still-life setups to keep different sections relatively standardized. These still-life setups are always tailored to the specific skills that students as a group need to develop further in order to meet course learning outcomes, as determined by the instructor's informal ongoing in-class assessment.

We have also begun using a new evaluation procedure for studio courses that we hope will help guide these modifications in a more focused way as we gather enough data to begin seeing trends (sample rubric in appendix B).

Music

Music has recently seen modification of collective approaches to teaching. A few examples include:

- In MUS 1002 Music Fundamentals, the Theory in a Box tutorials are no longer used since the company went out of business and have been replaced uTheory, an online program allowing students to complete assignments with live feedback and immediate grades. uTheory provides a better learning system for students in that they receive real-time feedback and can use mobile devices, allowing them the convenience of completing work without needing to print assignments.
- Students in MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music have been using *Introductory Musicianship* (Lynn) for at least three years, requiring students to purchase an additional textbook (*The Musician's Guide to Theory and Analysis* by Clendinning and Marvin) for Theory 1-3. Music faculty members are in the process of revising the required text for MUS 1002 to remove *Introductory Musicianship* from the required course materials. Students have expressed financial concerns at needing to buy an additional textbook, leading to the change in required materials.
- The course texts for Class Piano I and II have been slightly revised to include only one book per class (Class Piano I uses the *Prep Level* and Class Piano II uses *Level I* from Daniel Landes' *Class Piano Resource Materials*). Previously, students were required to purchase two books per class, and the texts were unnecessarily redundant.

3.5 Professional Development

It is perhaps the greatest evidence of our ability to demonstrate materials and guide our students through creative growth that the faculty of the Art and Music AFA programs continue to practice their crafts as professionals; faculty continue to exhibit, perform, play gigs, and maintain active presences in the

community as artists. This is imperative to maintain credibility since many students will not be convinced of instructors' abilities until they see them in action outside the classroom. In addition, faculty engage in ongoing professional development as educators through Vol State's faculty-led Teaching and Learning Center (TLC). The TLC offers an array of faculty development sessions throughout the fall, spring, and summer on topics such as diversity, equity, and inclusion, technology-enhanced learning, student engagement, etc. They also provide online resources and a blog where faculty can collaborate across disciplines. For more information, visit the TLC's website: <https://libguides.volstate.edu/tlc>.

Art

Art faculty are exhibition professionals and also provide artistic or educational services to outside groups. This also serves as a recruiting tool to the community and a networking opportunity with colleagues at colleges and universities in the region. When funding and time allow, Art faculty members also attend educational and art conferences. Recent examples:

- Abigail Felber: developed and co-hosted PD trainings *Culturally Responsive Teaching and the Brain*, *Alternative Assessments*, and *Are You Still Watching?: Self-Care for Educators*; attended SGC conference in 2018; led a Study Abroad group and taught a course in India in 2020; serves as leader for the Teaching Learning Commons.
- Patrick Green: Board Member of the Gallatin Arts Council; attended NCECA conference in 2019 and 2021; featured artist for the Fall Creek Falls State Park in Summer 2017; participated in 15 group exhibitions since 2017.
- Nathaniel Smyth: participated in the Hendersonville Arts Council group exhibition called *Humane Society: A View From Our Lenses*; attended GenCon conferences in 2017, 2018, and 2019.
- Shane Prine is brand new at Vol State beginning in Fall 2021, but he also has a strong exhibition record and has served as a juror and guest lecturer many times over the last few years.
- Art faculty also participate in the Faculty Art Exhibition on campus every 1-2 years.

Music

All four full-time faculty are active as professionals, attend conferences, and participate in professional development, although limited funding often makes this difficult. Participation in such events helps keep us current with best practices. A few examples include:

- Ben Graves performs regularly with his jazz trio in Nashville.
- Nancy Slaughter performs as a worship musician and leader at area churches.
- Lynn Peterson performs as a sideman in various capacities at Nashville area venues.
- Nicholas Reynolds regularly performs recitals, gives masterclasses, and teaches at music festivals.

3.6 Student Persistence and Success

In general, both Art and Music slightly outperform college averages for persistence and retention, and in the past two years, graduation rates for both degrees have also exceeded VSCC averages. (Please refer to Appendix G for student success and retention data.) Perhaps the most critical single element relative to student success is advising of our Music and Art AFA majors. In addition to the advising practices of the Art and Music departments, we also utilize an electronic early alert system that allows us to provide feedback to students about their progress while providing documentation to relevant college administration. Vol State has full-time completion advisors who follow up with students after an alert indicates a problem, which has made communication and response time much more effective.

Art

As the Art AFA program began to grow, the department saw a sharp increase in advising requirements and updated advising practices accordingly. New students in the program now receive an extremely thorough explanation of curriculum, course options, and registration processes. By front-loading advising

in this way, students become much more self-sufficient. It has reduced registration problems and student confusion, and subsequent advising sessions are much simpler and less time consuming.

As data has indicated a drop in our retention, likely as a result of moving studio classes online in the midst of the pandemic, our focus has shifted more to developing relationships with our students early, especially in core classes like Foundations Studio I, Drawing I and Art History Survey I. We also fully expect that the new design offerings coming soon will have a big impact on retention since we will more directly be meeting student expectations/demands.

Music

Music has identified and begun to correct a handful of critical oversights in the advising process of its majors having to do with catalog information as represented in DegreeWorks, the worksheets that all students can use with their advisors to map a plan towards graduation. We have attempted to make it clearer to students what they must do in what order to fulfill their degree requirements. Chair Nicholas Reynolds has assumed the responsibility of contacting all declared Music AFA majors at the beginning of each semester and furnishing a list of requirements, namely:

- Each Music AFA student must take or test out of MUS 1002 (Music Fundamentals) their first semester. Since the following three Music Theory/Ear Training courses in the four-semester Theory/Ear Training track are only offered once a year in specific semesters, if they fail to take this course in the Fall, they will be delayed a semester from graduating in two years.
- Music AFA students must take an applied private lesson and be enrolled in an ensemble every semester or totaling four of each of these classes.
- Each Music AFA major must take Class Piano I and Class Piano II or take private piano lessons which equip them to successfully perform an end of the semester jury representing the respective material from these classes.

Other examples of our commitment to student success in Music include:

- Conducting exit interviews with students upon successful graduation and integrating suggestions from Course Evaluations into faculty teaching methods.
- A more rigorous and hands-on approach to student advising helps ensure that students are well-advised by music faculty for the duration of their studies at Vol State. This will enable students to graduate in a timely fashion and guarantee success in transferring to a four-year institution. We expect to improve retention by at least 5-10% with this new approach.
- We use the technology of the EMP's recording facilities to provide students with valuable objectivity through the recording process. This interdisciplinary collaboration has resulted in two Bellwether Award nominations for excellence within the two departments.
- Piano labs are used as teaching tools in applying skills in composition, arranging, and music theory, and are available for student practice outside of class if practice rooms are occupied.
- In the summer of 2021, Nicholas Reynolds worked with the previous Chair Ben Graves to approve the purchase of 17 new Yamaha keyboards to replace the much older Kurzweil keyboards.
- During the COVID-19 pandemic, Nicholas Reynolds and Ben Graves approved the purchase of 11 keyboards for students enrolled in Class Piano or piano lessons to check out to practice from home. The keyboards are full-sized with weighted keys, a pedal, a keyboard stand, music stand, and an adjustable bench.
- Chair Nicholas Reynolds gave a workshop for Sumner County high school and middle school music teachers in the summer of 2021. The workshop established connections with many area schools, which will hopefully positively affect recruitment numbers. It has already led to Vol State

hosting the Middle Tennessee Vocal Association State Solo and Ensemble Competition in May 2022 and the possible donation of older keyboards from the piano lab to a high school in need.

4: Student Learning Assessment

4.1 Indicators of Student Learning Success

For Art and Music AFA students, the best benchmarks of student success are examples of the work they complete during their educational experience at Vol State. Thus, Art and Music faculty assess student learning in a more holistic and organic way than is possible in some other fields.

Art

Student success is gauged largely through the quality of the work they make: how well they can demonstrate a given technique or principle of design in class projects, and the overall quality of the work as a whole. This is especially relevant each spring when students submit work for the Annual Student Art Exhibition. We also put a lot of emphasis on the successes of our graduates in transferring into BFA programs and gaining employment and freelance work in related fields.

In an attempt to make this process a little less subjective, we also developed the studio assessment rubric found in Appendix B. This rubric was kept simple, as it's still ultimately a subjective assessment, but also so that the items being scored on the rubric can provide information about individual classes and student motivation and also directly reflect the program goals listed in section 1. This data will be a way to identify trends over time.

Examples of student artwork can be viewed at <https://www.volstate.edu/humanities/art>, and more can be made available during the site visit.

Music

The Pre- and Post-Tests provide data about student learning, specifically for Music and Art 1030 students. Additionally, Music faculty use several other performance-based assessment methods:

- Music students in the Songwriting classes, Bluegrass ensemble, Commercial Music Ensembles, and Show Stoppers all contribute to end-of-semester video recording projects that provide a valuable document of students' growth and ability at important junctures in their evolution.
- End-of-semester juries assess growth from our Private Lessons program, which is at the core of the Music AFA (see Appendix C).
- End-of-semester and regular performances of performance ensembles.
- Theory and Ear Training classes embrace traditional, regular sight-singing tests and end-of-semester exams.

4.2 Faculty Assessment of Student Learning

Our students are, almost without exception, active in their fields; as previously mentioned, there are numerous performances, recordings, or other semester-long endeavors that they are charged with completing. With this project-oriented approach to their disciplines, students give faculty an opportunity to monitor and guide their learning experience over time.

Art

Art students are expected to practice not only theoretical understanding but hands-on individualized creation. Student work is evaluated every few weeks (sometimes much more frequently depending on the class and the projects) by teachers and peers in formal oral &/or written critiques. In each course, teachers

follow and provide written rubrics appropriate to the media for evaluating student achievement of objectives (see sample in Appendix B).

- The art department ends the year with a juried exhibition, enlisting an arts professional or art faculty member from another institution to jury the student work to ensure neutrality and provide a professional, real-world experience for students. Since the pandemic, some discussion has been happening about also using our social media presence to highlight individual student profiles.
- As mentioned before, the Art Department has also worked with our Office of Institutional Effectiveness, Research, Planning, and Assessment to create a standardized rubric that we are beginning to embed into the eLearn course shells for our studio courses to streamline the process of gathering data to assess the quality of student work and instructional effectiveness in these courses. We are at the beginning stages of this process, and quantitative data is an inherently problematic way of assessing subjective work such as art and design, but the rubric was designed to take this into account so we are hopeful that this will prove to be a useful tool as we continue to gather data and discuss the findings.
- We experimented with an ePortfolio initiative to allow for better reflection on student progress and to make it easy for students to share their work with others, but it was found to be far too limited and too expensive, so this project was ended.

Music

Music assessment is a mixture of pre- and post-test assessment (MUS 1030), and performance project grading that is specific to classes. Students in music not only take classes but perform in various ensembles and/or musical productions, giving faculty an opportunity to see them rehearse as well as perform. In this way, faculty make assessments of both the quality of the finished product and the processes they employ. End-of-semester evaluations exist as well, involving faculty other than the student's primary instructor:

- Music faculty all participate in juries required of AFA majors and encouraged for all private instruction students. In addition to the full-time faculty members, four adjunct faculty members (piano, brass, and guitar) evaluate students by listening to the student's performance, the goal being to assess the student's progress from the individual semester. At the end of the student performance, faculty complete a rubricated jury analysis sheet (See Appendix C) to 1) make constructive criticism concerning the selection that was performed, and 2) to suggest a grade for that performance, which also figures heavily into the student's semester grade.
- Assessment in Theory and Ear Training classes takes place for students on a semesterly basis in the track, as well as regularly, via sight-singing quizzes, written music theory tests, and online assessments in the uTheory program.

4.3 Implementation of Improvements

Art

The quality of art is a very difficult thing to assess and quantify, but the Art department has established some effective rubrics to help guide faculty and explain the assessments to students.

- We have recently worked to standardize our rubrics to facilitate comparisons between courses. (See the Appendix B for samples.) When we notice recurring problems, we discuss and implement ways to better explain project assignments, more relevant examples to show students, new activities to explore content, etc.
- Faculty interaction has been especially essential over the last two years, where even our "hands on" studio classes had to be completely reimaged to work in a remote format and we would refer to the newly standardized rubrics as a basis to conduct more short-term surveys to help ensure that the quality of our instruction remained as strong as possible. Some of the technology and

techniques from our foray into remote learning are being used or repurposed to enhance our classes now that we have returned to campus instruction. (For example, video demonstrations and online discussion forums for critique.)

- As mentioned above, we are also looking into ways to more effectively use individual student profiles on our social media pages to extend the reach of our Student Art Exhibition capstone experience.
- The Art History classes have been updated to use a flipped classroom format and also to be more inclusive of non-western art and art history. According to anecdotal data collected from students taking the course, the accessibility of information has been broadened and improved, making the class more equitable and more inclusive. The flipped classroom model has helped students to become independent learners, with access to supplemental and robust support in the classroom.
- Many of the studio courses have been incorporating more use of self-reflection and other CRT (Culturally Responsive Teaching) methods.

Music

Music strives to normalize and share best practice information amongst instructors of Music Theory and Ear Training to achieve consistent results and refine expectations between lecture and lab. The faculty discuss objectives, sometimes in formal meetings but often in casual conversations. Recently we have reacted to identified shortcomings in student learning in the following ways:

- In Fall 2022, we will no longer use *Introductory Musicianship* (Lynn) for MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music. The text will instead be supplemented with worksheets created by adjunct Theory instructor William Fitzhugh. This will allow students better continuity between semesters and save them from having to purchase a preliminary text.
- There is a regular bi-monthly vocal lab, offering opportunities for periodic performance experience and peer review for our voice principles, as well as regular monthly recital opportunities for all AFA majors.
- Music outside of the traditional classical canon is being integrated into the faculty's studios, including compositions from the African diaspora, female composers, and other historically underrepresented composers.

5: Support

5.1 Library, Equipment, and Facilities

As with other areas related to our AFA programs, we continue to seek to improve our use of our facilities and equipment, to identify ways they can be built upon and improved, and to further realize the potential of what we already have.

Art

The Art Department relies heavily on facilities; drawing and painting courses require space for easels and still-life setups; ceramics and three-dimensional work requires space and equipment, particularly pottery wheels, kilns, and glazes; printmaking courses require access to printing presses, acid baths, and ventilation hoods; and design and photography classes, as well as all other art courses on occasion, make great use of our computer lab, printers, scanners, cameras, and drawing tablets.

We have recently built up our digital equipment significantly, adding classroom sets of MacBook laptops and iPad Pros with Apple Pencils, as well as upgrading our photo printer. We are currently in the process of upgrading our color laser printer as well. In summer 2021 we greatly increased our collection of still

life props for Drawing, Painting, and Foundations I classes, with emphasis on improving the quality and variety of artificial plants and flowers.

And finally, our gallery space is used to exhibit the work of professional artists, and to exhibit the best examples of student work each spring. We are beginning to improve the tools in the gallery used for installation, drywall repair, and painting.

Music

In the Thigpen Library, Music has about 3,232 books and materials through EBSCO alone and 67 from Safari Tech Books; however, this number does not factor in all the additional eBooks (music encyclopedias and dictionaries, other reference books) that are available from our database collections of reference materials (see CREDO, Gale Virtual Reference Library, General Reference Center Gold, and Oxford Reference Online). We also have a DVD collection including 75 DVDs with composer credits for original music and a music library of over 1000 historical CDs. Additionally, we have the luxury of:

- Soundproofed practice rooms
- A piano lab with smart instructor stations and a separate home for our Steinway grand piano.
- A formal instrument storage locker room for students and faculty.
- A dedicated copy room and home for our extensive music library/archives.

5.2. Operating Budget

The Art and Performing Arts Departments both have individual departmental budgets, and both also draw from the TAF budget to purchase items such as computer equipment and software.

Art

The Art Department does have a healthy budget that meets the needs of the program. Money is used to replenish supplies and equipment as needs arise, as well as to acquire additional big-budget items at the end of each fiscal year.

We also instituted some studio fees in Fall 2019 that are used to supplement this budget in providing more of the supplies for students directly, alleviating the need for them to purchase so much individually. This is especially helpful in beginning to make these courses a little more equitable in terms of costs. We are working to get to the point where we can balance these studio fees with the supply kits required for the courses, effectively building the cost of the supply kits into the course fees entirely and greatly reducing the hassle (and likely the cost as well) of purchasing these supplies.

Music

Music uses two budgets, Music Education and Music Performance, to support our annual needs. Music Performance is used for professional contracts and expenses to produce our annual recitals and shows and has proven to be adequate in recent years. Additionally, receipts from the musical performances, donations and CD sales go to the Music Department Scholarship Fund. This fund allows us to recruit students from high school, assist with the financial needs of music students, and makes us marketable in bringing quality students into the program. We also have individual need-based scholarships available.

5.3 History of Enrollment/Graduation

Art

Since its creation, the AFA Art major enrollment has grown quite a bit. The size of the program has declined a bit since the pandemic started in 2020, but it is still almost twice the size (in terms of declared majors) as it was when it first began in 2017. The Headcount in this program jumped from 23 in 2017 up to 64 in 2019 before falling a bit to 44 now in 2021.

Our graduation rate has remained fairly steady and actually grown despite the recent decline in declared majors. The graduation rate may not be especially high relative to the total number of majors, but this is a field in which a degree is not necessary to enter the field, and many students come to learn without finishing the degree being the final goal, so it is difficult to parse out a sense of how successful the program is by comparing enrollment to the graduation rate.

Music

Since the inception of the AFA Music program, there was a steady increase in enrollment, however in recent years the number has declined, partially due to the creation of the AAS Professional Music program in 2017. The Covid-19 pandemic has not helped enrollment and retention, but we are optimistic about future semesters. Efforts to improve enrollment and retention are underway, including working with local high schools and better advising of current students by music instructors.

Part IV: Potential Initiatives

The following initiatives are either a result of the analysis of the programs as discussed in this report or are a result of external influences. They are not presented in order of priority.

- Create additional studio space for Art: We need to annex another classroom from nearby lecture rooms to repurpose as an additional art studio. This would relieve a lot of scheduling issues that have arisen since our enrollment increased dramatically since the planning for our current building. A room has been identified, and we are working with the division dean to see what we can do to help make this happen.
- Develop a Graphic Design track for Art: The hiring of new graphic design instructor will allow us to pursue the development of additional design courses for students. We are in the planning stages of creating a degree track for this and exploring potential crossovers in the curricula of the EMP and Communications programs. As this is being instituted, success should be evidenced by enrollment numbers and feedback from transfer programs and local industry professionals.
- Create and fill new technician role for our facilities: With all of the facilities we now have in the Humanities building at the Gallatin campus (such as the Performing Arts Space and the Vol State Art Gallery), a need exists for a technician to serve the technical demands of both it and the Weymss Auditorium.
- Achieve accreditation from the National Association of Schools of Music: This is a long and challenging initiative, involving curriculum modifications, as well as facility requirements. We now have the space and physical resources (study and performance space, practice rooms, etc.) to realize this long-standing goal. Communication with the NASM will begin in the summer of 2022 to see if this is a feasible goal for the near future.
- Create a pre- and post-test instrument for Music Theory courses: This will inform faculty of students' knowledge of music theory upon enrolling in classes at Vol State, and to better understand students' proficiency and retention of skills learned in previous semesters. Theory instructors will need to work together to create and employ these instruments.
- Need for outreach/recruitment in Music: Due to our low enrollment, the music program is revising our recruitment strategies and reaching out to local high schools to improve our relationships within the community. High School Music Day, hosting high school events on campus, and workshops for high school music instructors and students will help us realize this goal.
- Need for a performance grand piano to be housed permanently in Wemyss Auditorium: It is very expensive to rent a grand piano for performances in Wemyss Auditorium. While the cost of purchasing a quality grand piano is much higher, it will pay for itself in time, and allow for more

guest artists to visit Vol State's performance hall. Significant funds and climate control are necessary for this initiative. Fundraising efforts are already underway.

Part V: Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

<i>No.</i>	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicators</i>	<i>When</i>
1	Develop a Graphic Design track for Art	Increase course offerings in design and build a degree program as either an AFA concentration or an AAS degree	Art Department Chair, Dean of Humanities, and Vice President of Academic Affairs	Enrollment numbers in the developed courses, and eventually the degree program, will be a strong indicator of student demand. Feedback from transfer universities and local industry professionals will be necessary for ensuring the quality of the program.	Academic year 2022-2023
2	Create additional studio space for Art	Grow the physical space of the Art Department to make space for additional students	Art Department Chair, Dean of Humanities, and Director of Facilities	The ability to offer enough studio courses to meet demand without adversely sacrificing open studio time	Fall 2023
3	Achieve accreditation from the National Association of Schools of Music	This affects our regional and national reputation as an institution and remains an important goal.	Music Department Chair and full-time faculty	Achieving accreditation	Beginning Summer 2022, ongoing. This will likely be a two-year process.
4	Create a pre- and post-test instrument for Music Theory courses	To better understand the effectiveness of our instruction in these classes.	Full-time Music faculty and adjuncts	Completion of the project and a successful pilot	Summer 2022 development Fall 2022 pilot
5	Improve Music outreach/ recruitment, enrollment, and graduation rates	To improve our outreach efforts to increase our student enrollment	Full-time Music faculty	Increase enrollment and graduation rates by at least 10%.	Fall 2022
6	Purchase performance grand piano	Higher quality instrument for students, faculty, and guest artists to perform on	Music faculty, the Vol State Foundation	Significant fundraising and donations are required to purchase this instrument.	Fall 2027

Part VI: Follow-Up Report

Recommendation 1

The team recommends more research into the Music low graduation rates.

Follow-Up:

Since the last audit, the Music program has seen a decline in graduation rates, largely due to the Covid-19 pandemic and lower enrollment numbers. In recent years, faculty members have become more involved in recruitment and increased visibility in local public schools. In addition, the music faculty believes it is important for them to directly advise music students so they can better guide them and is working with the advising office to send them students directly.

Recommendation 2

The team recommends that more effort be put into acquiring instruments students need, such as pianos, percussion, and other band instruments.

Follow-Up:

The music program has recently acquired a tenor saxophone, trombone, professional-level clarinet, a full keyboard lab with instructor's station, and several full-sized weighted keyboards for piano students to checkout during their studies. In addition, damp chasers have been installed on both grand pianos to ensure longevity by controlling humidity and temperature.

Recommendation 3

The team recommends that faculty, including adjuncts, have more academic control over the content of their courses, including online courses.

Follow-Up:

Art

Adjunct faculty in the Art Department currently have near total control over the content of their courses *so long as they are adequately meeting all student learning objectives for the course*. All faculty, including adjuncts, are supported by the department in this regard, including access to course manuals, examples of assignments, and (when available) model course shells, and regular discussions (and official meetings as called for) are held to support the open exchange of ideas and tips for teaching the various courses effectively. This helps keep the course content current and fresh, and facilitates better communication about student progress.

Music

Model course shells for MUS 1030 Introduction to Music are copied for each section, but full-time and adjunct faculty are allowed freedom to teach their lectures or add additional assignments/discussions as they see fit. The four theory courses currently have three different instructors; while they teach independently, the instructors coordinate assignments to ensure students' learning objectives are met.

Recommendation 4

The team recommends that additional faculty and staff be hired to support these programs.

Follow-Up:

Art

Since the last audit, the Art Department has added two more full-time faculty, doubling the number in the department and allowing the department to expand its offerings in two of its most popular studio areas: ceramics and graphic design. Patrick Green was hired in 2018 and now runs our ceramics area, and Shane Prine was just hired in 2021 to begin building a new program in graphic design.

Music

One new full-time faculty member has been added to the Performing Arts department since the last audit, with degrees in piano performance and experience teaching both music majors and secondary majors.

Recommendation 5

The team recommends that the Music adjunct faculty be more included in the workings of the department.

Follow-Up:

Two new adjunct faculty members have been hired to the Performing Arts department with training in music theory and piano performance. All adjunct faculty are directly involved in the end-of-semester showcases, recitals, and theory instruction.

Appendix A – Visual and Performing Arts Calendars

A schedule of exhibitions in the college art gallery, including current, recent, and future shows, can be found at <https://www.volstate.edu/humanities/art/gallery>.

A schedule of the 2021-2022 Music Calendar is listed below.

Voice Recitals: September 7, October 5, November 2, and December 7, 2021, at the Gallatin Public Library. Students studying voice with Professors Nancy Slaughter and Mark Granlund performed voice recitals of music from the Baroque period to modern day.

Vol State Singers: October 20 and November 17, 2021, in Wemyss Auditorium. Led by Professor Nancy Slaughter, Vol State Singers performed short concerts during school hours for the staff, students, and Gallatin community.

Vol State Singers: November 21, 2021, in Wemyss Auditorium. Vol State Singers perform their end-of-semester concert, featuring a full-length program of music from the classical and modern eras.

Music Winter Showcase: December 3-4, 2021 at 7:30 PM in Wemyss Auditorium. Students and faculty in Showstoppers, Vol State Jazz, Bluegrass Ablaze, Songwriting, and the Theater program performed solos and group performances.

AFA Music Sophomore Recital: Sunday, April 3, 2022 in the Vol State Choral Room. Elizabeth Chandler and music faculty and pianist Dr. Nicholas Reynolds collaborate in recital.

Spring Showcase: April 29 and 30, 2022 at 7:30 PM in Wemyss Auditorium. Vol State Singers, Commercial Music Ensemble, Bluegrass Ablaze, and the Theater program will perform solos and group performances.

Appendix B – Scoring Rubrics

Long form:

Indicate numerical value 1 - 5 for each assessment category

For college level standards:

5 points = Excellent: meets or exceeds requirements (A)

4 points = Good: meets most requirements and exceeds some (B)

3 points = Adequate: meets requirements but shows weakness in some (C)

2 points = Weak: meets some requirements but below college level standards (D)

1 points = Unacceptable: fails to meet most or all requirements and standards (F)

Assessment categories 1 – 4	
	1. Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater)
	Includes appropriate issues and materials as assigned
	Describes the artistic experience or event in a clear and appropriate manner
	Makes proper use of learned vocabulary specific to the discipline
	Follows format and assignment requirements
	2. Analysis and Evaluation of the artistic experience or event
	Thoughtful and clear evaluation based on the learned methods of the discipline
	Makes specific claims or responses, backed by reasoning and information
	Evaluations or responses show understanding of the issues in the area of study
	Evaluations show understanding of the assignment goals
	3. Personal insight and response
	Shows personal insight as appropriate backed by reasoning
	Shows thoughtful observation and learning
	Shows originality
	4. Writing Skills
	Ideas are well organized and in proper paragraph form
	Correct use of diction, syntax, , and mechanics of writing
	Sentence structure is clear, varied, and fluid
	Words are used correctly and aptly
	Supporting material is appropriate, adequate and convincing
	If the instructor chooses to use this form as direct student feedback, enter a grade for the student (letter, points or %) appropriate to your course grading style

Short Form:

Preview Rubric

Rubric Response Papers v13

Criteria	Level 5	Level 4	Level 3	Level 2	Level 1
Understanding of assignment & meets needs of the discipline	excellent	good	adequate	weak	unacceptable
Analysis of artistic works or event : supported by evidence & use of terms	excellent	good	adequate	weak	unacceptable
Personal Insight: thoughtful observations	excellent	good	adequate	weak	unacceptable
Writing Skills: organization, grammar, word usage etc	excellent	good	adequate	weak	unacceptable
Overall Score	Level 5	Level 4	Level 3	Level 2	Level 1

Studio Evaluation Rubric:

| STUDIO EVALUATION

ART 1350 AFA Studio Evaluation Rubric

CLOSE

☐ Show all standards

Total Score: 0/0 - 0.00% - Mean 0.00

CLEAR SELECTION

ELEMENTS	VERY GOOD	ACCEPTABLE	NEEDS WORK
Formal Qualities Includes Principles and Elements of Art and Design: Line, Shape, Composition, etc	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points Needs Work
Comment			
Conceptual Ideas Creativity in using the principles and elements. Is the idea conveyed successfully	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points
Comment			
On target with the assignment Were the assignment guidelines followed?	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points Needs Work
Comment			
Craftsmanship Clean margins, evenly cut or torn paper, no smudges, etc.	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points Needs Work
Comment			
Effort On time and complete, general effort and commitment to the project	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points Needs Work
Comment			

Appendix C – Music AFA Jury Sheet

Jury Performance Sheet Volunteer State Community College

Student _____ Semester _____ Instrument _____

Instructor _____ Number of semesters studied _____

List jury piece(s):

List all literature, scales, and chords studied this semester:

Students do not write below this line.

Please rate the following from 1-10 (10 being the best)

Preparedness of the score (notes, rhythms, basics) _____

Musicianship (dynamics, phrasing, expressiveness) _____

Quality of sound (pitch, color, placement, breath) _____

Technique (tension, agility, body alignment) _____

Physical appearance / Stage presence _____

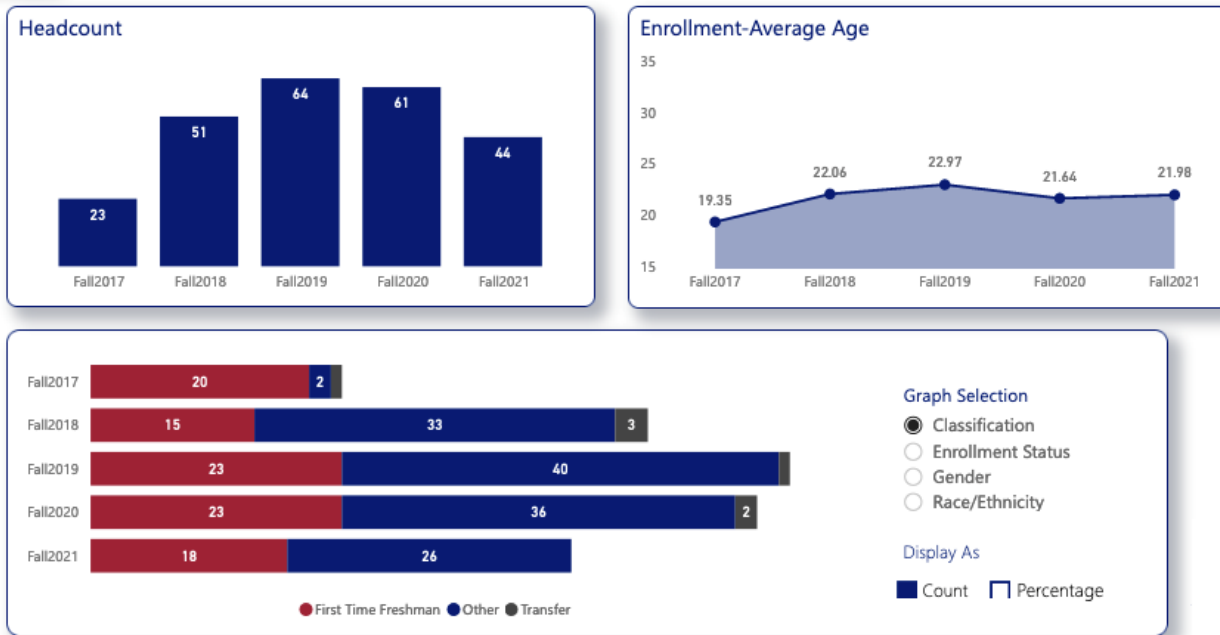
Memorization _____

Total (out of 60) _____

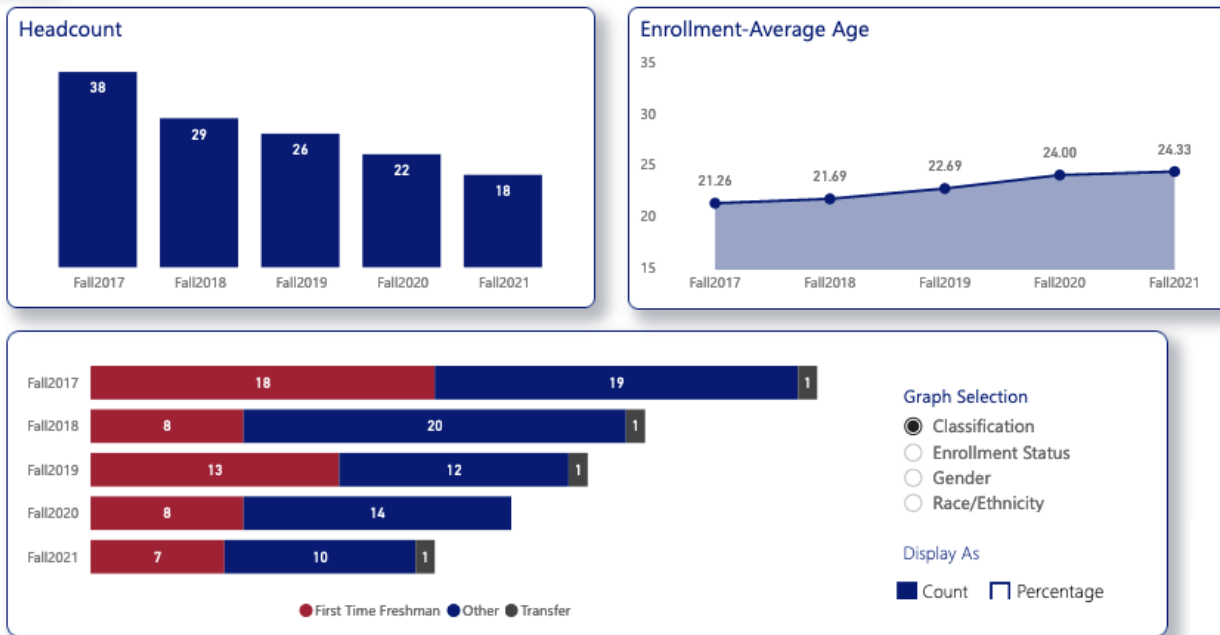
Comments:

Appendix D – Majors and Graduates

AFA Art Enrollment:



AFA Music Enrollment:



AFA Graduates:

Concentrations	16-17	17-18	18-19	19-20	20-21
Art (Studio)		3	11	11	13
Music	4	2	4	9	3

Appendix E – VPA Writing Assessment

Visual & Performing Arts (including Theatre) Writing Assessment Results (Spring 2017)

Prepared by the Office of Institutional Effectiveness Research Planning & Assessment

Full-time and adjunct faculty teaching general education courses in Visual & Performing Arts used a scoring rubric to assess student writing in Art 1030, Music 1030, and Theater 1030 courses. The rubric used a 5-point scale to score students (5=excellent and 1=unacceptable). This report contains the results aggregated by course and overall.

As shown in Table 1, a little over three quarters of students enrolled in these courses (at time of Census) were scored using the rubric. Table 2 displays mean item and overall assessment scores by course. Students in the music course had the highest average assessment score of all courses (avg = 4.38 on a 5-point scale.) Table 3 indicates statistically significant differences in averages between courses. Theater courses were awarded statistically significant lower scores than Art and Music for Item “Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater),” Item “Personal insight and response” as well as the overall rubric score. Music courses had statistically significant higher scores than Art and Theater for items “Personal insight and response” and Item “Writing Skills.” Table 4 includes frequencies by scoring categories for all items and courses.

Table 1: Enrolled students scored using the writing assessment rubric

Course	No Assignment Completed		Assignment Completed	
	N	%	N	%
ART 1030	65	16.20%	336	83.80%
MUS 1030	104	25.90%	297	74.10%
THEA 1030	22	16.30%	113	83.70%
Total	191	20.40%	746	79.60%

Table 2: Frequencies and means for assessment items

	Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater)		Analysis and evaluation of the artistic experience or event		Personal insight and response		Writing skills		Overall	
Course	N	Avg	N	Avg	N	Avg	N	Avg	N	Avg
ART 1030	336	4.44	336	4.17	335	4.22	334	4.19	336	4.25
MUS 1030	295	4.36	292	4.29	291	4.45	292	4.39	297	4.38
THEA 1030	113	4.05	113	4.10	113	3.88	113	3.97	113	4.00
Total	744	4.35	741	4.21	739	4.26	739	4.24	746	4.26

Table 3: Means Statistical Significance

	Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater)	Analysis and evaluation of the artistic experience or event	Personal insight and response	Writing skills	Overall
Course					
(A) ART 1030	C		C		C
(B) MUS 1030	C		AC	AC	C
(C) THEA 1030					

Results are based on two-sided tests assuming equal variances. For each significant pair, the key of the smaller category appears in the category with the larger mean.

Significance level for upper case letters (A, B, C):

.05

a Tests are adjusted for all pairwise comparisons within a row of each innermost subtable using the Bonferroni correction.

Table 4: Frequency distribution for assessment items

Item	Level	ART 1030		MUS 1030		THEA 1030		Total	
		N	%	N	%	N	%	N	%
Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater)	Unacceptable (1)	1	0.30%	3	1.00%	0	0.00%	4	0.50%
	Weak (2)	6	1.80%	5	1.70%	1	0.90%	12	1.60%
	Adequate	43	12.80%	48	16.30%	26	23.00%	117	15.70%
	Good (4)	81	24.10%	65	22.00%	52	46.00%	198	26.60%
	Excellent (5)	205	61.00%	174	59.00%	34	30.10%	413	55.50%
	Total	336	100.00%	295	100.00%	113	100.00%	744	100.00%
Analysis and evaluation of the artistic experience or event	Unacceptable (1)	0	0.00%	9	3.10%	0	0.00%	9	1.20%
	Weak (2)	9	2.70%	12	4.10%	0	0.00%	21	2.80%
	Adequate	61	18.20%	38	13.00%	26	23.00%	125	16.90%
	Good (4)	130	38.70%	60	20.50%	50	44.20%	240	32.40%
	Excellent (5)	136	40.50%	173	59.20%	37	32.70%	346	46.70%
	Total	336	100.00%	292	100.00%	113	100.00%	741	100.00%
Personal insight and response	Unacceptable (1)	1	0.30%	8	2.70%	0	0.00%	9	1.20%
	Weak (2)	16	4.80%	5	1.70%	8	7.10%	29	3.90%
	Adequate	45	13.40%	27	9.30%	31	27.40%	103	13.90%
	Good (4)	119	35.50%	59	20.30%	40	35.40%	218	29.50%
	Excellent (5)	154	46.00%	192	66.00%	34	30.10%	380	51.40%
	Total	335	100.00%	291	100.00%	113	100.00%	739	100.00%
Writing skills	Unacceptable (1)	1	0.30%	5	1.70%	0	0.00%	6	0.80%
	Weak (2)	13	3.90%	6	2.10%	2	1.80%	21	2.80%
	Adequate	64	19.20%	33	11.30%	25	22.10%	122	16.50%
	Good (4)	101	30.20%	73	25.00%	60	53.10%	234	31.70%
	Excellent (5)	155	46.40%	175	59.90%	26	23.00%	356	48.20%
	Total	334	100.00%	292	100.00%	113	100.00%	739	100.00%

Appendix F – Pre-/Post-Test Analysis Fall 2016-Spring 2020

Table 1. Means & Correlations of Pre-test/Post-test scores and final course grades.									
		Fall 2016	Spring 2017	Fall 2017	Spring 2018	Fall 2018	Spring 2019	Fall 2019	Spring 2020
	Exam Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score
Art	Pre	48.16	46.92	48.29	45.22	46.74	46.16	45.40	46.09
	Post	58.61	63.64	63.31	60.00	62.80	58.39	58.18	63.03
	Difference	10.45	16.72	15.02	14.78	16.06	12.23	12.78	16.94
	Final course grade of Post-test takers	3.16	3.31	3.32	3.18	3.29	3.17	3.20	3.41
	Correlation of Post-test score with final grade	0.25	0.33	--	0.27	0.11	--	0.14	--
Music	Pre	--	63.31	63.16	59.19	60.50	60.79	62.08	59.92
	Post	--	74.79	77.90	74.99	78.08	73.66	77.19	76.91

	Difference	--	11.48	14.74	15.80	17.58	12.87	15.11	16.99
	Final course grade of Post-test takers	--	3.17	3.32	3.56	3.54	3.43	3.37	3.55
	Correlation of Post-test score with final grade	--	0.21	--	0.17	0.15	--	0.21	0.24
	Pre	49.58	55.16	55.78	53.03	50.71	53.08	54.06	53.05
	Post	59.04	69.06	69.55	67.81	68.96	65.29	68.43	69.48
	Difference	9.46	13.90	13.77	14.78	18.25	12.21	14.37	16.43
	Final course grade of Post-test takers	3.11	3.21	3.30	3.41	3.39	3.29	3.29	3.48
	Correlation of Post-test score with final grade	0.23	0.24	--	0.26	0.12	--	0.19	0.17
Significant differences in average Pre-test and Post-test scores are indicated in bold (p<0.05).									
Only significant correlations are shown (p<0.05).									

Appendix G – Success and Retention Rates

AFA Art Retention:

Fall to Spring Persistence

NA
Fall 2016 to Spring 2017
78.3%
Fall 2017 to Spring 2018
65.0%
Fall 2018 to Spring 2019
67.9%
Fall 2019 to Spring 2020
59.6%
Fall 2020 to Spring 2021

Fall to Fall Retention

NA
Fall 2016 to Fall 2017
69.6%
Fall 2017 to Fall 2018
40.0%
Fall 2018 to Fall 2019
47.3%
Fall 2019 to Fall 2020
38.8%
Fall 2020 to Fall 2021

3yr Graduation Rate*

NA
Fall 2016 Freshman Cohort
40.0%
Fall 2017 Freshman Cohort
26.7%
Fall 2018 Freshman Cohort

AFA Music Retention:

Fall to Spring Persistence

76.7%
Fall 2016 to Spring 2017
67.6%
Fall 2017 to Spring 2018
85.2%
Fall 2018 to Spring 2019
81.0%
Fall 2019 to Spring 2020
75.0%
Fall 2020 to Spring 2021

Fall to Fall Retention

50.0%
Fall 2016 to Fall 2017
57.1%
Fall 2017 to Fall 2018
52.2%
Fall 2018 to Fall 2019
60.0%
Fall 2019 to Fall 2020
50.0%
Fall 2020 to Fall 2021

3yr Graduation Rate*

6.7%
Fall 2016 Freshman Cohort
33.3%
Fall 2017 Freshman Cohort
25.0%
Fall 2018 Freshman Cohort

VSCC Overall Retention:

Fall to Spring Persistence

68.5%
Fall 2016 to Spring 2017

67.4%
Fall 2017 to Spring 2018

67.6%
Fall 2018 to Spring 2019

67.6%
Fall 2019 to Spring 2020

63.1%
Fall 2020 to Spring 2021

Fall to Fall Retention

43.6%
Fall 2016 to Fall 2017

44.0%
Fall 2017 to Fall 2018

43.4%
Fall 2018 to Fall 2019

44.0%
Fall 2019 to Fall 2020

40.6%
Fall 2020 to Fall 2021

3yr Graduation Rate*

20.9%
Fall 2016 Freshman Cohort

23.0%
Fall 2017 Freshman Cohort

22.0%
Fall 2018 Freshman Cohort

*Graduation Rates cannot be filtered by Classification

Art Grade Distribution by Course 2016-2020:

Course	A	B	C	D	F	FA	I	N	NR	W
ART 100	2	1	1		1					
ART 1030	806	517	280	106	197	77		2		111
ART 1035	1206	531	256	147	273	240	6		1	135
ART 1045	67	36	17	10	5	16	1	6		10
ART 1050	22	14	11	3	5	3		5		
ART 1340	80	89	31	14	34	21	4		1	12
ART 135	45	9	4	1	1	2	4	8		
ART 1350	40	25	4	1	2	2				4
ART 136	12	11						1		3
ART 145	4			1				7		
ART 155	66	44	10	6	3	17		1		13
ART 2000	44	44	25	15	14	8	2	3		9
ART 2020	29	29	11	7	7	2	3			7
ART 211	8	9	6	2	1		1			1
ART 212	1							1		
ART 253	38	23	11	3	6	6				2
ART 280T	35	8	1				6	11		1
Total	2505	1390	668	316	549	394	27	45	2	308

Grade	Fall 2016	Fall 2017	Fall 2018	Fall 2019	Fall 2020	Spring 2016	Spring 2017	Spring 2018	Spring 2019	Spring 2020
A	9148	9543	10119	10300	9597	7622	8394	8733	8918	9464
B	7168	7209	7072	6721	5627	5471	5862	5818	5807	5494
C	4113	4067	4037	3824	3140	3511	3511	3269	3333	2889
D	1461	1479	1429	1434	1265	1265	1336	1314	1285	1100
F	4411	2603	2816	2709	2785	3508	3702	1890	2190	3695
F.				1						
FA		2126	2702	2693	3345			1643	1842	220
I	161	129	114	104	132	142	107	106	67	235
N	28	32	36	25	19	33	25	29	33	27
NR	3		31	22	2		1	1		1
P	43	58	48	44	33	53	43	53	80	63
W	2055	1871	1968	1833	2180	1539	1527	1339	1402	1374

General Education Review, Cohort A- Cycle 2

Communication GE

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

Program and institution mission alignment

How does the mission of the area align to the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Gen. Ed. Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The goal of the communication requirement is to enhance the effective use of the English language essential to students' success in school and in the world by way of learning to read and listen critically and to write and speak thoughtfully, clearly, coherently, and persuasively.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the area align with the mission of the institution? The program mission of enhancing communication skills directly supports the college's commitment to providing quality innovative educational programs. Effective communication is essential for students' success in school and beyond, aligning with the college's goal of preparing students for successful careers and university transfer. Additionally, improved communication abilities foster cultural awareness and diversity, supporting the college's dedication to promoting these values within its community.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A Assessment Plan

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule

5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

English:

Since the last General Education review, the English Department decided it would make more sense to assess English 1010 only in the fall and English 1020 only in the spring based on course offerings (i.e., more students take 1010 in the fall and 1020 in the spring). Of the seven TBR outcomes, English assesses five, including: primary purpose, rhetorical patterns, written/oral presentations, problem-solving and decision-making, and evidence, analysis, and persuasive strategies. Mapped to a rubric, this translates to primary purpose, ordering major points, developing ideas, diction/syntax/grammar, and supporting information. For both English 1010 and 1020, we consider the research paper as the student-learning piece. Students are scored from Excellent-Good-Average-Fair-Poor, and there's an N/A section to account for students who drop the course and/or do not turn in a paper. Anything from fair-excellent is considered "met," with a target of 80% of students meeting each outcome. Faculty find assessing every single student in every single outcome on the rubric to be cumbersome and unnecessary. Previously, random samples were used, which seemed to work well. The English Department has discussed other methods to assess outcomes, including reverting to some traditional methods like meeting in person and having a group of faculty assess a random stack of papers from across different sections. We plan to explore other methods and vote at the end of the semester.

Communication:

Communication Studies department faculty work collaboratively to develop, evaluate, and modify assessment instruments to ensure that learning outcomes remain measurable and meaningful. Once the assessment method is developed, an assessment rubric is created and used by all faculty that teach that course. Based on the assessment data, the faculty review the assessment assignments and make changes as needed to improve student achievement. Using the results of the student learning outcome assessments, faculty evaluate teaching strategies to determine the best way to achieve these student learning outcomes. GE.COMM.1 Oral and/or Written Expression, GE.COMM.4 Writing and/or Speaking Processes Components, GE.COMM.2 Primary Purpose, and GE.COMM.5 Written and/or Oral Presentations are assessed in COMM 2025 annually. These outcomes are assessed using the Informative Speech and Peer/Self Evaluation in COMM 2025. GE.COMM.1 Oral and/or Written Expression, GE.COMM.4 Writing and/or Speaking Processes Components, GE.COMM.2 Primary Purpose, and GE.COMM.5 Written and/or Oral Presentations are assessed in COMM 2045 annually. These outcomes are assessed using the Persuasive Speech and the Peer/Self Evaluation in COMM 2045. Students are scored from Exemplary, Meets Expectations, Developing, Novice, and Not Acceptable. Exemplary and Meets Expectations are considered meeting expectations, while Developing, Novice, and Not Acceptable are considered not meeting expectations.

Evidence:

- GECOMM, Assessment Tool

2.B Evidence of Student Learning

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the general education area course list.

Utilizing the assessment matrix and gateway data provided please provided the following:

1. Provide an analysis of trends found within the data.
2. Identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.
3. Review disaggregated data for gateway courses to identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning for gateway courses.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1	95.79%	4.21%	70.27%	29.73%	63.38%	36.62%	
PLO 2	90.91%	9.09%	84.11%	15.89%	79.69%	20.31%	
PLO 3	96.34%	3.66%	88.41%	11.59%	86.79%	13.21%	
PLO 4	95.77%	4.23%	71.94%	28.06%	62.93%	37.07%	

PLO 5	92.28%	7.72%	87.91%	12.09%	83.63%	16.37%	
PLO 6	92.68%	7.32%	85.55%	14.45%	83.81%	16.19%	
PLO 7	93.29%	6.71%	85.79%	14.21%	84.36%	15.64%	
Course Learning Outcome 2025.1			69.58%	30.42%	54.15%	45.85%	
Course Learning Outcome 2025.6			74.27%	25.73%	58.51%	41.49%	
Course Learning Outcome 2025.8			69.51%	30.49%	60.14%	39.86%	

Course Learning Outcome COMM 2025 2025.1 Primary Purpose 2025.6 Oral Delivery 2025.8 Self Evaluation

1. Analysis of trends

Analysis of PLOs: There is a noticeable decline in the percentage of students meeting certain outcomes over the three years, particularly for PLO 1 and PLO 4. This suggests a need to investigate and address potential challenges in these areas. PLO 2, PLO 3, PLO 5, PLO 6, and PLO 7 have maintained relatively high percentages of students meeting the outcomes, with all meeting the 80% target in the three-year average. This indicates strengths in these areas of the curriculum. Despite the declines in some areas, the general trend across all PLOs is toward a significant proportion of students meeting the learning outcomes. This suggests effective teaching and learning processes in place, though there's room for targeted improvements.

CLOs 2025: Karen

The sharply lower attainments in proficiency are very likely due to proficiencies that were failed to be met during the pandemic. Extensive online instruction and decreased student engagement produced students whose writing and comm skills were weaker than if instruction had been in person. It is anticipated that a return to traditional instruction modalities with prompt and frequent feedback on speeches will result in a regression toward the mean as in previous years. However, there may be a latency of a year due to the gradual nature of the transition back to traditional residential instruction. Observed trends are in keeping with those of peer institutions with similar student demographics and desired education educational outcomes. Further analysis including factor analysis and root cause would be required if the trends persist despite return to pre pandemic instructional modalities. The results furnish a cautionary tale that distributed education may not produce effectively identifiable student outcomes, even in courses that are functionally equivalent. Further investigation should explore any statistically significant difference and persistence and attainment of core objectives between online and on ground sections. A factor analysis should differentiate student achievement in light of available demographic information via the office of RESI. Self-reflection is more resistant to changes in instructional modality whereas delivery of speeches and brainstorming of ideas for topics is inherently simpler in a traditional classroom environment in which participants share a greater degree of intimacy and rapport with instructor. Differences could be attributed to looking inward alone. To support this hypothesis, we could look at metrics for online courses this semester and compare the results of online and in-person. Significant challenges remain equalizing online and traditional face-to-face modalities of instruction.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

English: PLO1 relates to rhetorical strategies in English classes. Students tend to struggle with rhetorical concepts. The model course could be improved by scaffolding these ideas to increase understanding. PLO4, which focuses on process writing in English classes, highlights the importance of guiding students through the various stages of writing, from pre-writing and drafting to revising and editing. Students often face challenges in understanding that writing is a process that involves multiple revisions and feedback cycles to enhance clarity, coherence, and effectiveness. To address these challenges and improve outcomes for PLO4, the model course could be enhanced by incorporating more explicit instruction on each step of the writing process.

Communication:

Assignments could be benchmarked throughout the semester to measure key indicators as students progress through the course. Additionally, the benchmarked assignments could provide opportunities for support in the Learning Commons, or by faculty appointment for students who fail to achieve significant progress throughout the semester. The threshold of significance would be defined by the common opinion of the faculty and identical instruments made available to each course throughout the department. After benchmark 1 is identified, faculty could analyze who did not meet the benchmark, and refer students for support.

Evidence:

- COMM2025 Peer _ Self Eval AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115712
- COMM2045 Peer _ Self Evaluation AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115732
- Communications Student Course Evals AY20-23

- ENG1010 Gen Outcome Assessment AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115652
- ENG1020 General Education Outcome Assessment AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115557
- GE COMM CLOs AY21-23
- GE COMM PLOs AY20-23
- GE COMM PLOs Gender AY21-23
- GE COMM PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-22
- GE COMM PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- GE COMM, Assessment Plan
- Student Pass Rate COMM Intro Courses
- Submitted University Parallel Academic Audit-1 (1)

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.

English

The 5:5 teaching load significantly burdens faculty, particularly in composition courses requiring extensive feedback, a task made more challenging by rising class sizes. This diminishes the opportunity for personalized feedback, crucial for developing writing and critical thinking skills. Smaller class sizes could improve outcomes by allowing more individualized attention. Moreover, the English Department's loss of 8 full-time faculty members, with no replacements, necessitates reliance on last-minute, often inexperienced temporary hires. This leads to student complaints due to inconsistent teaching quality and disrupts the educational experience. Full-time faculty, stretched thin by overloads to compensate for staffing shortages, face burnout, hindering their ability to support and engage students effectively. This situation underscores the urgent need for systemic changes, including addressing full-time faculty shortages and reevaluating the use of temporary hires. Investing in experienced full-time faculty recruitment and retention is essential for departmental stability, teaching quality, and student success.

Communication

Three years ago, in 2021, the same outcomes were analyzed and one of the initiatives/requests was a NEW full-time faculty position at the Springfield/Highland Crest campus.. This position would allow our department to service both Highland Crest and the surrounding High Schools (especially Robertson County). This request was not fulfilled; therefore, this need is being communicated three years later. The full-time faculty member could teach at Highland Crest (possibly a course during the day and an evening course) along with staffing many of the local Robertson County HS to make a full load. This new position would provide a dedicated person at Highland Crest and the surrounding Robertson County HS ensuring we meet the demand for classes and ensuring consistent high caliber instruction.

2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

English:

Addressing the shortfall in full-time faculty by hiring more permanent instructors could stabilize the department and improve teaching quality. Full-time faculty are generally more available for student support and mentorship, positively impacting student achievement and satisfaction.

3.B. Course Offerings

1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.

2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

3.B. Course Offerings

1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.

English:

Students do not do as well in online classes. Additionally, academic integrity in online classes is an issue. We have spoken with the interim president and VPAA about offering more in-person classes, which they support, but we would need funding for more faculty to teach on-ground.

Communication:

Course modality has been identified as an area of investigation since a noticeable difference in student success regarding modality has been observed.

2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Students who enrolled in the online sections of 2025 and 2045 did not perform as well as students who enrolled in face-to-face sections of the same course. Due to this observation, more face-to-face sections and fewer online sections are being offered in an effort to increase student success. The same is true for English.

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 4 initiatives in total.

General education areas may include separate action plans for each discipline or may label each initiative to identify which discipline is responsible for the initiative within its area if deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
1 (English).	Implement OER in English 1020 courses.	To reduce textbook costs and increase accessibility for all students enrolled in English 1020, aiming to enhance engagement and improve success rates.	English faculty	(1) Increase in course success rates by 2% over the first three years. (2) Monitoring student feedback on resource accessibility and usefulness.	Implementation in fall 2024 with ongoing assessment over the next three academic years.	Need overall success rates in ENGL 1020.
2 (English) (SL)	Offer a new co-requisite model for	To increase success and retention	English team focused	(1) 5% increase in success and	Development and pilot phase in the	Need rates.

	English 0810.	rates for learning support students in English 1010 by providing additional support and resources tailored to their needs.	on learning support.	retention rates over the next 3 years for English learning support students. (2) Collection of qualitative feedback from students on the co-requisite model's effectiveness.	upcoming academic year, with full implementation and review over the following two years.	
3 (Communication).	Refocus departmental assessment for COMM 2025	To increase success rate in face-to-face COMM 2025 sections	Comm Studies Faculty	(1) Increase number of f2f sections over the next two years (2) Benchmark assignment to evaluate progress	Implementation in fall 2024 with ongoing assessment over the next four academic semesters	Need rates in online and f2f sections
4 (Communication) (SL)	Offer campus-wide story slam	To increase student engagement and belonging	Comm Studies Faculty	(1) Host slam for COMM 2025 and 2045 students in an all-campus event (2) Collection of participation percentages of all face-to-face sections	Implementation in fall 2024 and subsequent fall semesters	Need rates of participants

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

English -

Funding for more full-time position to support increasing on-ground courses.

Communication-

A full-time position for Springfield and Cookeville needs to be funded.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee Review

Members of the General Education Committee will review the GER and provide feedback.

Please attach committee minutes and any other applicable documentation regarding the committee's discussion.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Changes if applicable</i>	<i>Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video created. -Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. - Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	-Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. -	No changes to the timeline.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1.	English: Implement OER in ENGL 1020	The course was created and piloted in Fall 2024. Most online, asynchronous sections are using the model course and a few faculty are following it for F2F classes.	No challenges at this time.	N/A	We will be able to collect data for Spring 2025 later this year to determine success.
2.	English: Offer a new co-req model for ENGL 0810	A faculty workgroup was given release time in spring 2025 to research and create the new co-req model. The model will go into effect fall 2025.	No challenges at this time.	N/A	We will collect our first round of data after the fall 2025 semester.

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Performance Indicator Result</i>	<i>Initiative Achieved? Yes/No</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video was launched in the model shell -Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. -The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	- none.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	-No
1.					

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
Ex.				
1.				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Veterinary Technology AAS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The mission of the Veterinary Technology Program is to enable students to attain licensure and gainful employment by providing high quality education and clinical experiences. These services contribute the college's mission by building partnerships within the community and preparing students for successful careers.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
These services contribute the college's mission by building partnerships within the community and preparing students for successful careers.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Program Learning Outcomes:

1. Demonstrate knowledge of hospital procedures, communicate in all formats, and recognize applicable laws
2. Calculate and administer prescribed drugs and communicate necessary client information

3. Assess patient and demonstrate care under the following: husbandry, nutrition, therapeutics, and dentistry for companion animals, farm animals, laboratory animals and exotic species
4. Formulate an anesthetic plan and demonstrate ability to implement the plan and maintain anesthesia during all phases, including utilizing appropriate equipment
5. Recognize routine surgical procedures, manage patient preparation and surgical environment accurately
6. Manage laboratory specimens, operate equipment to analyze specimens and evaluate validity of results
7. Create diagnostic radiographs and recognize non-radiographic imaging modalities

Course Learning Outcomes:

VET 215 – Small Animal Medical Nursing

1. Calculate anesthetic agents for administration – Dental Rubric
2. Perform diagnostic dental radiographs - Dental Rubric
3. Perform dental exam and cleaning - Dental Rubric
4. Create appropriate medical records - Dental Rubric and Animal Care Rubric
5. Provide appropriate husbandry and nutrition for hospitalized animals – Animal Care Rubric

VET 220 – Veterinary Surgery and Anesthesia

1. Assess patient before surgical procedure – Pre-Op Nurse Rubric
2. Prepare patient for surgery – Scrub Nurse Rubric and Pre-Op Nurse Rubric
3. Calculate and administer anesthetic agents – Anesthetist Rubric
4. Induce and maintain anesthesia throughout surgery – Anesthetist Rubric
5. Create an aseptic surgical environment – Scrub Nurse Rubric
6. Monitor patient using appropriate equipment – Anesthetist Rubric
7. Record all procedure appropriately – Anesthetist Rubric

Rubrics of student skills are used for all official assessment methods

Target for all – 95% successful completion of skills.

See Evidence for Rubrics and Assessment Schedule

Evidence:

- VET, AAS Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1	100%	0%	96.45%	3.55%	93.82%	6.18%	
PLO 2	83.9%	16.09%	85.06%	14.94%	94.19%	5.81%	
PLO 3	99%	1%	98.77%	1.23%	99.03%	.97%	
PLO 4	95.37%	4.62%	97.4%	2.6%	98.64%	1.36%	
PLO 5	97.77%	2.22%	99.05%	.95%	100%	0%	

PLO 6	100%	0%	100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 7	93.33%	6.66%	100%	0%	82.61%	17.39%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.1	93.33%	6.66%	90.91%	9.09%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.2	93.33%	6.66%	100%	0%	92.61%	17.39%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.3	98.33%	1.66%	100%	0%	98.91%	1.09%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.4	100%	0%	95.45%	4.55%	94.2%	5.8%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.5	100%	0%	97.27%	2.73%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.1	100%	0%	100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.2	96.29%	3.7%	98.41%	1.59%	98.41%	1.59%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.3	79.62%	20.37%	84.85%	15.15%	92.06%	7.94	
Course Learning Outcome 220.4	93.05%	6.94%	95.45%	4.55%	97.62%	2.38%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.5	97.22%	2.77%	97.62%	2.38%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.6	100%	0%	100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.7	100%	0%	100%	0%	100%	0%	

1. Analysis of trends

- Program learning outcomes 1) hospital procedures and 7) imaging are trending downward. Neither have met the 95% success rate goal.
 1. The Imaging PLO is directly related to the VET 215 course learning outcome 2) diagnostic radiographs. The trend in this class is due to a change in procedure for this assessment. In the past students could prepare for which x-ray would be taken. This past summer students only have a list of possible x-rays, they are given the specific x-ray the day of the assessment. Because of the changes made in VET 210, we expect this CLO and PLO to increase again in the future.
 2. The hospital procedures PLO is related to the VET 215 course learning outcome 4) medical records. The reason for this decrease in success rate needs to be investigated.
- Program learning outcome 2) Pharmacy has increased every year. This PLO is related to course learning outcomes in VET 215 1) Calculate drugs and VET 220 3) calculate and administer medications. It is not at the target goal at this time.
- The goals for program learning outcomes 3, 4, 5 and 6 are being met.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

- Diagnostic imaging improvement: Move dental x-ray labs to the end of summer. That will decrease the gap between when students learning the skills initially and when they are assessed over them.
- Hospital procedures improvement: Reinforce information about items that are included in proper recording of patient care and medical needs. Emphasize that animals needs are not being met when students are late for animal care duties.
- Pharmacy improvement: Find a textbook that is easier for students to understand, with fewer mistakes. Increase the level of memorization they must accomplish.

Evidence:

- PreOp Rubric AY 2021-2023
- VET 220 CLOs AY21-23
- VET AAS PLOs AY21-23
- VET AAS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- VET AAS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- VET AAS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- VET215 CLOs AY21-23
- Vet Tech Student Course Evals AY20-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
 1. Strengths: The program has focused on students skills required of entry level veterinary technicians. As a result, practices seek out our graduates for employment because of their skill level. The clinical practicum student evaluations indicate our students are performing as expected in clinics. In addition to skills, our students learn how to work well with others. This helps them to become valuable team members when they get jobs.
 2. Areas of opportunity: Retaining didactic knowledge needs improvement. As students move through the curriculum, they should retain knowledge from previous classes. This allows them to be better prepared for their national exam. Since COVID our VTNE passage rate has decreased.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.
 1. The program needs to focus on strategies that will help students retain the information and better prepare for the VTNE. That starts with developing assessments that will mark milestones in their progress. Students that do not pass those milestones will need remediation so they will be able to continue with the curriculum.
 2. Focus on areas of weakness, as evidenced on the VTNE domain scores. Weak areas include pharmacy, animal care and anesthesia. While the students skills in those areas good to excellent, their didactic knowledge is lacking.

Evidence:

- VTNE CVTEA Report 2020 July - Dec
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2021 July - Aug
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2021 Nov - Dec
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2022 July - Aug
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2022 Mar - Apr
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2022 Nov - Dec
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2023 July - Aug
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2023 Mar - Apr

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Increase the achievement of PLO#1 by developing and implementing assignments in the summer that will strengthen their medical record skills. (SL)	To bridge the gap between introduction of skills (spring) to assessment of skills (fall).	Vet Tech Program Director and faculty	Increase VET CLO 215.4 and PLO#1 to greater than 95%.	AY 2023-2024 - Develop and implement assignments in VET 130 and VET 210 (summer 2024) AY 2024-2025 - Evaluate results based on 2024 CLO 215.4 results	PLO#1 – 93.82% VET CLO 215.4 – 94.2%
2	Increase the achievement of PLO#2 by developing and implementing changes to the VET 130 course. (SL)	To provide students with relevant and consistent opportunities to apply pharmacy knowledge and facts	Vet Tech Program Director and faculty	Increase PLO#2 to greater than 95% Increase VET 130 final exam average to 80% Increase VTNE domain 2 to 60% by summer 2025.	AY 2023 – 2024 - Redesign VET 130 lecture to incorporate: memorizing drug facts, simplify drug classifications and applying pharmacy knowledge AY 2024 – 2025 - After analyzing summer 2024, consider incorporating a nursing OER text	PLO#2 – 94.19% VET 130 Final exam average – 77% VTNE domain 1 – 56%
3	Increase the achievement	To increase the number	Vet Tech Program	Increase VTNE domain	AY 2023 – 2024	VTNE domain 5 –

	of VTNE Domain 5 by developing additional rubrics and quizzes pertaining to animal care and nursing. (SL)	of times a student is required to recall this information.	Director and faculty	5 to 65% by summer 2024 and at or above the national average by summer 2025.	- Develop and implement an animal care exercise or quiz that must be completed prior to the animal care rotation - Develop a more robust rubric for physical examinations AY 2024 – 2025 - Redesign VET 215 Topic project: consider modifying topics covered, give groups the outline, increase the number of questions on the final exam over the topics.	61%
4	Increase the graduate first time passage rate of the VTNE by creating major milestones students must pass to progress through the program.	To increase the recall rate and accuracy of information as students progress through the program	Vet Tech Program Director and faculty	Mid-curriculum test average score to >75% by summer 2024 VTNE passage rate of first time test takers to 60% by 2024 and 70% by 2025.	AY 2023 – 2024 - Improve mid-curriculum test at the end of summer semester, part of VET 150 - Develop a remediation process for students that do not pass the mid-curriculum test which will allow them to continue taking courses AY 2024 – 2025	Mid-curriculum test summer 2023 – 61% VTNE passage rate summer 2023 – 40%

					• Implement the remediation process if needed • Improve the VTNE review course (VET 265) for Spring 2025 • Develop more formal study sessions for first year students.	
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4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

The first 3 initiatives to do require any budgetary changes.

Initiative four will require the development and implementation of a remediation process for students that do not pass the mid-curriculum exam. The remediation will need to be an outside of class time commitment for both the students and instructor. Tentative plans include an hour of added instructional time during the fall semester. The program is also assessing the need to develop and implement structured study sessions during spring semester for first year Vet Tech students. There is a great need to teach students effective study skills so they can pass all the required testing.

Because the plans do not include adding curriculum hours, there will be no TLE for the instructor. Therefore, during the 2024-2025 year, the Program Director should get an additional 3 release hours during the fall semester to develop and implement the plan outlined above. At the end of the year, the success of this initial phase will be reevaluated, along with the time commitment needed for another instructor to continue.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Mission Statement Alignment

- **Program Mission statement is in alignment with Institutional mission statement.**

Curriculum and Student Learning

- **Learning outcomes focus on developing a comprehensive understanding and practical skills in veterinary medicine. They encompass knowledge of hospital procedures and**

applicable laws, effective communication skills, drug calculation and administration, patient assessment and care across various species and conditions, anesthesia management, surgical preparation and execution, laboratory specimen management and analysis, and diagnostic imaging techniques including radiography and non-radiographic modalities. Overall, these Curriculum and Student Learning outcomes are measurable and follow the Bloom's taxonomy framework.

Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

Quantitative (Strengths)

- High employability of graduates due to their entry-level skills.
- Positive performance evaluations during clinical practicums.
- Identified weaknesses in retaining didactic knowledge, especially reflected in decreased VTNE passage rates post-COVID.

Qualitative (Strengths)

- Graduates are praised for their practical skills and ability to work well in teams.
- Positive feedback on students' performance in clinical settings.

Noted areas for improvement:

- Need to improve retention of didactic knowledge, especially for better preparation for the VTNE.
- Identified weak areas in VTNE domain scores: pharmacy, animal care, and anesthesia, indicating a need for improvement in didactic knowledge.

Improvement Initiatives

Proposed initiatives (also discussed during the meeting) –

- Trying to increase hospital procedures and medical records
- Create additional assignments over the summer that pick up on medical records.
- Increasing the pharmacy program learning outline – redesign the pharmacy class (find OER textbook to supplement some of the material)
- Increase domain 5 on the national board – animal care and nursing – plan is to develop an additional rubric and assignments that is picking up on animal care and physical exams to increase feedback for students to
- Increase overall passage rate (since 2020, the students struggled with passing national boards); there will be a mid-curriculum exam at the end of the summer; students who fail will have to re-take the exam.

- *Create additional exams/assignments to facilitate retention of information which may ultimately lead to better outcomes on the National Board exam. In addition, focus on addressing specific weaknesses identified in VTNE domain scores through targeted instruction and support in pharmacy, animal care, and anesthesia, to ensure students have a well-rounded understanding and preparation for the VTNE.*

- *The fourth initiative, focusing on the development and implementation of a remediation process for students who fail the mid-curriculum exam, requires financial consideration for additional instructional time and resources. This includes allocating funds for an hour of added instructional time during the fall semester and potentially funding structured study sessions during the spring semester to enhance students' study skills. Additionally, there is a need to allocate resources for the Program Director to receive an additional 3 release hours*

during the fall semester to develop and oversee the implementation of these initiatives without increasing the curriculum hours.

Overall Comments, Suggestions, or Recommendations

- *Based on the information provided in the report, Vet Tech faculty members are committed to maintaining the high standards of education and support for our students. It's evident that there are areas for improvement, and by actively addressing these opportunities and securing the necessary resources to achieve goals, it is anticipated that the program will not only grow but also become stronger.*

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was

	resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	media services improved the video quality.		78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1					
2					
3					
4					

Close

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?

		student success?		
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

General Education Review, Cohort A- Cycle 2

Mathematics GE

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

Program and institution mission alignment

How does the mission of the area align to the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Gen. Ed. Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the area align with the mission of the institution?	
The department encourages faculty to be involved in various activities throughout the college as well as local community. Support of the mission of the college in strengthening interval and external community engagement is exhibited through the various activities in which members of the math department are involved. Faculty are actively involved in VSCC community outreach activities such as the Parris Powers Science and Math Expo. The Expo invites area students (focused on homeschool and public school elementary and middle school students) to visit the campus for an open-house-style, fun, interactive opportunity to experience math and science. Vol State students, faculty, and third-party guests present informational displays and offer hands-on experiments and activities. These include an egg drop, a life-sized Operation game, making ice cream with liquid nitrogen, planting tomatoes with the Sumner County	

Master Gardeners, learning about the cosmos with the Cumberland Astronomical Society, touring an ambulance with our EMS program, and learning about the eye with medical equipment from our ophthalmic tech program, among many other student- and faculty-led exhibits. The expo is not only a fun afternoon to encourage kids to enjoy science, but it is also an important outreach opportunity to welcome the community to our campus.

Several Math Department faculty are TN Achieves mentors and some teach the TN Achieves summer Bridge program to high school students registered for TN Promise.

VSCC serves as a testing site for Tennessee Mathematics Teachers Association State-Wide High School Mathematics Contest held each spring. Math department members handle fees, proctor tests, organize tests for scoring, provide a hospitality room for the teachers, award the winners with plaques at the final awards ceremony, and generate statistics associated with the tests.

The math faculty hosts the Tennessee Girls in STEM Workshop. This group consists of young women in middle school grades (grades 5-8) and high school (grades 9-12). These girls are introduced to STEM components by spending a day in workshops focusing on STEM education and career options.

Vol State Math/Science Division faculty hosts Engineering Day each spring. Students come to the campus for a day to participate in workshops and hear from industry speakers. Also, in the spring, the Math Department hosts Pi Day, where students can participate in fun games and activities related to Pi.

The International Education Committee is chaired by a math faculty member. One component of this committee is the Faculty Exchange Program. The exchange is a two-week professional and cultural exchange with the United States of America. A faculty member or administrator from the Netherlands will be matched with an American counterpart with similar job responsibilities. As a rule, the two weeks' exchange will consist of nine days of professional exchange and three days of leisure time (weekend) plus orientation day upon arrival.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A Assessment Plan

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs), Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs), assessment method, and assessment rubrics.

Evidence:

- GEMATH Assessment Tool

2.B Evidence of Student Learning

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the general education area course list.

Utilizing the assessment matrix and gateway data provided please provided the following:

1. Provide an analysis of trends found within the data.
2. Identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.
3. Review disaggregated data for gateway courses to identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning for gateway courses.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			69.04%	30.96%	59.53%	40.47%	
PLO 2			65.84%	34.16%	61.14%	38.86%	
PLO 3			72.85%	27.15%	61.74%	38.26%	
PLO 4			60.65%	39.35%	54.09%	45.91%	
PLO 5			65.73%	34.27%	62.17%	37.83%	
PLO 6			74.62%	25.38%	64.69%	35.31%	
Course Learning Outcome 1010.5 Counting Methods			36.53%	63.47%	46.49%	53.51%	
Course Learning Outcome 1130.2 Quadratic Equations			83.26%	16.74%	44.44%	55.56%	
Course Learning Outcome 1530.6 Hypotheses			63.36%	36.64%	59.29%	40.71%	

1. Analysis of trends

The math program level outcomes "GE.MATH.1 Building", "GE.MATH.3 Real World", and "GE.MATH.6 Reasoning" all decreased by 10% or more students who met the outcome from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23. The math program level outcome "GE.MATH.4 Connections", decreased by nearly 7% for students who met the outcome from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23. The math program level outcomes "GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving" and "GE.MATH.5 Technology" decreased by less than 5% for students who met the outcome from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23.

The course learning outcome that we selected to analyze from MATH 1010 was "Math.1010.5 Counting Methods". This CLO exhibited the strongest increase for percentage met from AY 21-22 (36.53%) to AY 22-23 (46.49%).

The course learning outcome that we selected to analyze from MATH 1130 was "MATH1130.2 Quadratic Equations". This CLO exhibited the most drastic decrease for percentage met from AY 21-22 (83.26%) to AY 22-23 (44.44%).

The course learning outcome that we selected to analyze from MATH 1530 was "MATH1530.6 Hypotheses". This CLO exhibited the most lowest percentage met (63.36%) beginning AY 21-22, and the percentage fell to 59.29% for AY 22-23.

We will need to see AY 23-24 data to have a better understanding if these percentages of decrease are consistent or if any rebound occurs.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

The PLOs for the department are set by TBR. The department created SLOs for general education courses two years ago and has been using Watermark/VIA to collect data. As more data is collected, the course committees for each course will be able to analyze the data for each outcome. The committees will then be able discuss strategies and implement ideas into the course to try to improve student success.

The analysis of the trends the trends indicates a downward turn in the percentages of students meeting the PLOs. This is not altogether surprising as the data window includes the semesters coming out of the COVID-19 pandemic. The math department has already taken steps to get students back on track by 1) revamping all the Learning Support Courses, 2) piloting multiple learning platforms, and 3) making policy changes regarding calculator use. We hope to see improvements in the coming cycles based on these changes. Finally, we should also revisit the questions used in the mappings to make sure they are appropriate in measuring the PLOs/CLOs.

3. Review disaggregated data for our gateway courses to identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning for gateway courses.

MATH 1010: Presented below is the disaggregated data for our course MATH 1010: Math for General Studies. This chart displays the percentage of students who met the PLOs specifically in MATH 1010.

PLO	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	2023 Met	2023 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)

GE.MATH.1 Building	64.56%	35.44%	65.65%	34.35%			
GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving	53.26%	46.74%	58.84%	41.16%			
GE.MATH.3 Real World	62.26%	37.74%	65.99%	34.01%			
GE.MATH.4 Connections	41.00%	59.00%	46.60%	53.40%			
GE.MATH.5 Technology	48.08%	51.92%	48.30%	51.70%			
GE.MATH.6 Reasoning	60.92%	39.08%	68.03%	31.97%			
Course Learning Outcome MATH.1010.5 Counting Methods	36.53%	63.47%	46.49%	53.51%			

Based on the disaggregated PLO data for MATH 1010, all PLO mapping for this course saw a percentage increase from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23 for students who met the PLOs. The PLO with the lowest percentage increase, "GE.MATH.5 Technology," saw an increase of 0.22% of student who met the PLO while the PLO with the highest percentage increase, "GE.MATH.6 Reasoning," saw an increase of 7.11% of students who met the PLO.

The CLO we selected as part of our analysis, "MATH.1010.5 Counting Methods," is the CLO with the largest percentage of increase (9.96%) from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23.

We need to see AY 23-24 data to have a better understanding if these percentages of increase continue.

MATH 1130: Presented below is the disaggregated data for our gateway course MATH 1130: College Algebra. This chart displays the percentage of students who met the PLOs specifically in MATH 1130.

PLO	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	2023 Met	2023 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
GE.MATH.1 Building	78.65%	21.35%	63.43%	36.57%	15.22		
GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving	74.59%	25.41%	61.11%	38.89%	13.48		
GE.MATH.3 Real World	79.70%	20.30%	44.44%	55.56%	35.26		
GE.MATH.4 Connections	80.63%	19.37%	37.50%	62.50%	43.13		
GE.MATH.5 Technology	83.64%	16.36%	78.24%	21.76%	5.4		
GE.MATH.6 Reasoning	87.70%	12.30%	35.65%	64.35%	52.05		
Course Learning Outcome MATH.1130.2 Quadratic Equations	83.26%	16.74%	44.44%	55.56%			

Based on the disaggregated PLO data for MATH 1130, all PLO mappings for this gateway course saw a percentage decrease from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23 for students who met the PLOs. The smallest decrease in percentage of students who met the PLO, based on mapping to MATH 1130, was "GE.MATH.5 Technology" which was approximately 5%. "GE.MATH.1 Building" and "GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving" saw a decrease of 15% or less. While "GE.MATH.3 Real World," "GE.MATH.4 Connections," and "GE.MATH.6 Reasoning" only saw a decrease by less than 1% of students who met the PLO.

The CLO we selected as part of our analysis, "MATH.1130.2 Quadratic Equations," maps to "GE.MATH.3 Real World" which is a PLO that also saw a percentage of decrease (35.26%) in students who met the PLOs exclusively in MATH 1130. This decrease was in the middle of MATH 1130 specific decrease which ranged approximately from 5% to 52%.

We will need to see AY 23-24 data to have a better understanding if these percentage of decrease continue.

MATH 1530: Presented below is the disaggregated data for our gateway course MATH 1530: Introductory Statistics. This chart displays the percentage of students who met the PLOs specifically in MATH 1530.

PLO	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	2023 Met	2023 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
GE.MATH.1 Building	57.10%	42.90%	59.29%	40.71%			
22GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving	67.26%	32.74%	70.83%	29.17%			
GE.MATH.3 Real World	74.61%	25.39%	75.48%	24.52%			
GE.MATH.4 Connections	59.99%	40.01%	69.07%	30.93%			

GE.MATH.5 Technology	59.60%	40.40%	66.08%	33.92%			
GE.MATH.6 Reasoning	74.31%	25.69%	74.20%	25.80%			
Course Learning Outcome Math.1530.6 Hypotheses	63.36%	36.64%	59.29%	40.71%			

Based on the disaggregated PLO data for MATH 1530, all but one PLO mapping for this gateway course saw a percentage increase from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23 for students who met the PLOs. The one PLO with a percentage decrease, "GE.MATH.6 Reasoning," only saw a decrease by less than 1% of students who met the PLO.

The CLO we selected as part of our analysis, "MATH 1530.6 Hypotheses," maps to "GE.MATH.5 Technology" which is the PLO with the smallest percentage of decrease (3.56%) department wide. Yes, this mapping saw a percentage of increase (6.48%) in students who met the PLOs exclusively in MATH 1530.

We will need to see AY 23-24 data to have a better understanding if these percentages of increase continue.

Evidence:

- GE PLOs AY 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1010 PLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1010 Rubric 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1010 SLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1130 PLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1130 Rubric 21-22
- MATH 1130 Rubric 22-23
- MATH 1130 SLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1530 PLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1530 Rubric 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1530 SLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1630 and MATH 1830 PLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- STEM PLOs 21-22 and 22-23

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

The Mathematics Department of VSCC (hereinafter referred to as “the department”) consists of 20 full-time and 16+ adjunct faculty and is part of the larger Math and Science Division. A table including the number of full-time faculty and adjunct instructors along with instructor to student ratios can be found in the evidence. This data is monitored to ensure that faculty have class sizes that are within the recommended best practices for student success.

Department members are active in professional organizations, most notably the Tennessee Mathematics Teachers Association (TMTA), Tennessee Mathematical Association of Two-Year Colleges (TMATYC), American Mathematical Association of Two-Year Colleges (AMATYC), National Center for Academic Transformation (NCAT), National Council of Teachers of Mathematics (NCTM), and Tennessee Education Association (TEA). Vol State also offers free professional development through the Teaching & Learning Center. Most faculty report they have made changes to their teaching methods as a direct result of training or attending conferences. Faculty attending meetings present what they learned at either professional development sessions, division meetings, or departmental meetings.

Evidence:

- Faculty Numbers and Ratios

3.B. Course Offerings

1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Since the implementation of Ad Astra, the department has been using it to help improve scheduling and ensure the appropriate classes are offered at each campus. The math department chair works with the science department chair and others to utilize space efficiently.

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 4 initiatives in total.

General education areas may include separate action plans for each discipline or may label each initiative to identify which discipline is responsible for the initiative within its area if deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least *two student learning* and at least *two student success initiatives*. The matrix should not include more than 4 initiatives in total.

General education areas may include separate action plans for each discipline or may label each initiative to identify which discipline is responsible for the initiative within its area if deemed appropriate.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
1.	Increase regular and substantive interaction in online math courses. (SL)	Provide faculty teaching online courses a training course on student engagement.	Department Chair	50% of online math faculty attend a training session in year 1. 100% of online math faculty attend training by year 2.	AY 2023-2024 and AY 2024-2025 -Provided training sessions for faculty	
2.	Increase PLOs and CLOs in Gateway courses (SL)	Include skills material in MATH 1130 and MATH 1530 (Gateway Courses) for all students as review material to ensure they can practice math skills they may be missing or have forgotten.	MATH 1130 and MATH 1530 Course Coordinators and Course Committees	Increase objectives met by 3%	AY 2023-2024 -Build course material to make Learning Support materials available to all students -Provide material to students by Spring 2025	See evidence
3.	Align assessments with PLOs and CLOs.	Review assessments of PLOs and CLOs to ensure they are accurately measuring outcomes.	Course Committees		AY 2023-2024 -Course committees review current assessments AY 2024-2025 -Course committees revise assessments as needed	

					AY 2025-2026 -Implement any changes in assessments	
4.	Increase the achievement of PLO #5 by developing technology resources for MATH 1530. (SL)	Provide students and tutors in the Learning Commons with a comprehensive document explaining the procedures for using the TI-84 calculator for statistical purposes	Department chair and MATH 1530 faculty	Increase PLO #5 achievement to 70%.	AY 2023-2024 -Faculty develop and review document -Share document with all MATH 1530 students and Learning Commons staff by Dec. 2024	PLO #5 66% met outcome in MATH 1530

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee Review

Members of the General Education Committee will review the GER and provide feedback.

Please attach committee minutes and any other applicable documentation regarding the committee's discussion.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Changes if applicable</i>	<i>Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video created. -Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. - Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	-Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. -	No changes to the timeline.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1.	Increase regular and substantive interaction in online math courses.	-Several lists of things faculty should do before the semester begins, during the semester, and at the end of the semester were created and put into eLearn module course shells. The lists are not exhaustive but give faculty a good sense of what is needed.	Creating a training session and finding time for faculty to attend proved to be difficult with so many different schedules.	The math leadership team decided to make a change and created modules within eLearn for instructors that give details on what is expected.	The instructor module is available to all faculty.
2.	Increase PLOs and CLOs in Gateway courses	-Built course material and added Learning Support materials in gateway	none	none	See tables below.

		courses -Provided materials to students starting in the Spring 2025 semester			
3.	Align assessments with PLOs and CLOs	-Committees did not implement changes in AY 2024-2025 -Committees met to review and make changes to assessments and course learning outcomes. They also aligned the assessment to the new GE Math outcomes and the CORE outcomes.	none	TBR made changes to the General Education Math outcomes.	-Work is complete in all but one course, which will be done Summer 25 - Assessments have been uploaded into the system -Ready to implement Fall 25
4.	Increase the achievement of PLO #5 by developing technology resources for MATH 1530.	-A document was created for faculty to give to students explaining the procedures of using the TI-84 calculator for statistical purposes. It was also shared with the Learning Commons staff. Note: Not all instructors use the calculator; some may use other technology to perform statistical calculations.	none	none	For the AY 24-25, MATH 1530 results show that 58.86% met the outcome (909 results) for PLO#5. This has not met our goal and needs more work in the area for improvement.

For the AY 24-25, the results show the following:

Program Learning Outcomes MATH 1130 and MATH 1530 Combined	% met outcome AY 24-25	Number of results AY 24-25
GE.MATH.1 Building	61.87%	632
GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving	71.49%	1105
GE.MATH.3 Real World	68.78%	1086
GE.MATH.3 Real World	59.82%	1105
GE.MATH.5 Technology	63.90%	1086

GE.MATH.6 Reasoning	73.76%	1105
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Course Learning Outcomes MATH 1130	% met outcome AY 24-25	Number of results AY 24-25
MATH.1130.1 Linear Equations	90.96%	177
MATH.1130.2 Quadratic Equations	69.49%	177
MATH.1130.3 Inequalities	64.97%	177
MATH.1130.4 Graphs	89.83%	177
MATH.1130.5 Evaluate functions	-----	-----
MATH.1130.6 Exponential Equations	62.15%	354
MATH.1130.7 Logarithmic Equations	56.50%	177

Course Learning Outcomes MATH 1530	% met outcome AY 24-25	Number of results AY 24-25
MATH.1530.1 Identify Terms	70.68%	464
MATH.1530.2 Organize Data	83.84%	464
MATH.1530.3 Calculate Measures	81.90%	928
MATH.1530.4 Apply Distributions	78.88%	1392
MATH.1530.5 Confidence Intervals	72.09%	455
MATH.1530.6 Hypotheses	56.92%	455
MATH.1530.7 Linear Regression	65.20%	454

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Performance Indicator Result</i>	<i>Initiative Achieved? Yes/No</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video was launched in the model shell -Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. -The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	- none.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	-No
1.					

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
Ex.				
1.				

General Education Review, Cohort A- Cycle 2

History GE

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

Program and institution mission alignment

How does the mission of the area align to the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Gen. Ed. Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
<i>The history program at Vol State aims to educate students on cultural, religious, social, and economic systems that have existed over time and place, thereby promoting global awareness and acceptance, developing critical thinking through source analysis, and preparing students for civic engagement through discussions of ethics and human action.</i>	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the area align with the mission of the institution?	
The history program aligns with Vol State's mission by providing some of the most challenging and innovative instruction at the college. The history program promotes cultural awareness and ethical action through thoughtful and open discussion of diverse opinions, actions, and events throughout history. Additionally, the history program empowers students to research, think critically, and therefore promotes civic engagement and life-long learning.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A Assessment Plan

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes

1. Students will demonstrate the ability to....
 1. Analyze historical facts and interpretations.
 2. Analyze and compare political, geographic, economic, social, cultural, religious and intellectual institutions, structures, and processes across a range of historical periods and cultures.
 3. Recognize and articulate the diversity of the human experience across a range of historical periods and the complexities of a global culture and society.
 4. Draw on historical perspective to evaluate contemporary problems/issues.
 5. Analyze the contributions of past cultures/societies to the contemporary world.
2. Assessment Method
 1. Academic freedom and the nature of instruction in history dictate that each instructor is at liberty to determine the assignment(s) that are used to assess student learning. However, all instructors utilize some writing or other project that requires argument and evidence-based analysis. These are the assignments that are typically utilized for collecting data.
3. Achievement Targets
 1. To my knowledge, the History Program has not set specific achievement targets.
4. Assessment Schedule
 1. The schedule dictates that we report data for Early and Modern US History, as well as Early and modern World History, in the spring term each academic year. At this time, we do not report data for African American History and Tennessee History.
5. Assessment Rubric

1. See HIST Assessment Tool

2. Rubric Structure

Elements	Proficient	Satisfactory	Developing	Novice
	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
SOURCES	Student clearly demonstrates the ability to distinguish primary sources from secondary sources.	Student demonstrates the ability to distinguish primary sources from secondary sources most of the time.	Student mistakenly classifies primary and secondary sources most of the time.	Student does not demonstrate the ability to distinguish between primary and secondary sources.
GE.HIST. 1 - GE.HIST.1	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met

Historical Facts and Interpretations				
HIST.2010.1 - HIST.2010.1 Sources	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
SOCIETAL DEVELOPMENT	Student includes the most important historical concepts or information to explain the topic. Concepts and facts included are accurate and used appropriately.	Student includes some of the most important historical concepts or information, although one or two key ideas are missing. Any misconceptions/factual errors are minor and do not affect the overall accuracy of the argument.	Student omits most of the important historical concepts or information necessary to answer the questions. Specific details included may be accurate but could be seen as insignificant. Alternately, factual errors are prevalent enough to negatively impact accuracy.	Student includes information that is either irrelevant or insignificant to the topic. The student does not include any of the most significant historical concepts or terms. Key statements reveal misconceptions; details and examples contain many factual errors.

GE.HIST. 2 - GE.HIST.2 Institutions, Structures, and Processes	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
HIST.2010.2 - HIST.2010.2 Causes/consequences	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
INTERACTIONS	The student includes the most important historical concepts or information to explain the topic. Concepts and facts included are accurate and used appropriately.	Student includes some of the most important historical concepts or information, although one or two key ideas are missing. Any misconceptions/factual errors are minor and do not affect the overall accuracy of the argument.	Student omits most of the important historical concepts or information necessary to answer the questions. Specific details included may be accurate but could be seen as insignificant. Alternately, factual errors are prevalent	Student includes information that is either irrelevant or insignificant to the topic. The student does not include any of the most significant historical concepts or terms. Key statements reveal misconceptions; details and examples contain many factual errors.

			enough to negatively impact accuracy.	
GE.HIST. 3 - GE.HIST.3 Diversity	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
HIST.2010.3 - HIST.2010.3 Changes	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
HISTORICAL PERSPECTIVE	Student clearly demonstrates the ability to make multiple connections between historical events and the present day.	Student demonstrates the ability to make some connections between historical events and the present day.	Student makes superficial or loose connections between historical events and the present day.	Student fails to make connections between historical events and the present day or makes connections that are inaccurate.
GE.HIST. 4 - GE.HIST.4 Historical Perspective	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
HIST.2010.4 - HIST.2010.4 Historical perspective	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
GE.HIST. 5 - GE.HIST.5 Past Cultures and Societies	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met

	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
ARGUMENT	Student crafts a valid and defensible argument using both primary and secondary sources that are well explained and placed in historical context.	Student crafts a valid and defensible argument using both primary and secondary sources but the explanation of how primary and secondary sources support the argument and the historical context of the sources is less effective.	Student crafts an argument that is a somewhat questionable interpretation of the primary and secondary sources.	Student crafts an argument that is illogical or is not supported by primary and secondary sources.
HIST.2010.5 - HIST.2010.5 Argument	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met

Rationale for Findings:

1. Like other programs, the history program at Vol State crafted assessments rubrics based on TBR guidelines and rubrics, and we did not have sufficient flexibility to craft our own program outcomes. Further, each instructor has their own assignments with their own rubrics (exactly as it should be, with academic freedom and all), which makes determining our student's success using TBR mandated metrics like smashing a square peg into a round hole.

2. On the current assessment rubric we must follow, metric 2, 3, and 4 are so overlapping and vague as to be almost useless to measure. Many in the department have significant issues with metric 4- "Historical Perspective"- in particular, which requires that students make connections between the past and present day- something that should be left to experts (not students)- as it often invites ill-conceived, poorly considered comparisons that can even be dangerous in their lack of nuance. In teaching history, we are constantly telling students to stick to the time period under study and do not go outside of it. If we have not covered a current events topic, then we should not be asking students to construct a comparison to it.

3. Collecting data using the current method- leaving eLearn, using one assignment, translating from personal rubric to a standardized, TBR mandated rubric of learning outcomes- is cumbersome, time-consuming, and yields questionable results. Collecting good data should be seamless if it to be reliable and the instructor should not even know that it is happening. I don't know that this exists, but what would work would be software that integrates with D2L where individual assessment metrics can be linked to rubric metrics for one or more assignments, and the information is gathered as graded. No potential changes, however, should add more work to instructors plates. Any changes should end by easing teaching workload, not adding to it.

Evidence:

- GE HIST Assessment Tool

2.B Evidence of Student Learning

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the general education area course list.

Utilizing the assessment matrix and gateway data provided please provided the following:

1. Provide an analysis of trends found within the data.
2. Identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.
3. Review disaggregated data for gateway courses to identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning for gateway courses.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			86.24%	13.76%	84.33%	15.67%	
PLO 2			83.77%	16.23%	82.26%	17.74%	
PLO 3			84.05%	15.95%	82.14%	17.86%	
PLO 4			78.38%	21.62%	81.68%	18.32%	
PLO 5			78.38%	21.62%	81.68%	18.32%	
Course Learning Outcome 2010.1			83.84%	16.16%	82.03%	17.97%	
Course Learning Outcome 2010.2			81.96%	18.04%	81.36%	18.64%	
Course Learning Outcome 2010.3			84.05%	15.95%	82.14%	17.86%	

Course Learning Outcomes HIST2010.1 Sources HIST2010.2 Causes/Consequences HIST2010.3 Changes

1. Analysis of trends

1. Overall success rates for learning outcomes hold fairly steady over several years at or above 80%. Given the nature of college attrition, especially community college, 80% seems a very reasonable success rate, one that is unlikely to increase significantly.
2. In US history, success in almost every category dropped between AY21/22 and 22/23. In nearly every category, the reverse is true for World History: there was improvement between those years.
3. There is a noteworthy gap in the success rate of African American and Hispanic students and the overall population. The success rate for AY22-23 was 72.55% for AfAm students and over 82% for overall population.
4. There was a noticeable drop in the success rate first gen students between AY21-22 and AY22-23, but an improvement in success rates for Pell Grant recipients between the same years.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

1. Develop targeted programs for minority students
2. Allow for more departmental freedom to develop learning outcomes (no TBR mandated outcomes)
3. Streamline data collection- integrated into LMS/Rubrics

Evidence:

- GE HIST Assessment Plan
- GE HIST PLOs Gender AY21-23
- GE HIST PLOs AY21-23
- GE HIST PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- GE HIST PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- HIST CLO_s AY21-23
- HIST2010 SLO_s AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115942
- HIST2020 SLOs AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 120018
- Pass Rates HIST Intro Courses
- Submitted University Parallel Academic Audit-1 (1)

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
 1. **Full time/adjunct ratio:** there are consistently about 30% more adjuncts than full-timers teaching history, and most teach at or near the max load for adjuncts. Additionally, one of our full-time faculty retired over a year ago whom we have not replaced, and another is planning retirement within the next year or so. We could certainly benefit from another full-time instructor soon.

2. **Pre-requisites:** Require ENGL 1010 and 1020 before history. History courses are reading and writing intensive, and often require research and certainly require critical thinking, analysis, synthesis, and reading comprehension skills.
 3. **Fewer students/classes:** though unlikely to happen, fewer students or classes would certainly allow instructors the ability to engage more directly with students, especially those who need more direct assistance. With the current 30 student limit in most on ground history sections, I believe that fewer sections would be preferable to smaller class size, since 30 students is great for liveliness and discussion.
 4. **Fewer non-teaching related assignments:** streamline data-collection (instructors should not even know that they are doing it) through elearn/rubric integration, reduce administrative workload and data interpretation and collection.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.
1. **Full time/adjunct ratio:** More devoted (full-time) faculty who have greater opportunity to engage directly with well-prepared students equates to student success.
 2. **Pre-requisites** One of the most effective ways to help students succeed in history is to give them better foundational skills. Having to complete ENGL 1010 and ENGL 1020 as prerequisites (preferably with a grade of C or better) before entering history would increase the likelihood of success.
 3. **Fewer students/classes:** better teacher/student ration generally results in higher success rates
 4. **Fewer non-teaching related assignments:** Our faculty are excellent and devoted to student learning. Clearing out the extraneous work that is not in their wheelhouse would allow for greater focus on students.

3.B. Course Offerings

1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.B. Course Offerings

1. **3.B. Course Offerings**
 1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
 1. **On-ground v online classes:** based on data provided by Vol State interim President Deaton, success rates are higher in on-ground classes than online. I suspect that outcome numbers for online classes are even lower than the data show due to often compromised academic integrity in online classes.
 2. **Academic Integrity:** Use of AI, especially in online classes, is becoming ever more common.
 3. **Classrooms:** In many of our classrooms in Caudill, the projector screen covers nearly all of the white board.
2.
 1. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.
 1. **On-ground v online classes:** Online classes will not go away. It is important to create strong online classes that ensure student *learning* as well as student success. However, having robust on-ground offerings is important for ensuring positive outcomes. One way that the history program is doing this is by offering Tennessee

History and African American History on-ground in both the fall and spring semesters (they used to alternate on-ground, one fall, the other spring).

2. **Academic Integrity:** Having robust technology and course design training to prevent and detect AI use is essential to improving student learning and ensuring the student success is authentic.
3. **Classrooms:** Having white boards that span the full length of the wall would much improve clear communication in the classroom and improve student learning and effective note-taking.

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 4 initiatives in total.

General education areas may include separate action plans for each discipline or may label each initiative to identify which discipline is responsible for the initiative within its area if deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
1.	Create more robust, targeted assistance for students of color and others through history tutoring at the Learning Commons. (SL)	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of history projects/essays.	Delois Reagan and history faculty who participate in Learning Commons tutoring-Stella Pierce, Merritt McKinney, Melanie Cochran	Close the gap in success rates for students of color to an 80% success rate	By S25, have a published schedule of history faculty availability at the learning commons with targeted outreach for students of color	
2.	Identify a broad range of clear, well-defined, techniques in both course/assignment design training and technological	to support genuine academic rigor and dissuade academic dishonesty	Distributed Ed or IT as well as faculty from a broad	As far as I know, data is not collected through RASI on academic integrity so developing	In one year, have collected data on AI cases from student services and academic	

	software to prevent and detect AI use, also normalize faculty use of AI detection		range of disciplines	performance indicators will require information from Student Services and the Academic integrity	integrity committee from which we can determine frequency of AI use and correlation to success rates	
3.	Reduce instructor bureaucratic workload and streamline assessment data reporting including ALERTS	Free up instructor time to spend engaging with students, providing targeted feedback, ALERTS and direct assistance	RASI team, IT, and eLearn with feedback from faculty		By S25, determine feasibility of integrating ALERTS into eLearn and research software that will allow assessment tool (watermark/VIA) integration into eLearn rubrics	
4.	More full time history faculty	Increase student learning and success through more focused, devoted, and better paid faculty, IE full-timers	HPEG department would be responsible for hiring committee, approval would come from Pres, VP		Realistically, we can probably determine get approval within a year.	

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

- No budget requirements for item 1 (tutoring, targeting assistance).** History faculty are already acting as tutors in LC. The only progress that needs to be made is consistency and creating a published schedule, which Delois has begun planning
- Budget needs for item 2 (AI detection) might include:** AI detection software and more manpower in Distributed Ed (desperately in need already).
- Budget needs for item 3 (eLearn integration of assessment software and ALERTS system) might include:** improved assessment software and more manpower in IT and Distributed Ed to do the backend work and training.
- Budget needs for item 4 (Full-time History Faculty) will include:** salary and benefits for full-time faculty.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee Review

Members of the General Education Committee will review the GER and provide feedback.

Please attach committee minutes and any other applicable documentation regarding the committee's discussion.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

4/3/24.

Going forward, the history department needs to set achievement targets. This is the faculty's responsibility, though Theresa and I are available to help you work through that. For this cycle, you do not need to go backwards. It could be something like, "75% of students will meet SLO X" and could be an improvement over what the data is showing currently or a target to maintain if already sufficiently high.

Initiatives

Bear in mind that all of the initiatives you set for the department this year will have to be planned out, executed, and reported on annually over the coming three years. Going into Fall 2024, you will have to create a plan for how each initiative will be implemented. There should be at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives.

Initiative 1: "Create more robust, targeted assistance for students of color and others through history tutoring at the Learning Commons."

This initiative focuses on student support. Under current state and TBR directives, we are unable to targeted programs for minority students. However, we may develop interventions to deploy or make available to all students that would encompass minority students in the effort. Also, what exactly do you intend to measure here - how many history faculty are providing tutoring or student success rates? The information you've listed as 'baseline data' is really a timeline. This initiative needs some work to be measurable, and the focus of needs to be expanded to include improvement for all students taking history classes.

Initiative 2: identify a broad range of clear, well-defined, techniques in both course/assignment design training and technological software to prevent and detect AI use, also normalize faculty use of AI detection

This initiative also seems related to student support, though it will require a great amount of collaboration to plan and complete.

Initiative 3: Reduce instructor bureaucratic workload and streamline assessment data reporting including ALERTS

While I understand the rationale and support the idea, this initiative may prove difficult to accomplish simply because of the onus on other departments and technological limitations. Even so, RASI, DE, and IT cannot help us unless we work with them to identify and implement changes. It's important, but it also is not clearly tied to student learning outcomes or student support. I recommend replacing initiative 3 with something focused specifically on sustaining or improving student learning outcomes.

Initiative 4: More full time history faculty

Let's think about how best to support this by tying it to student learning. In your initiative chart, you say "Increase student learning and success through more focused, devoted, and better paid faculty, IE full-timers." To do this effectively with data, you have to analyze what is already happening and establish a baseline. I would like to see an analysis of student learning outcomes between full-time faculty and adjuncts within the history department. I spoke with Theresa, and she says that she can show you how to pull that data. Additionally, I recommend analyzing outcomes and success rates by modality within the department. The results of such studies could highlight any number of things that need to be addressed through targeted faculty development, communication/collaboration improvements, curriculum changes, and/or student support initiatives.

Comparing the full-time to adjunct ratio within History to that of other general education departments is informative. I have a report generated by Academic Affairs that contains this information. Within the SSE division, the percentage of history adjuncts is on the low side (40.74%) compared to sociology (47.06%), Psychology (53.06%). Only lower-enrolled areas (ECON, GEOG, POLS) have low adjunct rates within this department. Comparatively, BIOL has a less than 4% adjunct rate, CHEM has about 23%, COMM has about 43%, and ENGL has about 20%. Additional details are below.

Academic Year 2023-2024

Row Labels	Count of FT/PT	Sum of TLE	% of TLE
HIST	17 162	100.00%	
Adjunct	10 66	40.74%	
On Tenure Track	1 15	9.26%	
Tenured	5 66	40.74%	
Term	1 15	9.26%	

SOCI	6 51	100.00%
Adjunct	3 24	47.06%
On Tenure Track	1 9	17.65%
Tenured	2 18	35.29%

PSYC	16 147	100.00%
Adjunct	11 78	53.06%
On Tenure Track	2 30	20.41%
Tenured	2 30	20.41%
Term	1 9	6.12%

ECON	5 42	100.00%
Adjunct	3 12	28.57%
Tenured	1 15	35.71%
Term	1 15	35.71%

BIOL	18 252.4	100.00%
Adjunct	1 9	3.57%
Non-Tenured Track	1 14	5.55%
On Tenure Track	5 72	28.53%
Tenured	9 124.4	49.29%
Term	2 33	13.07%
CHEM	6 56	100.00%
Adjunct	2 13	23.21%
On Tenure Track	1 10	17.86%
Tenured	3 33	58.93%

COMM	20 154.2	100.00%
------	----------	---------

Adjunct	11	66	42.80%
On Tenure Track	2	16.2	10.51%
Tenured	7	72	46.69%

ENGL	35	360.1	100.00%
Adjunct	11	72	19.99%
Non-Tenure Track	2	24	6.66%
On Tenure Track	9	108	29.99%
Tenured	13	156.1	43.35%

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Changes if applicable</i>	<i>Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video created. -Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. - Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	-Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. -	No changes to the timeline.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1.					

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Performance Indicator Result</i>	<i>Initiative Achieved? Yes/No</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video was launched in the model shell -Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. -The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	- none.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	-No
1.					

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
Ex.				
1.				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Criminal Justice AAS & CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
The mission of the Criminal Justice program is to be the leader in educating future criminal justice practitioners by providing students with the skills needed to critically examine the world around them, the ability to understand and embrace the diversity of the society in which they serve and live, and the continuing desire to learn more about themselves, society, and the criminal justice field. The Criminal Justice program encourages students to use problem solving skills, to communicate clearly both verbally and in writing, to evaluate the various methodologies used to measure crime, to compare and contrast theoretical perspectives, to interpret case law, and to describe the functions/roles of law enforcement, courts, and corrections. There has been no change in the mission statement. The program probably needs to rephrase “embrace the diversity of the society in which they serve” to “embrace the society in which they live and serve,” in order to follow the current trend in TBR. The purposes of these two mission statements is about building innovative education programs and strengthening community ties while embracing people from all backgrounds. The main idea in promoting these goals is to provide a student who are ready for successful careers when they graduate.	

Evidence:

- Mission Statement Audit

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Section 2a: Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment- Assessment Plan

The program had identified two student learning outcome for the Criminal Justice Certificate. These are:

1. Students will demonstrate the knowledge and skills necessary for an entry level position in the criminal justice field. and
2. Students will demonstrate an understanding of the organizational structure, common legal terms, definitions, concepts, and roles of law enforcement, the courts, and corrections.

The program learning outcomes are measured through an one hundred question exit exam. Students must meet a target score of at least an eighty-five percent in order to show knowledge attainment. The program learning outcomes are also measured through three core classes in the Criminal Justice AAS nad certificates. Students must score a seventy percent or above to show knowledge attainment. These are measured through a learning outcome assessment embedded in the courses. The learning outcome assessments are given each semester. The rubrics and evidence are provided within the evidence of this section.

The program added a Corrections Certificate in the fall of 2023 as part of a governor’s initiative to provide more education and jobs in the State of Tennessee. This added the PLO’s which are tracked in the CRMJ 2020 Learning Outcome Assessment. These new PLO’s are below and are going through curriculum committee to be added to the catalog. No data is available for the new certificate due to how recently it was added. The rubric for the learning outcome assessment for the Corrections Certificate needs to be added.

Corrections CERT PLO’s

- Discuss the history of corrections, special populations in corrections, gangs, and PREA (Prison Rape Elimination Act).
- Identify issues concerning mental illness, suicide prevention, officer wellness, cultural diversity, and sexual harassment in corrections.
- Relate communication, report writing, and intelligence-gathering techniques to a corrections environment.
- Identify and cite laws concerning use of force, duty to intervene, and constitutional and civil rights laws for corrections populations.

The following questions are form the Learning Outcome Assessment for CRMJ 2020 Corrections and will be used to gauge success in learning the above PLO’s:

1. Corrections can be viewed as a series of processes that are _____, meaning that each process affects another part of the criminal justice system in some way. (Question 3)
2. Which of the following is NOT one of the four commonly accepted goals of criminal sanctions in the United States? (Question 4)
3. Which of the following is NOT an issue for correctional institutes dealing with offenders who have HIV/AIDS? (Question 10)
4. A judicial order asking correctional officials to produce the prisoner and to give reasons to justify continued confinement is called a writ of _____. (Question 19)
5. The number of Section 1983 lawsuits among both state and federal prisoners dropped dramatically following the passage of the _____. (Question 21)
6. The first juvenile court in the U.S. was established by legislative act in 1899 in what city? (Question 23)
7. Which Supreme Court case defines how to run a modern correctional facility? (Question 25)
8. What U.S. Constitutional amendment; and right within that amendment, is most often cited by the courts regarding prisoner rights violations? (Question 28)

The curriculum has changed slightly due to adding new classes for the certificate and making the Criminal Justice AAS fully attainable online. The catalog description and recommended schedule are:

General Education Requirements - Credits (15-16)

- [COMM 2025 - ^Fundamentals of Communication](#) Credits: (3)
- **OR** [COMM 2045 - ^Public Speaking](#) Credits: (3)
- [ENGL 1010 - ^English Composition I](#) Credits: (3)
- [Humanities and/or Fine Arts](#) Credits: (3)
- [Mathematics](#) Credits: (3-4)
- **OR** [Natural Science](#) Credits: (3-4)
- [Social/Behavioral Sciences](#) Credits: (3)

Major Core Course Requirements - Credits (30)

- [CRMJ 1010 - Introduction to Criminal Justice](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1020 - Introduction to the Legal Process](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1311 - Criminal Law](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1340 - Criminal Investigation](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1355 - Understanding Terrorism](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1360 - Introduction to Crime Scene Investigation](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 2010 - Introduction to Law Enforcement](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 2020 - Introduction to Corrections](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 2312 - Criminology](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 2390 - Probation and Parole](#) Credits: (3)

CRMJ Electives - Credits (15)

- CRMJ Electives (Choose from the following list or consult with the Program Advisor for approved course options) Credits: (15)

[CITC 2352 - *Digital Forensics](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 1325 - Issues and Ethics in Criminal Justice](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 1341 - *Physical Defensive Tactics](#) Credits: (4)
[CRMJ 1381 - *Interview and Interrogation](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2311 - Juvenile Justice](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2332 - Drug Identification and Effects](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2340 - Investigative Report Writing](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2381 - Selected Topics in Criminal Justice](#) Credits: (1-6)
[CRMJ 2395 - Corporate Security and Loss Prevention](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2396 - Criminal Justice Internship I](#) Credits: (3)
[HED 200 - First Aid and Safety/CPR](#) Credits: (3)

The program is making CRMJ 2340 a major course requirement due to feedback from the advisory board. The board has identified writing reports as a major issue with new recruits and specifically requested the college to make sure students are taking this course (September 2020 Advisory Board). This request has passed curriculum committee review, and the change will be in the next catalog.

The program has added a new corrections certificate based on identified need from the governor. This has allowed the program to receive special funding through a grant. The program has also analyzed the class schedule and front-loaded program courses in the student schedule in an effort to help retention. The sequencing in the program meets a cross section of classes that support the mission statement in preparing students for careers in the criminal justice field.

The assessment plan includes an evaluation of core concepts in core courses. These core courses have been identified by the TBR and program stakeholders to contain knowledge necessary for success in the criminal justice field. The questions identified have provided a cross-sectional framework of knowledge, skills and abilities needed to progress not only in core and elective courses, but in on-the-job success in the future. Data from these evaluations shows consistency in determining whether the goals were met, with very few outliers to explain.

Evidence:

- CRMJ AAS Cert Assessment Tool
- CRMJ Evidence Email
- Criminal Justice AAS Exit Exam

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

CRMJ AAS

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result	(Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			59.55%	40.45%	60.87%	39.13%		
PLO 2			88.30%	11.70%	61.97%	38.03%		
PLO 3			87.66	12.34%	88.32%	11.68%		
PLO 4			63.42%	36.58%	62.50%	37.50%		
PLO 5			60.98%	39.02%	60.87%	39.13%		
PLO 6			16.97%	83.03%	5.88%	94.12%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.1			61.59%	38.41%	59.42%	40.58%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.2			60.37%	39.63%	60.14%	39.86%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.5			63.41%	36.59%	59.42%	40.58%		

Course Learning Outcomes- CRMJ1010.1 Goals CRMJ 1010.2 Components CRMJ 1010.5 State and Federal

CRMJ TC

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result	(Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			59.55%	40.45%	60.87%	39.13%		
PLO 2			58.16%	41.84%	61.97%	38.03%		
PLO 3			87.59%	12.41%	88.32%	11.68%		
PLO 4			63.42%	36.58%	62.50%	37.50%		
PLO 5			60.98%	39.02%	60.87%	39.13%		
PLO 6			16.97%	83.03%	5.88%	94.12%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.1			61.59%	38.41%	59.42%	40.58%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.2			60.37%	39.63%	60.14%	39.86%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.5			63.41%	36.59%	59.42%	40.58%		

Course Learning Outcomes CRMJ1010.1 Goals CRMJ1010.2 Components CRMJ1010.5 State & Federal

1. Analysis of trends

The PLO's Data shows that approximately sixty percent of students are meeting the learning outcomes for section 1 Terms and Concepts, 4 Evidence and Investigation, 5 Organizational Structure, and eighty-eight percent of students are meeting learning outcomes for section 2 Individual Rights and 3 Safety procedures and Protocol. There is no data for section 6 Entry Level Skills.

PLO's by gender are in line with the data shown overall. The trend, with one exception, show that females scored slightly above the class average while males scored slightly below the class average. Traditionally, we have more female students in the classes, so outliers will be less of an effect for them in the classes.

PLO's for Pell Grant and First-Generation students are not as consistent as the previous areas. In many areas, these subsections of students scored better than the class average. The areas Pell Grant students scored lower were terms and organizational structure. First generational students scored higher in the 21-22 academic year than they did in the 22-23 academic year. In some cases, their scores were significantly higher.

PLO's involving race showed that minorities scores were fairly consistent in AY 21-22 with their scores just below the class average. This trend remained the same for black students in 22-23, but the Hispanic population showed a remarkable increase in AT 22-23 going from a 58% success rate to over a 90% success rate.

The CLO's were in line with the PLO's and show approximately sixty percent for knowledge attainment for all ten areas.

The exit exam results show that the program is not meeting its goals in this area. For Fall 2021 the average was sixty-one percent and only one student reached the goal of eighty-five percent. The average for Spring 2022 was seventy-two percent with one student meeting the required eighty-five percent. The average for Fall 2022 was seventy-five percent with no students reaching the eighty-five percent threshold. The average for Spring 2023 was sixty-eight percent with no students meeting the threshold. The average for Summer 2023 was seventy percent with no students reaching the eighty five percent threshold. The average for Fall 2023 was seventy-eight percent with two students meeting the threshold. The average for Summer 2024 was eighty-seven percent with the one student reaching the threshold. The average for Spring 2024 was sixty-six percent with no students reaching the threshold.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

The program is still recovering from an enormous shift of student population going online after covid. Students are generally not as successful in online formats. The program is actively recruiting in person students to help with student success. TBR has recently stated that the preferred method of instruction is in person. The program is in the process of revising/re-developing online courses to provide current and meaningful learning tools to enhance student success. The program is also focusing on developing OER classes and has developed three such classes to enhance student learning. The program will support online learners by working with the library and learning commons to encourage students to use the services provided and track data.

The program has also received funding from grants to promote project-based learning and job skills in classes. This delivery method helps non-traditional and minority students be successful in class. Data shows that minorities are only slightly below class average, and a remarkable improvement of Hispanics in the second year evaluated. The program encourages a variety of teaching methods to improve comprehension and

retention of core concepts to increase understanding of core concepts. The program also supports several of the TBR HIPs to improve student success. These include internships, certificates, advising by program leaders, international education, service learning, interactive learning, and technology usage in the classroom.

The results of the exit exam are disappointing, but could be drastically improved with two things. The test is a two-year comprehensive test covering the classes in the program. An eighty-five percent pass rate is extremely high and only five students in 3 years met this requirement. A seventy percent is passing with a "C" in college. Based on the fact that seventy percent shows knowledge attainment and the fact this is a comprehensive test covering two years of college course, the program should track rates of seventy percent or better. If tracked at this level, the average for each semester except for two would be met. A majority of students, twenty-five, would meet the threshold. The second item for improvement would be to develop a study guide for the test. This would help students familiarize themselves with material that they may have been exposed to several semesters ago.

Evidence:

- CRMJ 1010 CLOs AY21-23
- CRMJ AAS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- CRMJ AAS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- CRMJ AAS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- CRMJ TC PLOs Gender AY21-23
- CRMJ TC PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- CRMJ TC PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- Criminal Justice AAS Exit Exam
- Criminal Justice AAS PLOs AY21-23
- Criminal Justice TC PLO_s AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Analysis of the program fact sheet shows the continued decline in enrollment since covid. Criminal justice is traditionally an in-person major with lots of hands-on activities. The swing in student registration to online programs has had an effect on enrollment. There has been a drastic decrease in full-time students since 2021. This trend shows an approximate fifteen percent shift in full-time students versus part-time students. Providing PLA's for current law enforcement officers may have increased our part-time students. This would explain why there was a raise in part-time enrollment in 2021, while the full-time students declined. Enrollment has been down across the college and the program is in line or better with the college enrollment shifts over this period. Factbook shows that enrollment in 2020 was 8,619 for the college and that it dropped to 6,623 in 2023. According to Factbook, the criminal justice enrollment in 2020 was 82, but dropped to 54 in 2023.

Graduate data shows an improvement since 2020. 2021 shows a drastic improvement with students returning from covid to complete their degree.

Placement data is absent from this report. Previous staff indicated the office of IERPA was responsible for keeping this data. As of now, it is unknown how the data is to be tracked. However, based on continued faculty communication with graduates, students are being employed at local departments at a constant rate.

Retention showed a markable increase each year from 2019 to 2022. 2019-2022. Retention increases from 11 percent to 28 percent in 2021. It increased again to 48 percent in 2022. Retention then dropped off in 2023 to 41 percent. There was a slight decline in retention in 2023, dropping to 41%. There are two factors that have been identified to account for this change. The first factor is the substantial increase in part-time students and a significant lower enrollment the year prior. Part-time students are not as likely to complete a degree. The second is the employment rates increased in 2022, causing lower enrollment and more people returning to work. The employment change is a result from rising wages. These facts are confirmed in an email from Assistant Chief Bill Sorrells. (A new system is being created to track persistence retention. Currently persistence numbers are not available)

An analysis of student survey responses show that Vol State criminal justice faculty are consistently rated very high in all categories. The strength of faculty involves teaching methodology and assessments that provide hands on collaborative learning, engaging classroom environments and faculty with practical experience. Survey data showed a slight indication for two areas of improvement. These are:

1. "The instructor posted graded assignments and provided feedback on my progress in this course in a timely manner." and;
2. The instructor was accessible by appointment, office hours, emails, phone, online, as indicated in the syllabus."

When evaluating the instructors in the program, there were rare instances where grades could have been posted more frequently. The previous dean indicated that posting grades was a part of the instructional freedom of the college. It is now a part of the evaluation process and instructors can be held accountable in this area. Additionally, the program is developing a weekly form to help track the work completed in areas that the college evaluates for full-time faculty. This will help instructors when it is time for their evaluation to show proof for the areas evaluated.

The outlook for the criminal justice field is good. The change in the law enforcement climate since 2020 and the reforms pressuring departments and officers has subsided. As a result, jobs in the field are numerous and the pay has substantially increased. Local departments are currently hiring officers with no experience and a starting pay of over \$65,000. Some of the improvements of the plan since the last audit are:

- Employment and Career resource on eLearn.
- Front loading the sequence of classes to accommodate more major-based courses and allowing for English to be moved to the spring semester of freshman year.
- Making the AAS fully attainable online.
- Increasing PLA credits for certifications in the workforce.
- Revising/re-developing online courses to make them more up to date and providing OER
- Program Focusing on TBR's HIPs
- Receiving grants through different sources in order to provide technological advances in the classroom for hands on learning.
- Creating a new corrections certificate
- Offered TCI corrections classes to students and local law enforcement.

- Increasing full-time faculty
- Decreasing adjunct faculty
- Promoting hands on collaborative learning to all faculty
- Creating a criminal justice lab
- High attendance at recruitment events by faculty
- Advancing SkillsUSA

The program recently implemented an online career resource module that is open to all students throughout their student career. This was accomplished by taking a discontinued course and converting it to a resource for all careers in criminal justice that students can use to discover criminal justice careers, employment, and success in the program by understanding the careers available and how those careers meet their aptitude.

The program has also changed the schedule to enable students to front load major classes. This was a TBR initiative last year. Data suggests that providing their major courses in the beginning of their college career allows them to be more successful. Courses were also developed so that the Criminal Justice AAS degree could be completed fully online. This, along with the addition of PLA credits has increased part-time enrollment.

While this can be seen as a factor that has led to lower persistence and retention, it did help offset the lower enrollment to some extent. The Criminal Justice AAS degree was also made fully available online for the first time. This also supports the addition of part-time students who are returning to school. In an effort to support online students, course have been redesigned to be more in line with current practices. These include adding three OER sections, with plans to add more in the coming years. The program also focuses on TBR's HIPs to increase student success. The program currently supports work-based learning with internships at several local locations. The additional certificate now provides two certifications for students, as well as other embedded certifications. The program is active in advising students both academically and professionally. This involvement has resulted in several students obtaining employment after they graduate. The program has also purchased several items to increase the use of technology in the classroom.

The program has received funding from Perkins and other school-based grants to provide new equipment such as simulators and duty belts. The program also received funding from an initiative from the governor to increase corrections personnel. This funding provided \$80,000 in resources for equipment and program needs as well as funding for an additional full-time faculty member. This funding and equipment has enabled the program to complete a criminal justice lab with new technology, especially in the field of corrections. These purchase help in advancing the newly created corrections certificate as well as supporting the enrollment in local agencies in the Tennessee Corrections Institute classes offered on Vol State campus to both students and local officers. The addition of a full-time faculty member has allowed for the reduction in adjunct faculty. This saves the program money and provides consistency to students in the program. It also allowed for more collaborative teaching with hands-on learning objectives that are preferred in the criminal justice setting.

The additional faculty member also allowed for the program faculty to get more involved with campus initiatives and recruiting. The criminal justice program was present at almost every recruiting event and career fair the college hosted in the last year. These include events at the distance learning locations.

The program was also the first at the college to take part in SkillsUSA. SkillsUSA is a career and technical organization that allows students to compete against other schools, provides training, and places students in touch with employers for training and job placement. Initial attempts to grow this student based academic program were problematic, especially in securing a source of funding. Through the efforts of the program, the students have been labeled as an academic entity and receive funding through the college. This has allowed SkillsUSA to expand to other programs. Students have been very successful in this endeavor, winning first place in state every year, and placing in nationals every year with eight first place awards to students on the national stage.

Evidence:

- Criminal Justice AAS- Fact Sheet FA23- Adjusted
- Criminal Justice Student Course Evals AY20-23
- Criminal Justice TC Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1 (SS)	Provide students with viable affordable learning options in an online setting and encourage use of resources at VolState	Increase offering of OER online classes and support services	Program director and criminal justice faculty	Develop three more OER courses and collect data on support services	By next academic audit 2027	There are currently only two OER online options in the program. CRMJ 2312 CRMJ 2311
2 (SS)	Track successful student employment after graduation	Develop a student and employer survey to track data	IERPA or current office responsible for the data	At least 30 percent of graduates job placement is tracked after graduation	2024	There is currently no baseline as this data has not been tracked for several years.
3 (SL)	Increase lowest PLO from class learning outcomes	Provide students with updated curriculum that supports success in this PLO	Program directors and faculty	Increase student learning outcomes for identified PLO	2025	The lowest PLO attainment was forty percent.

4 (SS)	Increase persistence and retention, in the program	Director and program faculty will continue using instructional methods to support academic student success in all modalities.	Director and program faculty	Increase persistence 25% and retention 18%	2025	Student persistence is currently 23% and retention is 15%
5 (SL)	Increase student exit exam scores (PLO 1)	Provide students with study materials that will support the successful completion of the exit exam	Director	Increase successful exam results by five percent	2025	Class averages per semester Fall 21 61% Spring 22 72% Fall 22 75% Spring 23 68% Summer 23 70% Fall 23 78% Summer 24 87% Fall 24 65%

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

The only budgeting needs from the improvement matrix would be to update the online courses and make these OER. Currently the cost for developing courses in house is \$2400 a course. So the total cost would be \$7200 to meet this goal. There are, however, grants through the TBR that will provide money at no cost for the college to develop these courses. The program will be exploring these options as well.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Mission Statement Alignment

The mission of the program is aligned with significant portions of the institutional mission

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcome Assessment

The review describes two program-level learning outcomes and the method of assessment of each. The review calls these learning outcomes. I suggest it would clarify the document to call these PLOs since the discussion also mentions assessment of course-level learning outcomes to assess the second PLO. The assessments and targets seem appropriate for the program.

One suggestion would be to separate the AAS program and the Cert program in the program review section. As a person without familiarity with the criminal justice program, blending the discussion of these two different programs makes it difficult for me to follow this thread. For example, what part of the curriculum applies to the AAS that doesn't apply to the Cert?

The modification of the curriculum to require the CRMJ 2340 course is a great example of responding to externally identified student deficiencies.

Evidence of Student Learning

I think I am not following the PLOs being measured in this section. In 2A, it appears that goals are set at 80% for one learning objective and 70% for another learning objective but in this section, there are more objectives listed and it appears that 60% is labelled as meeting the objective. I must be misunderstanding.

Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

Very good analysis of current enrollment trends.

Improvement Initiatives

I am not in the program area and so cannot directly relate to the needs of this program, but I would note that the anticipated move towards increasing online options in this program is counter to the plans for other programs in the college. Other programs are moving to offer more in-person options. Similarly, as an outsider I would question if the lack of interactions between students and mentoring faculty in online education would be detrimental to the development of the students.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

Section 2a

As written:

Success for the second learning outcome is gauged by six learning outcomes in three core classes for the Criminal Justice AAS and Criminal Justice Certificate. *A student must score a seventy percent or above to show knowledge attainment. These are measured through a learning outcome assessment embedded in the courses. The target is to have every student pass the test with at least an eighty percent success rate.* The learning outcome assessments are given each semester. The rubrics and evidence are provided within the evidence of this section.

Above, you state two different targets, 70% and 80%. Please clarify.

Further, documentation attached to the review indicates there are 6 PLOs, the last of which is measured by an exit exam. The numbering and description provided in the narrative does not align with the supporting documentation. #1 equals #6 and #2 equals #1. Numbers 2, 3, 4, 5, and 5 are not mapped in any comprehensible way. They should be consistently numbered and labeled in all parts of the report and supporting documentation.

As written:

- 1. Students will demonstrate the knowledge and skills necessary for an entry level position in the criminal justice field, and
- 2. Students will demonstrate an understanding of the organizational structure, common legal terms, definitions, concepts, and roles of law enforcement, the courts, and corrections.

Attached:

- 1. Students will demonstrate an understanding of common legal terms, definitions, and concepts of law enforcement, the courts, and corrections.
- 2. Students will identify individual rights as they apply to law enforcement interaction as they apply to the public.
- 3. Students will apply safety procedures and protocol to law enforcement situations.
- 4. Students will analyze evidentiary and investigation procedures.
- 5. Students will demonstrate the organizational structure, evolution, and roles of law enforcement, the courts, and corrections.
- 6. Students will demonstrate the knowledge and skills necessary for an entry level position in the criminal justice field.

Lastly, please provide evidence to support the following claims:

- The program is making CRMJ 2340 a major course requirement due to feedback from the advisory board. The board has identified writing reports as a major issue with new recruits and specifically requested the college to make sure students are taking this course.
- The program has added a new corrections certificate based on identified need from the community....Data has shown this helps students success rates in college.

Section 2.B

Please correct the typos where commas are used instead of decimals.

It should be stated that students are performing below the target level, whether that is 70 or 80%.

Why is there no data for PLO 6, Entry Level Skills? Was the exit exam not administered as planned? If not, explain why it was not.

In addition to increasing the use of OER, I would like to see a plan to support online learners. You stated that the program has received grant funding to promote problem based learning and job skills. In my view, those resources need to be made available to online students in some way.

Section 3

Please provide evidence to support these claims:

- Enrollment has been down across the college and the program is in line or better with the college enrollment shifts over this period.
- The second is the employment rates increased in 2022, causing lower enrollment and more people returning to work.

The student survey data indicates a slight, but noticeable trend in two areas:

- The instructor posted graded assignments and provided feedback on my progress in this course in a timely manner.
- The instructor was accessible by appointment, office hours, emails, phone, online, as indicated in the syllabus.

Please comment on these areas and explain what, if anything is or can be done to improve them.

Section 4

Initiative 1, please include the course numbers that are currently using OER in the baseline data. Courses may be redeveloped for compensation through the Distance Learning office's existing budget if faculty apply and are awarded a contract, or faculty may apply for a TBR OER grant. No division or department funds are currently available to compensate faculty for this work.

I would like to see initiative 4's objective expanded to include all modalities. Director and program faculty will continue using instructional methods to support academic student success in all modalities.

Initiatives 1, 2, and 4 are student success oriented while #3 is about tracking student learning outcomes. The expectation stated is that the matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives, so you are currently short one initiative related to student learning.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Note that the matrix was incorrectly formatted and difficult to comprehend at the time of the Year 2 updates made in August-September, 2025. This is a link to the matrix with its original content as well as our revisions: [Assessment Initiatives Tracking F25.docx](#). The table inserted here reflects only the revised versions (without the original content that has been replaced).

Initiative	Measure	Target	Baseline	Who	Due Date	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes, if Applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1 (Student Success)	Increase offering of	Develop three more	There are only 2 OER courses in	Program director and	By next academic	As of August 2025, 2/3	CRMJ 1311- Criminal Law was	In August 2025, we narrowed	During AY 24-25, two courses (CRMJ 1010 Intro

Provide students with viable affordable learning options in an online setting	OER online classes	OER courses	the program. CRMJ 2312 CRMJ 2311	criminal justice faculty	audit 2027	of the goal has been met.	contracted but not complete due to loss of the program director in May 2025. Funds from Distance Education are limited, delaying additional development during AY25-26.	the focus of this initiative to only OER course development because it should not be conflated with the encouraging online students to use the library and learning commons resources. These student support services are already accessible to online students in every course, and a more focused initiative in this vein might be appropriate in the future based on an analysis of online and on-ground student success rates.	to CJ and CRMJ 1355 (Understanding Terrorism) were redeveloped with OER and received approval from Distance Learning in May 2025. In August 2025, the faculty identified the following priorities for additional OER model course development: 1. 2020 Introduction to Corrections – by Kevin Cook AY25-26 2. 2010 Introduction to Law Enforcement – by Catherina Castiglione AY25-26 3. 1020 Introduction to Legal Process – TBD 4. 1311 Criminal Law – TBD Note that this initiative aligns to initiative #5 in the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 .
2 (Student Success) Track successful student employment after graduation	Develop a student and employer survey to track data	At least 30 percent of graduates job placement is tracked after graduation	There is currently no baseline as this data has not been tracked for several years. Plan has been established to track these.	RASI and program director	2024	In Fall 2024, RASI prepared a survey and provided instructions and training to program directors and deans.	Three challenges exist. 1. Student engagement, 2. the timeline for survey collection, and 3. a manual distribution process of employer surveys required of program directors after students respond. RASI creates 3 surveys and deploys them all on	None, N/A	June 2025, Dean Gregory emailed graduates to encourage completion of their two surveys. Spring & Summer graduate data is collected from October to August of the following year. Fall graduate data is collected from February to August. Reports become available September 30 th for the prior academic year. Employer surveys are also available for distribution and collection at the same time, but not after.

							the same timeline: 2 students go to students (graduate satisfaction and job placement are separate surveys) and 1 is created for employers. RASI emails the 2 student surveys. Program directors are responsible for contacting the employers identified in the student's survey response.		At the time of this report, data for 2024 graduates is still being collected. No respondents (to date) provided any employer information, so we are unable to distribute the employer satisfaction survey. Note that this initiative aligns to initiative #2 of the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 .
3 (Student Learning) Implement improved assessment instruments being used to measure student learning.	Completion of project: Assessments will be updated across all model courses to remove errors, and outcomes will be assessed by more than one exam question.	<u>AAS PLO 1:</u> 70% Met	<u>AAS PLO 1</u> AY21-22 59.55% (293) Met 40.45% (199) Not Met AY22-23 60.87% (252) 39.13% (162) Not Met	Program director and faculty	December 2025	None yet	August-September 2025: As written, the initiative lacked clarity and purpose. The former director had not shared or discussed this initiative or PLO data with the other full-time faculty members. Faculty identified that some of the course assessments contained errors such as incorrectly marked answer options and misspelled words. Further, the outcomes are only being assessed by a singular question on one exam.	September 2025: Rewrote the initiative and measure, focusing on overall improvement of the assessment instruments to correct the errors and challenges noted. Revised the baseline to reflect attached evidence. Set a specific target at 70% (C or better equivalent). Set a December 2025 due date.	While completing the program curriculum map this fall, we noted that PLO 1 (terms and concepts) is introduced in CRMJ 1010 and developed in every course thereafter. To improve visibility alongside other program initiatives, we included the tracking of this revised initiative into the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 and plan to follow-up with additional analysis in future years to measure its impact.
4 (Student Success) Identify curriculum updates	Increase persistence and retention, in the program	60% retention rate 70% persistence	August 2025 data: Retention rates in the AAS program	Program Director and Faculty	2025	No	In the drafting of this initiative and his initial update in Spring 2025,	September 2025: Rewrote this initiative, measure, and target,	The process of curriculum review is being tracked in detail as part of initiative #6 of

needed to support student success initiatives so that all AAS graduates also earn the two embedded certificates to improve retention and persistence rates		rate	ranged from 25% to 56.3% over the past 5 years. Retention from F23 to F24 was 47.4%, compared to 49% in the college overall. Persistence rates ranged from 46.4% to 87.5% over the past 5 years. Fall 23 to Spring 24 persistence was 63.2% compared to 72.6% at the college.				the former director conflated curriculum sequencing and delivery formats with actual instructional methods. The measure and target as presented are not specific nor measurable. Further, the baseline data reported was inaccurate.	citing accurate baseline data.	the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 .
5 (Student Learning) Increase student exit exam scores (PLO 1)	Provide students with study materials that will support the successful completion of the exit exam	Increase successful exam results by five percent	Class averages per semester: Fall 21 61% Spring 22 72% Fall 22 75% Spring 23 68% Summer 23 70% Fall 23 78% Summer 24 87% Fall 24 65%	Program Director	2025	None	The former director only shared the study guide with the Testing Center and one other full-time faculty member. Additional distribution methods are needed to increase student awareness of the exam as well as of the study guide and how to use it.	August 2025, CJ faculty determined to create additional distribution avenues to make the study guide widely accessible to all students in the AAS program. Note that this initiative and its action steps are tracked in the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 , initiative #4.	Spring 2025, the former director created a study guide and provided it to the Testing Center at Vol State. In August 2025, the Testing Center Director added a link to the Criminal Justice Exit Exam study guide to the Testing Center webpage (under Graduation Exit Exams), on the Graduation Exit Exams webpage , and within their online scheduling system when students select the Criminal Justice Exit Exam.

Narrative:

There are some overarching challenges facing the department at the time of this update. One major challenge that will be noted in the matrix is that the program director position was vacated in May 2025, leaving the department without direct leadership and one full-time faculty member short. Related, the remaining program faculty reported to the dean that they were unaware of the assessment process and the level of detail required in managing implementation and tracking of the identified initiatives. Further, some initiatives were written without measurable or specific targets despite earlier feedback provided to the former director; this input has been documented in previous sections of this report. The two remaining full-time faculty members are 9/10-month employees who do not work through the summer on program-related initiatives outside of optional teaching assignments. This left the Year 2 update work for the Fall 2025 semester.

The TBR academic audit of the program occurred last year, AY24-25, and included a self-study that was written by the former program director. The audit resulted in a separate set of program improvement initiatives that must be planned, implemented,

tracked, and reported on annually for the next five years, at which time the audit will be repeated. There are some overlapping initiatives between this internal reporting process and the TBR audit, but not all initiatives overlap.

Finally, the program curriculum has not been properly mapped to identify which course learning outcomes align to specific program learning outcomes and the degree to which those outcomes are introduced, developed, or mastered throughout the curriculum. All combined, these challenges create a sizable amount of work to sort through, prioritize, and complete - all in service to improving program outcomes and student success. Program faculty, an interim department chair from the Sociology, Psychology, and Social Work department, and I are working together currently to accomplish this work and provide a clearer direction for future success.

~Dean Rhonda Gregory, written 8/26/25 and revised 9/29/25

Reviewed and confirmed at department meetings, fall 2025 (minutes available upon request)

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- University Parallel Cycle 2

University Parallel AA & AS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
"Be a great program"	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	

Evidence:

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Volunteer State Community College's University Parallel program offers Associates of Arts and Associate of Science degrees in sixty-seven areas of emphasis. The programs span five academic divisions: Business, Humanities, Math and Science, Social Science and Education, and Health Sciences. The mission of the University Parallel Program aligns with the mission of Volunteer State Community College.

All courses offered by the college correspond with the mandated student learning outcomes for each general education course by the Tennessee Board of Regents (TBR). The courses taught at Volunteer State Community College are offered through four different delivery methods: traditional face-to-face, online, hybrid, and TNeCampus. The faculty of Volunteer State Community College have developed programs designed to meet the educational needs of our service area. Consistency of instruction and preparation of appropriate course materials that meet the students' needs is a challenge, however, faculty implement several learning initiatives to address these challenges. For example, increase direct assessments of University Parallel student learning outcomes, the development of a vigorous Quality Assurance Process for online learning, and the development of the Teaching & Learning Center. Additionally, the academic freedom allowed to each faculty member illustrates the commitment of establishing attainable course outcomes and allows for the implementation of best practices throughout each program's curriculum.

The curriculum of each University Parallel program promotes the mission of the college by providing innovative educational programs in the context of preparing students for successful careers and community service.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan is attached as evidence. Assessed A.S. and A.A. areas of emphasis assessment plans are also attached as evidence. Assessment plans detail the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcome for the A.A. & A.S. are evaluated in a variety of subjects annually. Each division identified faculty members who created standardized rubrics and faculty provided input regarding the creation of those rubrics. Additionally, faculty within each division have chosen an assignment or assessment to evaluate the learning outcomes. Faculty have also identified achievement targets as either "met" or "not met", respective to their content area. Assessments take place once an academic year, but each division has the liberty to choose which semester the outcomes are evaluated.

Evidence:

- ART1035 General Education SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144759
- BIOL 1010 Student Learning Outcome Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145036
- CHEM1030 General Education Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145251
- ECON2100 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144442
- ECON2200 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144504
- GEOL1060 Assessment Rubric- Lab Activity Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145115
- MATH 1530 Student Learning Outcomes Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144954
- MUS1030 General Education SLO Rubric Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144832
- SOCI1010 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144548
- University Parallel A.A. & A.S. Assessment Plan

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends.
2. Attach effectiveness documentation of each assessed area of emphasis.
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Attach: Academic Program Review, University Parallel Area of Emphasis Assessment Reviews

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)	
PLO 1			87.54	12.46	83.81	16.19	93.64	6.36
PLO 2			74.59	25.41	64.87	35.13		
PLO 3			67.01	32.99	62.5	37.5		
PLO 4			77.94	22.06	70.37	29.63	96.36	3.64
PLO 5			81.82	18.18	75	25	92.73	7.27
PLO 6			79.10	20.9	94.2	5.8	78	22
Course Learning Outcome 1 HIST.2010.1 Sources Students will explain the difference between primary and secondary sources.			83.84	16.16	82.03	17.97		
Course Learning Outcome 2 HIST.2010.2 Causes/consequences Students will analyze the causes and consequences of major historical events in early US history			81.96	18.04	81.36	18.64		
Course Learning Outcome 3 HIST.2010.3 Changes Students will demonstrate an understanding of the various social, economic, and political events and changes of the early US period			84.05	15.95	23.82	17.86		

PLO 1: Students will use problem solving as an application of critical thought.

PLO 2: Students will understand and apply knowledge of the foundations and practice in the scientific method of inquiry.

PLO 3: Students will understand and apply knowledge to the foundation and practice in relevant mathematical skills.

PLO 4: Students will demonstrate effective oral communication skills.

PLO 5: Students will demonstrate effective effective written communication skills.

PLO 6: Students will identify and analyze national and global societal challenges.

PLO results dropped in all categories except PLO 7. The most significant drop was in PLO 2, followed by PLO4. The significant decrease in PLO2 is due to students are weaker in science skills coming into college. Additionally, during the transition from Covid to post-Covid, we were seeing students who took more of their science courses online. We know that success went down in the online science courses compared to in-person science courses. Since then we have switched back to modalities that have more in-person components. The significant decrease in PLO4 is most likely a result of the lack of oral communication activity in students due to isolation during the pandemic. The isolation from others increased the level of social anxiety, which decreased the level of effective oral communication skills. Once students were able to return to social activities, too much time had passed in not exercising said skills and at this point, electronic communication was more commonplace than before.

Evidence:

- History Course Learning Outcomes Report
- UPR AA AS PLO_s AY20-23

- UPR AA AS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- UPR AA AS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- UPR AA AS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- University Parallel Learning Outcome - Courses Assessment Chart - UPR

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Analysis of top and low-performing areas of emphasis.
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

1. Assessment of Strengths

The program's biggest strength lies with the faculty at the college. Their ability to adapt and innovate seems to be the driving force behind the increase in graduation rates of students in the University Parallel programs by approximately 500 students from 2020 to 2022, even with the decline of student headcount of approximately 1500 students from Fall 2018 to Fall 2021. There are numerous examples across many departments within the University Parallel program, illustrating the faculty's ability to adapt not only the course modality, but also course content delivery to reach our students' ever-changing needs. Faculty are engaged in HIPs (High Impact Practices), rigorous course review, development and re-development of model courses, annual assessment and review of course learning outcomes, course textbook revisions, and supporting students through the Learning Commons. During the academic audit timeline, the data shows that there are fewer adjunct faculty compared to full-time faculty. This means there are more hours each semester where students have access to faculty during office hours, tutoring time in the Learning Commons, and other unplanned, random interactions with faculty. An increase in student graduation rate in the University Parallel Programs could be attributed to an increase in one-on-one student interactions both inside and outside of the classroom.

3. Areas of Opportunity

In addition to faculty attendance at regional conferences for subject area two-year colleges and similar groups, we find that this is also an area of opportunity. There are several departments within the University Parallel program that would benefit from more consistent interaction with other TBR and out-of-state community colleges and 4-year schools, which would serve both as opportunities to network as well as to gather information about what is being done. This can also lead to continued innovation within our department and program.

Another area of opportunity lies with interdepartmental and cross divisional collaborations and interaction within the program. Many departments have interesting and useful initiatives and other departments may not be aware of these. We find that working on the University Parallel Academic Audit and University Parallel Review makes this clear as we find out about a variety of such initiatives through these processes. This may also be true within each department regarding how classes are taught and different activities, methodologies, and best practices.

By increasing student retention, we would also be increasing graduation rates. Focusing on faculty support of students in the classroom in both content area and study skills and critical thinking abilities may continue to increase graduation rates. Gateway courses, FYEX, and a broader adoption of HIPs, best practices, and innovations that are occurring in some areas.

Another area of opportunity is leadership structure. One of the University Parallel Academic Audit's initiatives from Spring 2023 was to provide a leadership group for the University Parallel program. The goal date for this was Spring 2024. Thus far a leadership group has not been announced. A General Education committee was created and approved in Fall 2022, so the precedent has been set for such a committee for the University Parallel. A leadership organization would go a long way towards accomplishing the area of opportunity listed above.

Evidence:

- University Parallel Academic Audit 2022
- University Parallel- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements	Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty	(1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%. (2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88% (3) Reach 120 views	AY2023-2024 Develop Tutorial Faculty review of the tutorial. Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections. AY2024-2025 Launch video in the model shell	(1) 76% pass rate (2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.
1	To increase student success achievement of all PLOs, faculty have a scheduled time slot during	To provide faculty with resources, strategies, and classroom management techniques to best meet the needs of the	VPAA, Deans, Department Chairs, and Faculty.	Increase of each PLO by 2.5%	Provide a round table discussion time during convocation days. Record minutes to share with	

	convocation to discuss best practices.	student population.			faculty not in attendance.	
2	Increase student learning in PLO #4 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	To provide students with the skills and techniques needed to develop effective oral communication skills.	Deans, department chairs, and faculty	Increase the PLO #4 met outcome rate to 80% which is an increase of 9.63%	Develop the FYEX course by Fall of 2024. Pilot course Spring of 2025. Examine evidence to determine why the rate dropped from 77.94% in 2021 to 70.37% in 2022	Baseline of 77.94 in 2021 70.37% in 2022 of met outcome.
3	Increasing student learning in PLO #3 through the development of course material in Gateway courses.	To provide all students in Gateway math courses additional resources of prerequisite material to ensure they are prepared to learn new and more complex concepts.	Dean Math and Sciences Division, Math Department Chair, and Math Faculty	Increase the PLO #3 met outcome rate to the rate from 2021 (67%)	AY 2023-2024 -Build course material to make Learning Support materials available to all students -Provide material to students by Spring 2025	Baseline of 67.01% (2021) and 52.5% (2022) met the outcome.
4	Increase student learning in PLO #5 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	To provide students with the skills and techniques needed to develop effective written communication skills.	Deans, department chairs, and faculty	Increase the PLO #5 the met outcome rate to the rate from 2021 (81.2%) which is an increase of 6.2%	Develop the FYEX course by Fall of 2024. Pilot course Spring of 2025. Examine evidence to determine why the rate dropped in 2021 from 81.2% to 75% in 2022	Baseline of the met outcome of 81.2% (2021) and 75% (2022).

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee

Faculty will present the General Education Review (GER) to the General Education Committee. The Committee will conduct a review of the UPR and GER. The committee will provide feedback for the completed review and action plan as a supportive step.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Deans should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	To increase student success achievement		During the past academic year, the college experienced a significant leadership	As the new leadership continues to settle in,	Unable to compare because no progress has

	of all PLOs, faculty have a scheduled time slot during convocation to discuss best practices.		transition with the appointment of a new president. While this change brought fresh perspectives and long-term strategic vision, it also required a period of adjustment and realignment of priorities across departments. As the administration focused on assessing current practices and establishing new goals under new leadership, our effort to provide faculty with targeted resources, strategies, and classroom management techniques was temporarily paused or delayed. This transition period limited the availability of time and support needed to fully implement faculty development programs.	we anticipate renewed momentum for faculty support in the upcoming year.	been made in the initiative.
2	Increase student learning in PLO #4 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	The campus-wide FYEX committee created a FYEX model that was shared with each division earlier this semester (2025). Divisions will revise the course, as needed, by the end of April 2025. FYEX courses will go live in Fall 2025.	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #4 79.66% met. This is 0.34% below the goal.
3	Increasing student learning in PLO #3 through the	The Math Gateway courses use a third-party learning platform	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #3 57.88% met. This is a

	development of course material in Gateway courses.	to deliver the majority of course content, including homework assignments, quizzes, and tests. The math department added the Learning Support Math material into these learning platforms in the model courses as optional assignments to ensure that the material is available to all students.			5.38% increase from 2022, but still below the goal.
4	Increase student learning in PLO #5 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	The campus-wide FYEX committee created a FYEX model that was shared with each division earlier this semester (2025). Divisions will revise the course, as needed, by the end of April 2025. FYEX courses will go live in Fall 2025.	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #5 84.05% met. This exceeds the goal of 81.2%.

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1	The tutorial video was launched in the model	None	The assignment success rate for pilot	YES

	by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				